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Friday, October 16, 2026

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Initial Public Offer of equity shares on the main board of BSE Limited (**"BSE"**) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited **("NSE"**, and together with BSE, the **"Stock Exchanges"**) in compliance with Chapter II of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018, as amended ("**SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS**").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and Abridged Prospectus)

ZETWERK

ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED

(formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited)

(To be listed on the main board of BSE and NSE)

Our Company was originally incorporated at Chennai, Tamil Nadu as 'Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited' as a private limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated December 6, 2017, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre ("**RoC CRC**"). Subsequent to a change in our registered office from the state of Tamil Nadu to the state of Karnataka pursuant to the Board resolution dated April 11, 2019, and the special resolution passed by our Shareholders on May 6, 2019 and confirmation of such alteration by an order dated September 13, 2019 passed by regional director, a fresh certificate of registration dated October 15, 2019, was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Karnataka at Bangalore. Subsequently, our Company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company and the name of our Company changed from 'Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited' to 'Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Limited', pursuant to a Board resolution dated January 23, 2026, and a special resolution dated February 6, 2026, passed by the Shareholders. Accordingly, a fresh certificate of incorporation dated February 23, 2026, was issued by the RoC, CRC. For further details on the changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see ***"History and Certain Corporate Matters - Changes in the registered office"*** on page 362 of the red herring prospectus dated October 11, 2026 (**"RHP"** or **"Red Herring Prospectus"**).

Registered and Corporate Office: #84/1, Ground & 1st Floor, Vaishnavi Sovereign, Green Glen Layout, Bellandur, Bengaluru South, Bengaluru - 560 103, Karnataka, India
Tel: +91 7624 9748 90; **Website:** www.zetwerk.com; **Contact person:** Mania Sarkar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **E-mail:** cs@zetwerk.com; **Corporate Identity Number:** U74999KA2017PLC128777

PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY: AMRIT PRATIK ACHARYA AND SRINATH RAMAKKRUSHNAN

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED ("COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹28,300.00 MILLION (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 144,525,036 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION, COMPRISING AN OFFER FOR SALE OF 14,230,672 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY AMRIT PRATIK ACHARYA, 14,230,672 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SRINATH RAMAKKRUSHNAN ("PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS"), 22,974,820 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY CREOVATE INNOVATION PRIVATE LIMITED ("PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER"), 17,611,820 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY PEAK XV PARTNERS INVESTMENTS V *(FORMERLY KNOWN AS SCI INVESTMENTS V)*, 12,016,622 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY ACCEL INDIA V (MAURITIUS) LIMITED, 13,529,722 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY LIGHTSPEED VENTURE PARTNERS SELECT IV MAURITIUS, 11,597,361 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY LIGHTSPEED INDIA PARTNERS II, LLC, 12,570,262 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY KAE CAPITAL FUND II, 2,857,565 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SAIFUDDIN FAKHRUDDIN QUREISHI, 5,797,579 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY PEAK XV PARTNERS GROWTH INVESTMENTS III (FORMERLY KNOWN AS SCI GROWTH INVESTMENTS III), 2,442,738 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY MATTHEW HARRIS ARNOLD, 3,145,603 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY LIGHTSPEED INDIA PARTNERS III, LLC, 4,190,105 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY KALYSTA CAPITAL FUND II (MAURITIUS), 409,182 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SUBBIAH VELLAYAN, 408,469 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY A. VENKATACHALAM, 100 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SHIVRAJ SINGH KANDHARI (GUARDIAN, BIKRAMJIT SINGH KANDHARI), 299,402 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY CAN KÖSEOĞLU, 256,630 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY ANDREW RICHARD WOGLOM, 86,129 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY CEM GARIH NAHMIYAS, 83,167 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY NITIN MAHAJAN, 71,286 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY DANIEL ROBERT BACHELET ("INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDERS"), 1,714,539 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY VISHAL CHAUDHARY, 1,714,539 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY RAHUL SHARMA, 2,286,052 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY ANKIT FATEHPURIA ("INDIVIDUAL SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER AND THE INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS") (THE "OFFER FOR SALE" AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES, THE "OFFERED SHARES"). THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO 700,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]%, RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

**ALL OR A CERTAIN PORTION OF THE OFFERED SHARES OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS INCLUDES EQUITY SHARES THAT HAVE BEEN ISSUED UPON CONVERSION OF PREFERENCE SHARES PRIOR TO THE FILING OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS, AS APPLICABLE.*

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE TOP 10 SELLING SHAREHOLDERS

NAME OF SELLING SHAREHOLDER	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OFFERED / AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)**	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
Amrit Pratik Acharya	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 14,230,672 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	Negligible[#]
Srinath Ramakkrushnan	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 14,230,672 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	Negligible[#]
Creovate Innovation Private Limited	Promoter Group Selling Shareholder	Up to 22,974,820 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	178.58
Peak XV Partners Investments V *(Formerly known as SCI Investments V)*	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 17,611,820 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	6.31
Lightspeed Venture Partners Select IV Mauritius	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 13,529,722 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	54.66
Kae Capital Fund II	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 12,570,262 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	3.94
Accel India V (Mauritius) Limited	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 12,016,622 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	7.84
Lightspeed India Partners II, LLC	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,597,361 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	13.97
Peak XV Partners Growth Investments III *(Formerly known as SCI Growth Investments III)*	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 5,797,579 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	46.30
Kalysta Capital Fund II (Mauritius)	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to 4,190,105 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	3.94

***All or a certain portion of the Offered Shares of the Selling Shareholders includes Equity Shares that have been issued upon conversion of Preference Shares prior to the filing of the Red Herring Prospectus, as applicable.*
**As certified by M/s. RADS & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN: 320298E), by way of their certificate dated October 11, 2026 (UDIN: 26303622JKOYCV4719).*
[#]The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share is below ₹0.01.
For the complete list of Selling Shareholders and their details, see "The Offer" on page 78 of the Red Herring Prospectus.

PRICE BAND: ₹143 TO ₹151 PER EQUITY SHARE BEARING FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 143 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 151 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 99 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 99 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹14 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
SINCE COMPANY HAS INCURRED LOSS IN FINANCIAL YEAR 2026 BASED ON RESTATED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL INFORMATION, THE BASIC AND DILUTED EPS IS NEGATIVE, AND HENCE, THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO IS NOT ASCERTAINABLE.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS (15.64)%.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post-Offer market capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹143 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹151 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	197,970,629	28,300.00	187,482,119	28,300.00
Offer for Sale	144,525,036	20,667.08	144,525,036	21,823.28
Total Offer Size*	342,495,665	48,967.08	332,007,155	50,123.28
Post-Offer market capitalization	**1,704,743,288**	**243,778.29**	**1,694,254,778**	**255,832.47**

**Offer size has been calculated considering the Employee Discount of ₹14 per Equity Share at Floor price and Cap price.*

BID/ OFFER PERIOD

BID/OFFER OPEN

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026[(1)]

[(1)]The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

WE ARE A TECHNOLOGY-LED, ASSET-LIGHT MANUFACTURING PLATFORM FOR INDUSTRIAL AND CONSUMER GOODS IN INDIA AND GLOBALLY. WE AGGREGATE MANUFACTURING CAPACITY ACROSS A NETWORK OF THIRD-PARTY SUPPLIERS AND OUR OWN FACILITIES INTO A "UNIVERSAL FACTORY", UNIFIED THROUGH ZETWERK OS, OUR PROPRIETARY TECHNOLOGY BACKBONE.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(2) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 75% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 10% OF THE NET OFFER
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 700,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION.

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY OUR COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED OCTOBER 11, 2026 THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS DISCLOSED IN THE *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 248 OF THE RHP *VIS-A-VIS* THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 248 OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 28 of the RHP

1. **Loss incurred in past period:** We incurred a restated loss for the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively, and certain of our Subsidiaries have incurred losses in the past; any similar losses in the future may adversely affect our business, financial condition and cash flows.

(₹ in million)

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Restated loss before exceptional items and tax from continuing operations	(513.92)	(729.21)	(806.04)	(1,210.02)	(4,266.32)
Exceptional items (net)*	-	(8,032.33)	(8,358.39)	(835.49)	(3,717.73)
Total tax expense/(credit)*	127.37	45.11	479.50	105.18	541.26
Restated loss for the period/year from continuing operations	(641.29)	(8,806.65)	(9,643.93)	(2,150.69)	(8,525.31)
Restated loss for the period/year from discontinued operations	(6,688.54)	(4,878.07)	(6,417.78)	(1,556.39)	(654.18)
Restated loss for the period/year	**(7,329.83)**	**(13,684.72)**	**(16,061.71)**	**(3,707.08)**	**(9,179.49)**

**Represents figures from continuing operations.*

2. **Third-Party Supplier Dependence Risk:** We rely on third-party suppliers for manufacturing and raw materials, and exposure to price volatility, capacity and quality issues, supply disruptions, and trade and foreign exchange risks could adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows, results of operations and prospects.

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	(Percentage of segment revenue from Manufacturing and Ecosystem Business) (in %)	(₹ million)	(Percentage of segment revenue from Manufacturing and Ecosystem Business) (in %)	(₹ million)	(Percentage of segment revenue from Manufacturing and Ecosystem Business) (in %)	(₹ million)	(Percentage of segment revenue from Manufacturing and Ecosystem Business) (in %)	(₹ million)	(Percentage of segment revenue from Manufacturing and Ecosystem Business) (in %)
Revenue from the sale of products sourced from third-party suppliers	31,177.85	75.71%	21,842.46	82.44%	128,032.74	80.46%	95,306.79	84.11%	119,326.11	96.51%
Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business (A)	19,018.82	46.19%	14,808.27	55.89%	93,746.76	58.91%	62,491.02	55.15%	60,818.51	49.19%
Segment revenue - Ecosystem Business (B)	22,159.95	53.81%	11,686.08	44.11%	65,386.47	41.09%	50,827.54	44.85%	62,825.21	50.81%
Segment revenue from Manufacturing Business and Ecosystem Business (A+B)	**41,178.77**	**100.00%**	**26,494.35**	**100.00%**	**159,133.23**	**100.00%**	**113,318.56**	**100.00%**	**123,643.72**	**100.00%**

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3. **End-Industry Dependence Risk:** We are dependent on the performance of the industries our customers operate in, including renewables, artificial intelligence infrastructure, oil & gas, consumer electronics, and defence & aerospace industries. Demand for our products across all three verticals is particularly sensitive to changes in government policies affecting the underlying end industries, including policies related to energy transition, fiscal incentives, domestic manufacturing and trade policies. Any adverse changes in such policies could have an adverse effect on our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	*(Percentage of Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business) (in %)*
Details of Revenue from Manufacturing Business*										
Energy Products	11,342.98	59.64%	8,672.80	58.57%	65,075.72	69.42%	34,818.44	55.72%	41,596.61	68.40%
Precision Products	4,367.40	22.96%	3,357.52	22.67%	13,971.87	14.90%	14,058.55	22.50%	5,809.45	9.55%
Capital Goods	3,303.38	17.37%	2,772.14	18.72%	14,643.97	15.62%	13,532.17	21.65%	13,160.38	21.64%
Other Operating Revenue	5.06	0.03%	5.81	0.04%	55.20	0.06%	81.86	0.13%	252.07	0.41%
Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business**	**19,018.82**	**100.00%**	**14,808.27**	**100.00%**	**93,746.76**	**100.00%**	**62,491.02**	**100.00%**	**60,818.51**	**100.00%**

**Based on disaggregation of revenue as per Ind AS 115 Revenue from Contracts with Customers - Manufacturing Business.*
***Refers to Segment revenue - Manufacturing Business for the period/ year based on Ind AS 108 Operating Segments.*

4. **Geographic Concentration Risk:** We derive a significant portion of our revenue from operations from India and the USA and adverse economic or regulatory changes that negatively affect the demand for our products in such countries could adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*
India*	34,395.05	83.53%	20,476.39	77.29%	131,346.31	82.54%	89,983.67	79.41%	93,265.46	75.43%
USA*	5,260.94	12.77%	5,415.11	20.44%	22,796.69	14.33%	21,626.95	19.09%	26,628.39	21.54%
Rest of the countries*	1,522.78	3.70%	602.85	2.27%	4,990.23	3.13%	1,707.94	1.50%	3,749.87	3.03%
Revenue from operations - continuing operations	**41,178.77**	**100.00%**	**26,494.35**	**100.00%**	**159,133.23**	**100.00%**	**113,318.56**	**100.00%**	**123,643.72**	**100.00%**

**Represents figures from continuing operations.*

5. **Supplier Concentration Risk:** Our top 10 suppliers contributed 40.71%, 37.59%, 38.18%, 39.59% and 36.87% of our total expenses for continuing operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively; any disruption in the supply or quality from these suppliers could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, cash flows, and reputation.

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	*(Percentage of total expenses for continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of total expenses for continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of total expenses for continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of total expenses for continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of total expenses for continuing operations) (in %)*
Top five suppliers	12,855.70	30.33%	7,450.97	27.08%	43,475.50	26.93%	33,972.27	29.41%	34,233.04	26.65%
Top 10 suppliers	17,256.27	40.71%	10,342.11	37.59%	61,631.17	38.18%	45,740.24	39.59%	47,365.88	36.87%

6. **Auditor Observations Risk:** Our Statutory Auditors have included certain emphasis of matters and modifications under the section "Report on Other Legal and Regulatory Requirements" in their auditor reports in the three months periods ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024.
7. **Customer Concentration Risk:** Our growth depends on expanding and retaining our network of customers and if we fail to retain or expand our network of customers, our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations may be adversely affected.

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026		2025		2026		2025		2024	
	(₹ million)	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*	*(₹ million)*	*(Percentage of revenue from operations – continuing operations) (in %)*
Top ten customers*	12,103.63	29.39%	9,078.25	34.26%	57,135.56	35.90%	30,466.97	26.89%	27,658.79	22.37%
Revenue from operations - continuing operations	**41,178.77**	**-**	**26,494.35**	**-**	**159,133.23**	**-**	**113,318.56**	**-**	**123,643.72**	**-**

**Represents figures from continuing operations.*

8. **Product Quality and Liability Risk:** We are subject to strict performance and quality requirements. Defects, perceived defects or failures to meet customer specifications, whether attributable to us or our suppliers, could result in order cancellations, recalls, liability and reputational harm.
9. **Global Manufacturing Footprint Risk:** As of June 30, 2026 we operated 26 own manufacturing facilities across India, Spain, the USA and Germany. Any adverse changes in economic or regulatory conditions affecting our supply chains in these jurisdictions could negatively affect our results of operations.
10. **Customer Order Visibility Risk:** We do not have firm, long-term purchase commitments with many of our customers. Our purchase orders are typically short-term and may be amended, rescheduled or cancelled, and customer forecasts are non-binding. Any order reductions, cancellations or delays may adversely affect our revenue visibility, capacity utilisation and margins.
11. **Offer Related Risk:** The Offer also consists of an offer for sale aggregating up to ₹ 21,823.28 million (approximately 43.54% of the Offer Size at upper end of the Price Band), the proceeds of which will not be available to our Company.
12. Our Company proposes to utilise an estimated amount of ₹21,600 million from the Net Proceeds towards repayment/ prepayment, in part or full, of all or a portion of certain borrowings availed by our Company and investing in certain of our Subsidiaries, in order to repay/ prepay in full or in part, certain or all of the borrowings availed by these Subsidiaries. Considering that the Net Proceeds will be utilised towards repayment of borrowings of our Subsidiaries, namely (i) Sharp Tanks and Structurals Private Limited; (ii) Terra91 International Private Limited; (iii) Smile Electronics Limited; (iv) Kryfs Power Components Limited; (v) Kryfs Transformers Private Limited; (vi) Unimacts Global LLC; (vii) Zetwerk Manufacturing SG Pte. Ltd.; (viii) Zap91 Solar India Private Limited; and (ix) Zet Town India Private Limited ("**Specified Subsidiaries**"), our Company shall deploy the Net Proceeds, to the extent of ₹8,600 million, for this Object in the form of debt investments, which involve extending inter-corporate loans to the Specified Subsidiaries. In relation to such inter-corporate loans, the key terms include interest rates up to 12% per annum subject to applicable annual arms' length benchmarking, a tenure of up to five years, being unsecured in nature, and do not include any prepayment charges.
13. Our diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026 is ₹(6.69); accordingly, the Price/Earning (P/E) ratio is not ascertainable. The market capitalisation to revenue from operations ratio for Fiscal 2026 at the upper end of the Price Band is 1.61 times. There are no listed companies in India or globally which operate in a similar business model as ours.
14. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is (15.64)%.
15. **The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share by the Selling Shareholders as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows and upper end of the Price Band is ₹ 151 per Equity Share:**

Name	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each*# (in ₹ per Equity Share)##
Promoter Selling Shareholders		
Amrit Pratik Acharya	115,526,710	Negligible^^
Srinath Ramakkrushnan	128,355,830	Negligible^^
Promoter Group Selling Shareholder		
Creovate Innovation Private Limited	33,598,711	178.58
Investor Selling Shareholders		
Peak XV Partners Investments V *(formerly known as SCI Investments V)*	140,032,098	6.31
Lightspeed Venture Partners Select IV Mauritius	72,314,953	54.66
Kae Capital Fund II	55,669,714	3.94
Accel India V (Mauritius) Limited	118,729,425	7.84
Lightspeed India Partners II, LLC	57,504,145	13.97
Peak XV Partners Growth Investments III *(formerly known as SCI Growth Investments III)*	46,095,987	46.30
Kalysta Capital Fund II (Mauritius)	18,560,533	3.94
Lightspeed India Partners III, LLC	21,704,250	42.28
Saifuddin Fakhruddin Qureishi	10,904,477	178.58
Matthew Harris Arnold	2,442,738	157.87
Name	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each*# (in ₹ per Equity Share)##
Subbiah Vellayan	1,363,941	8.88
A. Venkatachalam	1,361,564	8.89
Shivraj Singh Kandhari (Guardian, Bikramjit Singh Kandhari)	439,308	182.10
Can Köseoğlu	299,402	130.34
Andrew Richard Woglom	256,630	157.87
Cem Garih Nahmiyas	299,402	130.34
Nitin Mahajan	166,334	12.92
Daniel Robert Bachelet	71,286	157.87
Individual Selling Shareholders		
Rahul Sharma	20,429,816	0.06**
Vishal Chaudhary	5,261,761	0.23**
Ankit Fatehpuria	18,452,429	0.18**

**As certified by M/s. RADS & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN: 320298E), by way of their certificate dated October 11, 2026 (UDIN: 26303622JKOYCV4719).*
^^ The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share is below ₹0.01.
 # The consideration paid towards the acquisition of CCPS has been factored into the computation of the average cost of acquisition per Equity Share in respect of the conversion of CCPS undertaken.
*** The Selling Shareholders were allotted Equity Shares on December 18, 2019 and September 22, 2020 at issue prices of ₹28,687.41 and ₹49,926 per Equity Share, respectively, as per filings with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. However, such Shareholders had paid ₹1 per Equity Share and accordingly, the same has been considered.*
The consideration paid towards the acquisition of OCRPS has been factored into the computation of the weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share in respect of the conversion of OCRPS undertaken.

16. **Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in the three years, 18 months and one year immediately preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:**

Period	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition	Range of acquisition price per Equity Share: Lowest Price – Highest Price (in ₹)
Last one year	53.46	2.82	0.22 – 282.94
Last 18 months	52.12	2.90	0.22 – 282.94
Last three years	51.75	2.92	0.22 – 282.94

As certified by M/s. RADS & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN: 320298E), by way of their certificate dated October 11, 2026 (UDIN: 26303622JKOYCV4719).

17. **The 7 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 109 public issues in the past three years, out of which 29 issues closed below the issue price on the listing date.**

Name of the BRLMs	Total Public Issues	Issues closed below the issue price on listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	11	1
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	3	-
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
Avendus Capital Private Limited*	1	-
JM Financial Limited*	30	9
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	3	1
Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited*	14	4
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	47	14
Total	**109**	**29**

**Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.*

Continued on next page...

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. **Our Company has not undertaken pre-IPO placement from the Updated Draft Red Herring Prospectus - I till date.**
2. **The Promoters or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of our Company from the Pre-filed Draft Red Herring Prospectus till date.**

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

*(The "**Basis for Offer Price**" beginning on page 248 of the RHP has been updated in the price band advertisement published on October 11, 2026. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs:* https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, https://www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com, respectively, *for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated with the above Price Band.)* (you may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited)

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/ Offer Period (except the Bid/ Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Bid/ Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) - For Retail Individual Bidders	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹0.50 million	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification/ revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Bid/Offer Closing Date, i.e. Monday, October 19, 2026.*
#QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.

Bid/ Offer programme

EVENT	INDICATIVE DATE
Anchor Investor Bidding Date	Wednesday, October 14, 2026
Bid/Offer Opened on	Thursday, October 15, 2026
Bid/Offer Closes on	Monday, October 19, 2026[1]
Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Thursday, October 22, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Thursday, October 22, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Friday, October 23, 2026

[1] UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Bid/ Offer Closing Date, i.e. Monday, October 19, 2026.
**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of nonallotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Offer BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by the UPI Bidders may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which has prescribed that all individual investors applying in initial public offerings opening on or after May 1, 2022, where the application amount is up to ₹ 0.50 million, shall use UPI. RIBs and individual investors Bidding under the Non-Institutional Portion Bidding for more than ₹ 0.20 million and up to ₹ 0.50 million, using the UPI Mechanism, shall provide their UPI ID in the Bid-cum-Application Form for Bidding through Syndicate, sub-syndicate members, Registered Brokers, RTAs or CDPs, or online using the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account (3 in 1 type accounts), provided by certain brokers. The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular.*

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non - Institutional Investor applying for amount upto ₹ 500,000/-, applying through Registered Brokers, DPs and RTAs. UPI Bidder also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except anchor investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in ASBA form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 663 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended for at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of *force majeure,* banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

This is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in compliance with Regulation 6(2) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein in terms of Regulation 32(2) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations not less than 75% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**" and such portion the "**QIB Portion**") provided that our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, have allocated up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), of which 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion within the 60% of allocation of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors, was reserved in the following manner: (i) 33.33% was reserved for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% was reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds. In the event of under-subscription in the reserved category for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, the balance Equity Shares was allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (excluding the Anchor Investor Portion) ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not more than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders ("**NIBs**") of which (a) one- third portion shall be reserved for Bidders with application size of more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹1.00 million; and (b) two-thirds of the portion shall be reserved for Bidders with application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in other sub-category of the NIBs in accordance with SEBI ICDR Regulations and not more than 10% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees applying under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price (net of employee discount). All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable to participate in the Net Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Net Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 663 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 362 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, please see the section titled "***Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection***" on page 719 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares

Amount of share capital of our Company and Capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹ 47,403,412,496 divided into 45,605,618,966 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each, ₹ 487,050 divided into 48,705 Series A CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 643,460 divided into 64,346 Series A1 CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 731,270 divided into 73,127 Series B CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 445,660 divided into 44,566 Series C CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 845,220 divided into 84,522 Series D CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 449,630 divided into 44,963 Series E CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 421,300 divided into 42,130 Series F CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 13,460,000 divided into 1,346,000 Series F1 CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 278,109,170 divided into 27,810,917 Series F2 CCPS of face value of ₹10 each, ₹ 1,502,200,770 divided into 150,220,077 Series F3 CCPS of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of our Company is ₹ 1,506,772,659 divided into 1,506,772,659 Equity shares of face value ₹1 each. For details, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** on page 123 of the RHP.

Names of signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company are: Balaraman Ramakkrushnan and Srinath Ramakkrushnan. For details of the share capital history of our Company, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 123 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated June 8, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been delivered to the RoC in accordance with Section 32 of the Companies Act, 2013, and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Section 26(4) of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see ***"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"*** on page 719 of the RHP

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities or the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 629 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 635 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to page 635 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General Risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the Bidders is invited to ***"Risk Factors"*** on page 28 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27BKC, Plot No. C–27, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East)
Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: zetwerk.ipo@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration Number: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40, Pandurang Budhkar Marg,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: zetwerkipo@morganstanley.com
Website: www.morganstanley.com/india
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors_india@morganstanley.com
Contact Person: Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration Number: INM000011203

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli, Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, India
Tel: +91 22 6618 9000
E-mail: zetwerkipo@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Contact Person: Rohan Johar / Saurav S
SEBI Registration Number: INM000011054

Avendus Capital Private Limited
Platina Building, 9th Floor 901, Plot No C-59
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6648 0050
E-mail: zetwerk.ipo@avendus.com
Website: https://www.avendus.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@avendus.com
Contact Person: Sarthak Sawa / Sneha Roy
SEBI Registration Number: INM000011021

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: + 91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: zetwerk.ipo@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration Number: INM000010361

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001, Maharashtra, India
Tel: + 91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: zetwerkipo@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar / Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration Number: INM000010353

Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited
Pantomath Nucleus House, Saki Vihar Road, Andheri East,
Mumbai - 400 072, Maharashtra, India
Tel: 1800 889 8711
Email: zetwerk.ipo@pantomathgroup.com
Website: www.pantomathcapital.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors@pantomathgroup.com
Contact Person: Amit Maheshwari
SEBI Registration Number: INM000012110

REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER

KFin Technologies Limited
301, The Centrium, 3rd Floor, 57, Lal Bahadur Shastri Road,
Nav Pada, Kurla (West), Mumbai - 400 070, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 40 6716 2222/180 0309 4001
E-mail: zetwerk.ipo@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R.
SEBI Registration No: INR000000221

COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER

Mania Sarkar
#84/1, Ground & 1st Floor, Vaishnavi Sovereign, Green Glen Layout
Bellandur, Bengaluru South, Bengaluru - 560 103, Karnataka, India
Tel: +91 7624 9748 90
E-mail: cs@zetwerk.com

Bidders can contact our Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related queries, grievances and for redressal of complaints including queries, grievances and for redressal of complaints including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 28 of the RHP, before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, and on the website of the Company at www.zetwerk.com and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Avendus Capital Private Limited, JM Financial Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited and Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, https://www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at www.zetwerk.com, https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, https://www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED** *(formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited)*, **Tel:** +91 7624 9748 90; **BRLMs: Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Tel:** +91 22 4336 0000, **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6118 1000, **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6618 9000, **Avendus Capital Private Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6648 0050, **JM Financial Limited, Tel:** + 91 22 6630 3030, **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, Tel:** + 91 22 6864 1289 and **Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited, Tel:** 1800 889 8711 and **Syndicate Members: Kotak Securities Limited, Tel:** + 91 22 4285 8484, **Spark Institutional Equities Private Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6885 4503 / +91 44 4344 0078 / +91 99209 31711, **JM Financial Services Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6136 3400 and **Asit C. Mehta Investment Interrmediates Limited, Tel:** +91 22 2858 3333; +91 97699 89513 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members: 360 ONE WAM Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Axis Capital Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Centrum Finverse Ltd, Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited, IIFL Wealth Management Limited, India Infoline Limited, Innovate Securities Pvt. Ltd., Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Keynote Capital Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Mirae Asset Sharekhan, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited, PL Capital, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Limited, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SKSE SECURITIES LTD, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited.

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

Escrow Collection Bank: ICICI Bank Limited • **Refund Bank and Public Offer Account Bank :** Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited • **Sponsor Banks :** Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED**
(formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited)
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Mania Sarkar
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Bengaluru, Karnataka
Date: October 15, 2026

ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED *(formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited)* is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with SEBI, RoC, Bengaluru at Karnataka and the Stock Exchanges on October 11, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.zetwerk.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Avendus Capital Private Limited, JM Financial Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited and Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, https://www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 28 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the UDRHP- I filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "**U.S. Securities Act**") or any other applicable law of the United States and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold (a) to persons in the United States that are reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act; or (b) outside the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

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HT MUMBAI

Friday, October 16, 2026

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Nifty defies AI selloff as heavyweights flex muscle ▶P1

India's merchandise trade deficit widens in Sep ▶P2

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Initial Public Offer of equity shares on the main board of BSE Limited (**"BSE"**) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited **("NSE"**, and together with BSE, the **"Stock Exchanges"**) in compliance with Chapter II of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018, as amended ("**SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS**").

(Please scan this QR Code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

Bonfiglioli
We engineer dreams

BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was originally incorporated as 'Bonfiglioli Deepak Private Limited' at Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India, as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated June 23, 1998, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu at Chennai ("**RoC**"). Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed from 'Bonfiglioli Deepak Private Limited' to 'Bonfiglioli Transmissions Private Limited', pursuant to a Board resolution dated August 31, 1998, a Shareholders' resolution dated September 15, 1998, and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon change of name dated September 25, 1998 issued by the RoC. The name of our Company was changed to 'Bonfiglioli Transmissions Limited', pursuant to a Board resolution dated June 26, 2025, Shareholders' resolution dated September 1, 2025 and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon conversion to public company dated September 16, 2025 issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For details, see ***"History and Certain Corporate Matters - Brief History of our Company"*** on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 9, 2026, read with the Corrigendum to the red herring prospectus dated October 10, 2026 (**"RHP"** or **"Red Herring Prospectus"**) filed with the RoC.

Registered and Corporate Office: Plot No. AC7-AC11, SIDCO Industrial Estate, Thirumudivakkam, Kancheepuram - 600 132, Tamil Nadu, India
Contact Person: Sunil Kumar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **Tel:** +91 63858 63934, **E-mail:** btl.secretarial@bonfiglioli.com; **Website:** www.bonfiglioli.in; **Corporate Identity Number:** U29309TN1998PLC040717

OUR PROMOTERS: SONIA BONFIGLIOLI, LUCIANO BONFIGLIOLI, LUISA LUSARDI, BON-FI S.R.L., AND BONFIGLIOLI S.P.A.

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 43,239,042 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] MILLION THROUGH AN OFFER FOR SALE (THE "OFFER") OF UP TO 43,239,042 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "OFFER FOR SALE" AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES, THE "OFFERED SHARES") BY BONFIGLIOLI S.P.A. ("PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER"). THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO 50,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMS MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO ₹ 29 OF THE OFFER PRICE TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"), SUBJECT TO NECESSARY APPROVALS AS MAY BE REQUIRED. THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY.

DETAILS OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDER AND THE OFFERED SHARES

Name of the Selling Shareholder	Type	Maximum Number of Offered Shares	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition Per Equity Share (₹)[(1)]
Bonfiglioli S.p.A.	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 43,239,042 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating to ₹ [●] million	6.77

[(1)]As certified by J.C. Bhalla & Co., Chartered Accountants, (FRN No. 001111N) by way of their certificate dated October 10, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹558 TO ₹586 PER EQUITY SHARE BEARING FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 55.8 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 58.6 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 25 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 25 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH THEREAFTER.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹29 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS (P/E RATIO) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2025 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 46.32 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 44.11 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 51.61 TIMES.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 22.45%

The details of the Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post-Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹558 per Equity Share (₹ in million)		At Cap Price of ₹586 per Equity Share (₹ in million)	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable
Offer for Sale	43,239,042	24,125.94*	43,239,042	25,336.63*
Total Offer Size	43,239,042	24,125.94	43,239,042	25,336.63
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	187,995,834	104,901.68	187,995,834	110,165.56

**Offer size has been calculated considering a discount of ₹29 each at floor price and cap price.*

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME

BID/OFFER OPEN

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026[(1)]

[(1)]UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

WE MANUFACTURE MISSION-CRITICAL, PRECISION-ENGINEERED GEAR MOTORS, GEARBOXES AND DRIVE SYSTEMS FOR DIVERSE END-USER MARKETS. OFFERINGS INCLUDE HELICAL, BEVEL, PLANETARY AND WORM GEARBOXES AND GEAR MOTORS, ELECTRIC MOTORS, VARIABLE FREQUENCY DRIVES, SERVO MOTORS AND DRIVES, PRECISION DRIVES FOR ROBOTICS & AUTOMATION, AND SWING, TRACK, DRUM, MIXER, WHEEL, AUGER, CONVEYOR, CUTTER, HOIST, YAW AND PITCH DRIVES.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE AND NSE. BSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 50,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION.

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED OCTOBER 10, 2026 THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS DISCLOSED IN THE *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 109 OF THE RHP *VIS-A-VIS* THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 109 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 20 of the RHP

1. **Risk related to supplier dependencies:** We depend on a limited number of suppliers for procurement of raw materials and components required for our manufacturing operations. Our largest supplier is Bonfiglioli Riduttori S.p.A, a related party. Purchases from our related parties represented 15.53%, 16.75%, 15.18%, 17.00% and 19.98%, and purchases from our top 10 suppliers represented 40.84%, 41.74%, 41.20%, 45.62% and 47.52% of our total purchases of raw materials and components in the six months periods ended June 30, 2026 and 2025 and in Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively. As we do not have definitive agreements with our suppliers, any interruption in the availability of raw materials and components on account of any disruption, breakdown or shutdown of our suppliers' operations could adversely impact our operations.
2. **Risk related to cost of Raw material:** Our ability to manufacture gearboxes at competitive prices depends on the continued availability of parts and materials including motors, gears, machined parts and other commercial components required for our manufacturing operations, at prices acceptable to us. The cost of such raw materials and components are typically tied to their underlying raw materials such as steel, aluminium and cast iron. As a result, our operations and our suppliers' ability to provide parts and materials to us at competitive prices is affected by global commodity prices, inflation and our ability to negotiate with our suppliers effectively. Continued or significant fluctuations in the cost of commodities, supply interruptions or shortages could cause our suppliers to increase their costs, which in turn may have an adverse impact on our ability to manufacture our gearboxes in line with targeted costs. Any increase in the prices of raw materials and components required for our operations or levy of duties on the materials we import for our operations, could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations, and cash flows.
3. **Risk related to Operations:** Any unscheduled, unplanned or prolonged disruption of operations at our manufacturing facilities could materially and adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.
4. **Risk related to quality of Product/service:** Any actual or perceived defects in our gearboxes and drive systems or the sales and after-sale services provided through dealers or third parties may adversely impact our brand, reputation, and ability to sell our products, which could have an adverse impact on our operations.
5. **Risk related to dependence on Promoter:** We depend on BSPA, one of our Corporate Promoters, for certain aspects of our operations, including the license to manufacture and sell products under its intellectual property including the "Bonfiglioli" trade name and trademark for which we pay a consideration of 6% of our annual sales of the specified products (excluding sales to BSPA and net of discounts and allowances). Any adverse change in our relationship with BSPA could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition, results of operations, cash flows and reputation.
6. **Risk related to dependence on Promoter & Group Companies:** We depend on BSPA, one of our Corporate Promoters, and other companies in the Bonfiglioli Group for certain aspects of our operations including administrative and corporate services. Any adverse change in our relationship with BSPA and the companies in the Bonfiglioli Group could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition, results of operations, cash flows and reputation.
7. **Risk related to related party transactions:** We have entered into and will continue to enter into related party transactions with BSPA and companies within the Bonfiglioli Group that may involve conflicts of interest, which could adversely impact our business. The arithmetic aggregate absolute total of income from related parties represented 19.91%, 14.29%, 15.59%, 17.66% and 17.70% of our total income in the six months periods ended June 30, 2026 and 2025 and in Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively, while the arithmetic aggregate absolute total of expenses from related parties represented 32.71%, 32.38%, 24.83%, 25.20% and 28.66% of our total expenses in the six months periods ended June 30, 2026 and 2025 and in Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively.
8. **Risk related to Customer concentration:** We depend on a limited number of customers for our sales, and revenue from our top 10 OEM customers represented 31.72%, 37.83%, 36.60%, 34.38% and 32.82% of our total revenue from operations (continuing operations) in the six months periods ended June 30, 2026 and 2025 and in Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively. As we do not have long-term binding agreements with all our customers, any reduction in orders from, or loss of, any of our major customers could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.

Particulars	For the six months period ended June 30, 2026	For the six months period ended June 30, 2025	For the year ended December 31, 2025	For the year ended December 31, 2024	For the year ended December 31, 2023
Revenue from largest customer as a % of revenue from customers-continuing operations	9.40%	11.60%	11.43%	9.92%	7.48%
Revenue from top-five customers as a % of revenue from customers-continuing operations	25.29%	29.86%	28.77%	26.17%	23.43%
Revenue from top-10 customers as a % of revenue from customers-continuing operations	31.72%	37.83%	36.60%	34.38%	32.82%

9. **Risk related to co-engineered products:** Failure to successfully commercialise co-engineered products could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations, and cash flows.

Particulars	For the six months period ended June 30, 2026		For the six months period ended June 30, 2025		For the year ended December 31, 2025		For the year ended December 31, 2024		For the year ended December 31, 2023	
	Amount (₹ million)	*Percentage of total revenue from operations – continuing operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations – continuing operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations – continuing operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations – continuing operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations – continuing operations (%)*
Revenue from co-engineer products	5,980.50	52.84%	5,185.82	54.00%	10,817.98	53.73%	9,948.37	53.65%	8,886.26	52.66%

10. **Risk related to dependency on Dealer network:** We partly depend on our dealer network for the sale of our gearboxes and the provision of services, including after-sale services to customers under our Industry & Automation Solutions ("I&A") vertical. Any disruption in this network could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations, and cash flows.
The table below sets forth channel-wise split of sales for the periods/years indicated:

Sales Channel	Six months period ended June 30, 2026		Six months period ended June 30, 2025		Year ended December 31, 2025		Year ended December 31, 2024		Year ended December 31, 2023	
	Amount (₹ million)	*Percentage of total revenue from operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations (%)*	*Amount (₹ million)*	*Percentage of total revenue from operations (%)*
Dealer sales	2,145.72	18.96%	1,865.11	19.42%	3,909.41	19.42%	3,535.58	19.07%	3,333.07	19.75%
Direct sales	6,741.06	59.56%	6,210.11	64.66%	12,746.32	63.30%	11,756.65	63.41%	10,556.18	62.56%
Inter-company sales[(1)]	2,263.99	20.00%	1,294.75	13.48%	3,064.77	15.22%	2,775.09	14.97%	2,722.21	16.13%
Others[(2)]	167.92	1.48%	233.59	2.44%	414.76	2.06%	474.51	2.56%	261.84	1.55%
Total	**11,318.69**	**100.00%**	**9,603.55**	**100.00%**	**20,135.26**	**100.00%**	**18,541.83**	**100.00%**	**16,873.30**	**100.00%**

Notes: [(1)]Inter-company sales includes sale of finished goods such as yaw drives and swing drives to related parties for onward sale to their customers. [(2)]Others includes non-core sales such as the sale of components to vendors.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

11. Our EBITDA (excluding Other Income) Margin and PAT Margin were the lowest among our listed industry peers in Fiscals 2024 and 2023, and lower than certain of our listed industry peers in Fiscal 2025. Our inability to improve our operating and profitability margins in the future may adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows, and our ability to compete effectively with our listed peers.
12. The Price/Earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for 2025 for the issuer at the upper end of the Price band is as high as 46.32 as compared to the average industry peer group PE ratio of 51.61
13. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscal 2023,2024 and 2025 is 22.45%
14. **Weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in the one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus:** The weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as set forth below:

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)#	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price per Equity Share: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year	Nil	NA	Nil to Nil
Last eighteen months	Nil	NA	Nil to Nil
Last three years	Nil	NA	Nil to Nil

*As certified by J.C. Bhalla & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN No. 001111N), by way of their certificate dated October 10, 2026.

#Computed based on the Equity Shares acquired/allotted/purchased - There were no acquisitions or purchases of Equity Shares during the period other than allotment pursuant to the bonus issue on January 25, 2026.

15. The 4 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 104 public issues in the past three years, out of which 29 issues closed below the issue price on listing date:

Name of BRLMs	Total Issues	Issues closed below IPO Price as on listing date
Axis Capital Limited*	30	7
BNP Paribas*	1	0
ICICI Securities Limited*	31	14
Jefferies India Private Limited*	4	1
Common Issues of all BRLMs	38	7
Total	**104**	**29**

*Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. Our Company has not undertaken pre-IPO placement from the date of the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoters or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the DRHP till date.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

*(The "**Basis for Offer Price**" beginning on page 109 of the RHP has been updated as below. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs:* www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com and www.jefferies.com, respectively, *for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated with the above Price Band.)* (You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of **Axis Capital Limited**)

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIIs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications of QIBs and NIIs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

*UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date

#QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.

Bid/ Offer Period

EVENT	INDICATIVE DATE
Anchor Investor Bidding Date	Wednesday, October 14, 2026
Bid/ Offer Opened on(1)	Thursday, October 15, 2026
Bid/ Offer Closes on(2)(3)	Monday, October 19, 2026
Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Thursday, October 22, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to demat accounts of Allottees	On or about Thursday, October 22, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Friday, October 23, 2026

(1) *Our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider participation by Anchor Investors in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Anchor Investor Bid/Offer Opening Date will be one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Opening Date.*

(2) *Our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations.*

(3) *UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on Bid/Offer Closing Date.*

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date till date of actual unblock, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from three Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the intermediary responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. Further, the Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Master Circular.

ASBA# **Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!**

Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account, For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non - Institutional Investor applying for amount upto ₹ 500,000/-, applying through Registered Brokers, DPs and RTAs. UPI Bidder also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except anchor investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in ASBA form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 441 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period shall be extended for at least three additional Working Days after such revision of the Price Band, subject to the total Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of *force majeure,* banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company, may in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band, and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges by issuing a public notice and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Members of the Syndicate and by intimation to the Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

The Offer is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended (the "**SCRR**"), read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in accordance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIBs (the "**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors and the basis of such allocation will be on a discretionary basis by our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations (the "**Anchor Investor Portion**"), of which, 40% shall be reserved in the following manner, (I) 33.33% shall be available for allocation to domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% shall be available for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which allocation is made to Anchor Investors ("**Anchor Investor Allocation Price**"). In the event of under-subscription in (ii) above, the allocation may be made to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than the Anchor Investor Portion) ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors), including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Investors ("**Non-Institutional Portion**") of which one-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 and under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. Further, not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Investors ("**Retail Portion**"), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees applying under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) shall mandatorily participate in this Offer only through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process and shall provide details of their respective bank account (including UPI ID (defined hereinafter) in case of UPI Bidders (defined hereinafter)) in which the Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or the Sponsor Bank(s), as the case may be. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 441 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, please see the section titled "***Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection***" on page 500 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares

Amount of share capital of our Company and Capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of the Company is ₹ 1,879,958,340 divided into 187,995,834 Equity shares of face value of ₹ 10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of the Company is ₹ 1,879,958,340 divided into 187,995,834 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For details, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** on page 93 of the RHP.

Names of signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: K Balasubramanian and M S Natesan. For details of the share capital history of our Company, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 93 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received in-principle approvals from BSE and NSE for listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated March 19, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, BSE shall be the Designated Stock Exchange. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Section 32 and Section 26(4) of the Companies Act. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/Offer Closing Date, see ***"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"*** on page 500 of the RHP

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities or the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 412 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 418 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to page 417 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General Risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in this Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in this Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of the Issuer and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to ***"Risk Factors"*** on page 20 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS				REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
AXIS CAPITAL	BNP PARIBAS	ICICI Securities	Jefferies	MUFG Intime	
Axis Capital Limited Axis House, 1st Floor, P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 22 4325 2183 **E-mail:** bonfiglioli.ipo@axiscap.in **Investor grievance e-mail:** complaints@axiscap.in **Website:** www.axiscapital.co.in **Contact person:** Devika Kanani **SEBI registration no.:** INM000012029	**BNP Paribas** 1 North Avenue, Maker Maxity Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E) Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 22 3370 4000 **E-mail:** list.cib.bonfiglioliipo@asia.bnpparibas.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com **Website:** www.bnpparibas.co.in **Contact Person:** Arpit Arora **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011534	**ICICI Securities Limited** ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 22 6807 7100 **E-mail:** bonfiglioltransmissions.ipo@icicisecurities.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** customercare@icicisecurities.com **Website:** www.icicisecurities.com **Contact Person:** Shri Subramanyam / Namrata Ravasia **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011179	**Jefferies India Private Limited** Level 16, Express Towers, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 22 4356 6000 **E-mail:** bonfiglioli.transmission.ipo@jefferies.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** jipl.grievance@jefferies.com **Website:** www.jefferies.com **Contact Person:** Akshat Shah / Siddharth Dalmia **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011443	**MUFG Intime India Private Limited** *(Formerly, Link Intime India Private Limited)* C-101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400 083, Maharashtra, India **Tel:** +91 810 811 4949 **E-mail:** bonfiglioltransmissions.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Investor Grievance e-mail:** bonfiglioltransmissions.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com **Contact Person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan **SEBI Registration No.:** INR000004058	**Sunil Kumar** Plot No.AC7-AC11, SIDCO Industrial Estate Thirumudivakkam, Kancheepuram - 600 132 Tamil Nadu, India **Tel:** +91 63858 63934 **E-mail:** btl.secretarial@bonfiglioli.com Bidders can contact our Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related queries, grievances and for redressal of complaints including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 20 of the RHP, before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, and on the website of the Company at www.bonfiglioli.in and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. Axis Capital Limited, BNP Paribas, ICICI Securities Limited and Jefferies India Private Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com and www.jefferies.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at www.bonfiglioli.in, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.jefferies.com and www.in.mpms.mufg.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED, Tel:** +91 63858 63934; **BRLMs : Axis Capital Limited, Tel:** +91 22 4325 2183, **BNP Paribas, Tel:** +91 22 3370 4000, **ICICI Securities Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6807 7100 and **Jefferies India Private Limited, Tel:** +91 22 4356 6000 and **Syndicate Members:** N.A., and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members: Axis Securities Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, BNP Paribas, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, HDFC Securities Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Jefferies India Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, JM Financial Services Limited, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Pvt. Ltd, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, RR Equity Brokers Pvt Limited, SBICap Securities Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Trade Bulls Securities (P) Ltd, Yes Securities (India) Limited

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: ICICI Bank Limited • **Public Offer Account Bank :** Axis Bank Limited • **Sponsor Banks :** ICICI Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Sunil Kumar
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Thirumudivakkam, Tamil Nadu
Date: October 15, 2026

BONFIGLIOLI TRANSMISSIONS LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with SEBI, RoC, Tamil Nadu at Chennai and the Stock Exchanges on October 9, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.bonfiglioli.in and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., Axis Capital Limited, BNP Paribas, ICICI Securities Limited and Jefferies India Private Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com and www.jefferies.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 20 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act or any state securities laws of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (a) in the United States only to persons reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in and in reliance on Rule 144A) and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "U.S. QIBs"; for the avoidance of doubt, the term U.S. QIBs does not refer to a category of institutional investor defined under applicable Indian regulations and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "QIBs" in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in reliance on Rule 144A and (b) in "offshore transactions" as defined in, and in reliance on, Regulation S and in compliance with the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

HT MUMBAI VOL. 9 NO. 248

Friday, October 16, 2026

mint

Think Ahead. Think Growth.

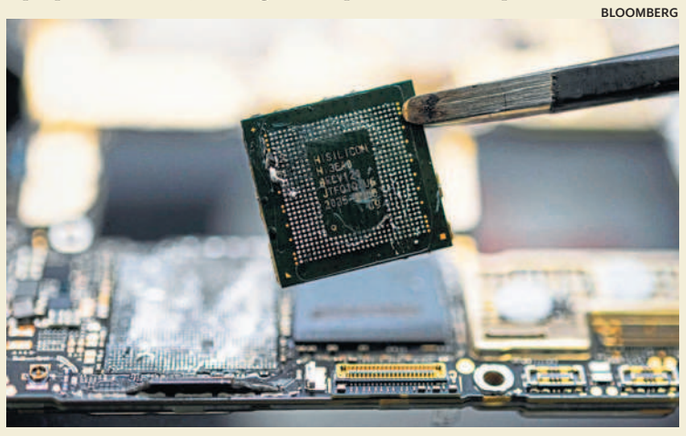
mint primer

How chipflation left buyers with fewer bargains

BY SHELLEY SINGH

The global semiconductor market is seeing an unusual surge in prices. Rising AI demand, tight supplies of chips, and capacity shifts towards high-bandwidth memory are pushing up costs for smartphones, laptops and servers, leading to a chipflation. *Mint* explains:

BLOOMBERG



1 Why are memory chip prices rising?

The AI boom has created an insatiable appetite for data centre infrastructure, a large consumer of high-end chips. Samsung, Micron, SK Hynix and other suppliers have diverted standard wafer production capacity towards high-bandwidth memory (HBM) and enterprise SSDs or solid state devices, for storage. It has starved the consumer electronics market, triggering up to 400% DRAM (memory chip) price hikes since 2024. Beyond memory, other chip prices are becoming dearer. Advanced foundries such as Taiwan's TSMC are increasing node costs, prompting major suppliers, including Intel and AMD, to raise hardware prices.

2 What is the impact on firms and consumers?

Enterprise customers face higher costs as memory has become one of the most expensive hardware components. In a post on X, Zoho founder Sridhar Vembu said the four-fold increase in server prices, higher memory and AI token costs (price of using AI) make business conditions challenging. According to Counterpoint Research, smartphone prices in India rose 16% on average in the first half of 2026. A weaker rupee has also made imported components more expensive, leaving most brands with little choice but to raise prices. Phones priced below ₹10,000 saw the sharpest hikes, averaging around 32%.

BLOOMBERG

3 Will local production help cool prices?

Domestic facilities, including Kaynes Technology, Tata Electronics, and Micron's ATMP plant focus on assembly, testing, marking and packaging (ATMP/OSAT) or specialized fabrication nodes, rather than the raw fabrication of leading-edge consumer DRAM or advanced HBM wafers, which are driving the shortage. They can't cool short-term global prices.

4 What coping measures are firms adopting?

From mid-2025 to now, memory and storage component prices have surged 300%, according to IDC. Nvidia chips have become dearer by 60-100%. Firms are responding by increasing device prices. Apple even raised prices on older models by 14-18%. Smartphone brands are selectively raising prices, adjusting specifications and focusing on high-margin premium products. Large cloud providers and OEMs are signing long-term supply deals. Data centres are improving utilization rates to extract more value from existing hardware.

5 When will prices come down?

Prices are expected to remain elevated till end 2027, although the pace of increases will moderate. Taiwan-based market intelligence firm TrendForce recently projected continued memory price increases, albeit at lower rates. Analysts point to a structural shortage rather than a traditional cyclical spike because chipmakers continue reallocating capacity towards AI-related products. Relief will depend on availability of new capacity and a better balance between AI and conventional demand.

QUICK EDIT

Stability question

As pile-ups of sovereign debt scale new peaks in rich economies, a question that has the air of an elephant in the room has arisen. Will policymakers, willy-nilly, inflate their burden away by letting inflation rip? In the US, the cost of living rose 3.7% in September over the previous year, up from 3.4% in August. It's the US Federal Reserve's job to rein this variable back to its 2% target, but the White House seems to see no case for the central bank to hike lending rates to that end. Although the Fed went for a defiant hike last month, how this standoff plays out is under global watch, given the dollar's centrality to the world of finance. In contrast, the eurozone has a structural advantage on price stability. While euro-using countries can run large fiscal deficits and let their debt bloat, as France has done, monetary policy is centralized in the European Central Bank. On paper, this means no single government can lessen what it owes by reducing the currency's real value. In truth, tension between a common euro authority and diverse fiscal policies could strain Eurozone cohesion amid rising capital costs. In both cases, the world would be better off if they opt to keep general price levels firmly in check.

QUOTE OF THE DAY

We expect a $1.4 trillion digital economy by FY31; we will take a huge market share of this.

AKASH AMBANI
MANAGING DIRECTOR, JIO PLATFORMS

Ambani was speaking ahead of the anticipated public listing of the company.

INSIDE

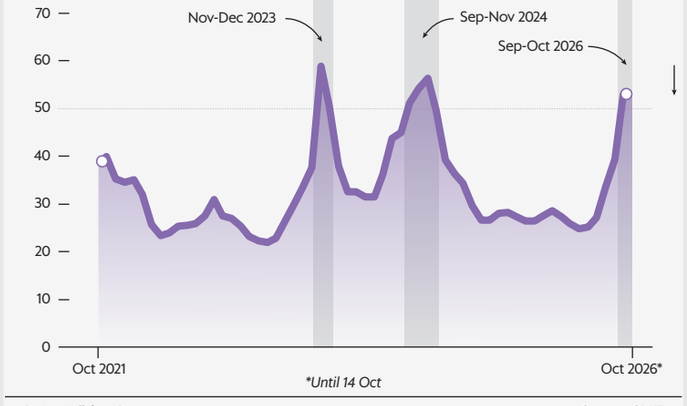
Mark to Market | Groww's struggle to diversify >P4
Global | AI firms play cat-and-mouse with secret-stealing spies >P10
Money | Can a class IX textbook make your kids better money managers? >P11
Views | India's IDBI Bank stake sale: double-score move >P12
Views | Europe must look beyond the US and China to boost productivity >P13

mint | DATA BITES

HOW OFTEN DO ONION PRICES HIT ₹50/KG?

After onion prices plummeted last year, prices have since recovered and now shot past the ₹50 per kilogram mark. Since October 2021, onion prices exceeded ₹50 per kilogram in seven months.

Monthly average onion price (in ₹/kg)



Data: Anjishnu Das
Graphic: Prateek Kumar

Source: CMIE

COLUMNS

HIMANSHU
WAGE DATA SUGGESTS THAT DISTRESS IN RURAL INDIA IS ABOUT TO WORSEN >P12

Soumya Sarkar
INDIAN TOURISM'S CLIMATE RISKS NEED TO BE FULLY PRICED IN >P12

Abby McCloskey
AI IS MAKING PARENTING SCARIER FOR MOTHERS OF YOUNG CHILDREN >P13

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PLAIN FACTS

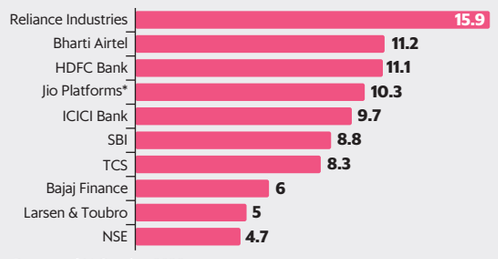
DATA RECAP THE WEEK IN CHARTS

CURATED BY HOWINDIALIVES.COM | feedback@livemint.com

From Jio Platforms preparing for a potential record-breaking Indian IPO to RBI deferring charges on select UPI transactions, the week saw key developments across markets and banking. The rupee gained against the dollar following RBI intervention, while the Union cabinet clearedthe sale of majority stake in IDBI Bank to Fairfax Financial Holdings—the largest privatization since Air India in 2022. Here is the week in numbers.

JIO'S DEBUT

Top 10 companies by market capitalisation (in ₹ trillion)



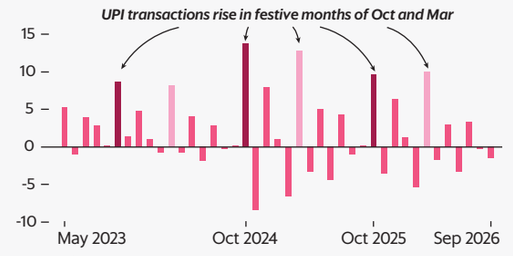
Data as of 14 October 2026.
**Jio's potential valuation is shown at the upper end of its IPO price band.*

Source: Companiesmarketcap.com mint

THE MUCH-AWAITED initial public offering (IPO) of Jio Platforms, Mukesh Ambani's telecom business, will open on 21 October. At the upper end of its price band, the issue is set to raise ₹30,200 crore, making it India's largest IPO, surpassing Hyundai Motor India's October 2024 offering. Launched in 2016, Jio has grown into a major player in India's telecom sector, and the listing marks another milestone for Ambani's business. The shares will be listed on 28 October. At the upper end of its IPO price band, Jio's market capitalization would make it India's fourth-most-valuable listed company, after Reliance Industries, Bharti Airtel and HDFC Bank, based on market values as of Wednesday.

FESTIVE PAUSE

Month-on-month change in value of UPI transactions (in %)



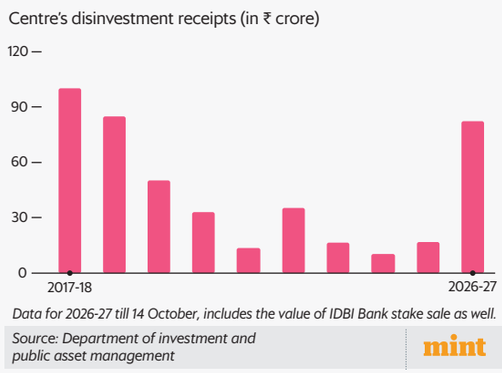
Figures for October and March have been highlighted to show the rise during those months.

Source: NPCI mint

THE NATIONAL Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has postponed the planned charge on select person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions, citing the festive season. UPI (unified payments interface) transactions have been free since the platform was launched in 2016. In September, the government announced a charge of 0.4% on P2M transactions above ₹2,000, capped at ₹300. The charge, which was earlier scheduled to take effect on 15 October, will now be implemented "immediately post Diwali," according to NPCI. UPI transactions typically see their highest sequential growth in October, coinciding with the festive season, with March recording the next-highest growth.

PRIME SALE

Centre's disinvestment receipts (in ₹ crore)



Data for 2026-27 till 14 October, includes the value of IDBI Bank stake sale as well.

Source: Department of investment and public asset management mint

NEARLY FOUR years after first announcing plans to sell IDBI Bank, the Union cabinet on Wednesday cleared the sale of a 60.7% stake to Canada's Fairfax Financial Holdings for ₹52,877 crore. The deal follows major foreign investments in India's financial sector: Emirates NBD's investment in RBL Bank, Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.'s investment in Yes Bank and MUFG's investment in Shriram Finance. It will also be the government's biggest privatization since selling Air India to the Tata Group in 2022. Since then, outright sales have stalled. But small stake sales, alongside the proposed IDBI Bank deal, are putting FY27 on course to be the strongest year for disinvestment since FY18.

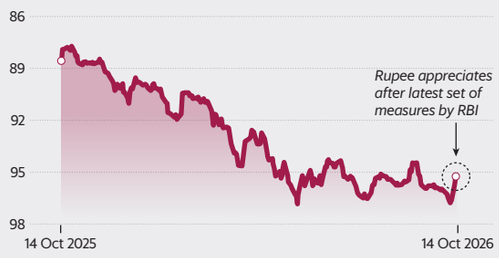
NUMBERS TALK

- **23%:** The average forecast by five brokerages for growth in Nifty 50 companies' net profit in the September quarter, compared with 11% growth in the June quarter.
- **36.7 million sq. ft:** Net absorption of office space across eight major Indian cities in January-September, down 20% from a year earlier, according to Cushman & Wakefield.
- **₹3,191 crore:** Net profit reported by SaaS firm Zoho for 2024-25. This week, co-founder Sridhar Vembu said Zoho would not hike salaries this year amid disruptions from artificial intelligence.
- **12%:** Share of Indian consumers who reported being scammed in the previous 12 months, per GSMA's *India Consumer Scam Report 2026*. Of the victims, 86% took their cases to an organization.
- **$276 million:** Amount Elon Musk has spent on Republican midterm election efforts since July, making him the largest known donor in the 2026 US election cycle.

RUPEE SUPPORT

Rupee per US dollar, daily

(Inverse scale used)



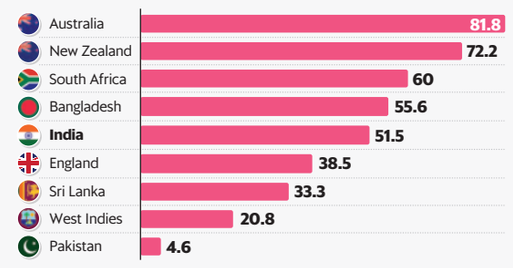
Source: RBI mint

THE RUPEE gained about 1.8% against the US dollar this week, following a series of foreign exchange measures announced by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) last week. It closed at ₹95.03 to the dollar on 14 October.

The measures were aimed at easing immediate dollar demand and curbing positions in currency derivatives. Between 7 September and 8 October, the rupee had depreciated 2.5%. Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi this week, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the RBI would seek to curb volatility in the rupee, which was under pressure from external factors, but would not attempt to fix its value.

TEST OF CHAMPIONS

Share of total points earned in the 2025-27 world test championship cycle (in %)



Source: ESPNCricinfo.com mint

THE WORLD Test Championship 2025-27 cycle is underway, with Australia leading the standings after a recent 214-run win over South Africa in the first Test of their three-match series. Australia has won nine of its 11 Tests in the current cycle and lost two, earning about 82% of the points available. South Africa is third with 60%, while India is fifth with 51.5%. The top two teams at the end of the cycle will meet in the final at The Oval in England in June 2027. South Africa's remaining fixtures include home series against Bangladesh and England and a tour of Sri Lanka. India will tour New Zealand and host Australia, leaving it needing a strong run of wins and favourable results elsewhere to reach the final.

MINT BEST OF THE WEEK

Jio IPO's AI test

Jio Platforms is seeking a valuation of about $107 billion in an IPO that could rank among India's largest. Its decade-long rise reshaped telecom through cheap data and massive scale. Now, investors must decide whether its AI and digital services can justify a premium beyond telecom.

Bullet train ambitions

From Surat's soaring viaducts to an undersea tunnel near Mumbai, India's ₹2 trillion bullet train project is finally taking shape. Despite delays and Japanese supply snags, a homegrown high-speed rail ecosystem is emerging. But can this engineering marvel justify its staggering cost?

Profits surge, costs loom

Nifty 50 companies could post 23% profit growth in Q2, their strongest showing in four quarters, aided by a low base and softer crude prices. But rising input costs, uncertain rural demand and volatile oil prices threaten momentum. Investors will watch whether firms can raise prices without hurting sales.

HT MUMBAI VOL. 9 NO. 248 Rs. 15.00 22 PAGES

Friday, October 16, 2026

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India is emerging as a hub for global auto ambitions ▶P5

Tech M maintains edge over Wipro in Sep quarter ▶P5

SENSEX **74,315.63** ↑ **1,533.74** NIFTY **22,997.35** ↑ **374.65** DOLLAR **₹95.05** ↑ **₹0.10** EURO **₹106.62** ↓ **₹0.11** OIL **$103.87** ↓ **$1.54** POUND **₹126.05** ↑ **₹0.18**

Apex court blow to Yes Bank's bond kill

Administrator didn't follow procedure in AT-1 bond write-off: SC

Krishna Yadav & Subhana Shaikh
NEW DELHI/MUMBAI

Yes Bank Ltd's bondholders scored a landmark win over India's central bank and the government on Thursday, with the Supreme Court striking down a six-year-old decision to cancel their investments.

The Reserve Bank of India had seized the wobbly private lender in 2020 to facilitate a bailout, appointing an administrator who wrote off the bank's additional tier-1 (AT-1) bonds worth ₹8,415 crore. The Bombay High Court quashed the write-off in 2023, and the apex court on Thursday said it found no reason to reverse that.

"The question is not whether the AT-1 bonds could have been or ought to have been written off. The question is the manner in which it was done," the judgment penned by justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih said. The administrator could not exercise a power reserved for the RBI, the court said, noting the write-down was contrary to the RBI's own master circular on Basel-III capital regulations and the terms governing the bonds.

Yes Bank shares plunged 14.5% to ₹18.12 on the NSE, turning the worst-performer in the Nifty Bank index, as investors fretted about the ruling's financial impact.

The impact on Yes Bank's balance sheet may not be immediate.

According to the former chief financial officer of a private sector bank, since AT-1 bonds do not have a maturity date, lenders only need to pay coupon every year. However, most AT-1 bonds have a call option under which banks repay investors in full after five or 10 years. Therefore, unless the verdict is overturned, Yes Bank will have to restart making yearly coupon payments to

TURN TO PAGE 4

NO TO YES

The bondholders argued that Yes Bank's administrator acted unilaterally and exceeded his authority by writing off these bonds.

Yes Bank AT-1 bond crisis

- **Dec 2016** — Yes Bank issues **₹3,000 crore** AT-1 bonds
- **Oct 2017** — Issues another **₹5,415 crore** AT-1 bonds
- **Mar 2020** — RBI imposes a moratorium on Yes Bank amid severe financial crisis
- **14 Mar 2020** — Administrator writes off **₹8,415 crore** in bonds
- **16 Mar 2020** — AT-1 bondholders challenge the write-off in the Bombay High Court
- **Jan 2023** — Bombay High Court quashes the write-off
- **Feb 2023** — Yes Bank and RBI challenge the HC ruling in Supreme Court
- **15 Oct 2026** — **Supreme Court dismisses the Yes Bank and RBI appeals**

Source: Supreme Court judgment mint

BOND BLUES

YES BANK shares plunged as investors fretted over impact

THE bank faces heat over AT-1 bond sales to individuals

SOLICITOR General had said the write-off was necessary

GOPAKUMAR WARRIER/MINT

BlackRock, ADIA, Norges vie for Jio IPO anchor book

Agnidev Bhattacharya & Sneha Shah
MUMBAI

Global investors and sovereign wealth funds, including the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, Qatar Investment Authority, GIC Pte. Ltd, Norges Bank Investment Management and Mubadala Investment Co., are queueing up for allocations in the anchor book of Jio Platforms Ltd's public offering, alongside asset managers BlackRock Inc. and FMR LLC, according to four people familiar with the matter.

About 15 domestic asset managers, including HDFC Mutual Fund, SBI Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Nippon Life India Asset Management and Motilal Oswal Asset Management, have also submitted indications of interest for a share of Jio's ₹8,000-crore anchor book, the people said on the condition of anonymity.

The asset management arms of Goldman Sachs and Franklin Templeton are also considering anchor investments, the people said.

While ADIA, Motilal and Norges declined to comment,

The Jio Platforms IPO will raise around ₹30,200 crore. AFP

representatives of Jio's parent company, Reliance Industries Ltd, as well as other institutional investors and fund managers, did not respond to requests for comment.

The telecom giant's parent filed its red herring prospectus with the Securities and Exchange Board of India on Wednesday for an initial public offering (IPO) that will raise around ₹30,200 crore, or about $3.2 billion, at the upper end of the ₹1,069-1,119 per share price band announced.

The anchor allocation window, which precedes the public subscription period, allows

TURN TO PAGE 4

Nifty logs its best day in 4 months, but rally may fade

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MUMBAI

Indian stocks surged on Thursday, bucking a global sell-off in artificial intelligence (AI) and technology shares as domestic buying and a rush by traders to reverse their bets against the market fuelled the rally. However, experts do not see the uptrend sustaining as of now as foreign funds continue to pull money out of Indian equities.

The Nifty 50 index closed 1.66% higher at 22,997.35 on Thursday, clocking its biggest rise in percentage terms since 12 June. Sensex closed 2.1% up at 74,315.61, seeing a similar highest rise since 12 June.

Heavyweights ICICI Bank, Reliance Industries Ltd, HDFC Bank and Bharti Airtel buoyed the index. Domestic institutional investors (DIIs) net bought shares worth ₹3,319 crore, while foreign institutional investors (FIIs) net sold shares worth ₹5,285 crore. However, the FIIs, on a gross basis, bought shares worth ₹12,735 crore on Thursday.

The proof of short-covering was visible in the put-call ratio of weekly options contracts on

TURN TO PAGE 9

DON'T MISS

REUTERS

Sebi brings back VWAP on expiry days after CAS volatility

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Thursday withdrew the two-month-old closing auction framework for settlement of derivatives contracts, after it led to abrupt price swings and uncertainty on expiry days. >P7

Govt unlikely to hold spectrum auction this fiscal year

The government is unlikely to hold a spectrum auction this fiscal year, the second time in a row the government will miss the Cabinet's timeline for selling mobile airwaves, said two government officials and industry executives familiar with the matter. >P7

How Lakshmi ended up with less of Venu Srinivasan's businesses

A series of restructuring moves over years shifted a valuable TVS Motor stake out of the business that Lakshmi Venu ran, leaving Laskshmi and her sibling Sudarshan Venu with very different assets and growth trajectories, a *Mint* review found. >P6

Air India's new CEO tightens spending as losses mount

Less than a month after taking over as the CEO of Air India, Tewolde Gebremariam has initiated belt-tightening steps to counter mounting losses and rising operating costs. The airline has set up a dedicated team to identify cost savings across the group. >P6

Panama's ambassador to India Alonso Correa Miguel. @ECISVEEP/X

'For Indian biz, Panama is a gateway to Latin America'

Ramita Mishra & Banikinkar Pattanayak

NEW DELHI

A decade after the Panama Papers scandal tarnished its reputation, Panama is seeking to position itself as a gateway for Indian businesses looking to expand across Latin America, leveraging its ports, free trade zones and logistics infrastructure, said the country's ambassador to India, Alonso Correa Miguel.

The April 2016 Paper leaks damaged the country's reputation, but it is unfair to judge a country solely by the scandal involving a single private law firm, Miguel told *Mint* in an interview.

The Panama Papers comprised 11.5 million leaked files from the database of Panamanian law firm Mossack Fonseca that exposed how it helped global elites, including Indians, conceal wealth, evade taxes and create anonymous shell firms.

Miguel pitched Panama's Colón Free Trade Zone, Panama Pacifico, Tocumen, and City of Knowledge as logistics and distribution platforms for Indian firms seeking greater access to Latin America.

This comes at a time when India is seeking to further diversify its export destinations and reduce reliance on a few large markets as trade protectionism, especially in the US, intensifies and global supply chains realign.

Panama had the highest maritime connectivity in Latin America and the Caribbean in 2026, per the UN Conference on Trade and Development data, reflecting the strategic importance of the Panama Canal to global trade flows.

"Panama can be your partner. Like to be your port in the middle ground in Latin America—to cover that continent that you're barely touching, and to reach other markets, to reach a well-developed, well-equipped and very trustworthy ally," he said, adding India's Viksit Bharat aim would need deeper ties with Latin America.

ramita.mishra@livemint.com

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

'Service conditions, benefits of IDBI Bank staff protected'

Govt's assurance comes amid bank unions' opposition to the proposed privatization of IDBI

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NEW DELHI

The government has assured that IDBI Bank employees' service conditions and pension benefits will be fully protected following the lender's ₹52,878 crore strategic disinvestment, with a dedicated pension fund already set aside to safeguard retirees' interests, Arunish Chawla, secretary of the department of investment and public asset management (DIPAM), told *Mint* on Thursday.

The assurance comes amid bank unions' opposition to the proposed privatization of IDBI Bank, in which the government and Life Insurance Corp. of India (LIC) are selling a combined 60.72% stake to Fairfax Financial Holdings. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the divestment on Wednesday.

"The service conditions of all existing employees will be fully protected. The bank also has pensioners, and their pension benefits will be protected. A dedicated pension fund has been set aside for this purpose. Hence, the employees and pensioners have nothing to fear," Chawla said.

He explained that IDBI Bank is being strategically restructured as a going concern, with LIC, its present promoter, set to be replaced by the strategic buyer as the future promoter. The bank would continue to operate under the existing framework of company and labour laws, he said.

Arunish Chawla, secretary of the department of investment and public asset management.

The United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU), an umbrella body of bank employee organizations, has opposed the deal and called upon its constituent unions and members to observe a black badge protest on 16 October 2026.

In a circular issued on Thursday, the forum opposed what it described as the "privatization and foreignization" of IDBI Bank, arguing that the lender had returned to profitability.

Chawla said IDBI Bank would remain a board-run company, with the incoming promoter and management continuing negotiations with the respective employee associations. "The bank is being strategically restructured as a going concern. It will continue to be a board-run company," he said.

He added that existing legal remedies would remain available to employees even after the change in ownership.

"If there is any grievance, there are labour courts. Even today, the banking company is run under company law and labour law. It will continue to be run under company law and labour law," Chawla said.

Under the government-approved transaction terms, the Centre will divest its 30.48% stake, while LIC will sell 30.24%, bringing the combined stake sale to 60.72%. The transaction has been valued at ₹52,878 crore, at ₹81 per share.

On the transaction timeline, Chawla said the successful bidder would need clearance from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) before the share purchase agreement could be signed.

"After RBI has cleared the successful bidder, the share purchase agreement will be signed, and the deal will hopefully be closed in the current fiscal year," he said.

The government is hopeful of completing the transaction by 31 March 2027, subject to regulatory approvals and the remaining formalities.

On concerns raised by minority shareholders, Chawla said their interests would also remain protected, as the strategic buyer would be required to make an open offer following the signing of the share purchase agreement.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

EMPLOYEE PROTECTION

CHAWLA explained that IDBI Bank is being strategically restructured as a going concern

HE said LIC, its current promoter, is set to be replaced by the strategic buyer as a future promoter

IDBI will continue to operate under the existing framework of the company and labour laws, he said

EXISTING legal remedies will remain available to staff even after change in ownership, he added

For related stories, see Page 8

Need to mobilize private investment to create jobs: FM

Banikinkar Pattanayak
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NEW DELHI

Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman. PTI

Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Thursday called on the World Bank Group to keep the private sector at the centre of its development agenda, stressing that mobilizing private investment is essential as most jobs will be created by private enterprises.

Speaking at the 114th meeting of the Development Committee Plenary in Bangkok, Sitharaman said sustainable job creation requires ecosystems built on macroeconomic stability, infrastructure, simple regulations and access to finance, according to a statement by the Indian finance ministry.

The meeting of the Development Committee, a joint ministerial forum of the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund, is being held during the 2026 annual meetings of both the multilateral institutions in Bangkok between 12 and 18 October. The plenary agenda was 'Private Capital Mobilisation and Jobs'.

"At a time of growing energy market stress, trade fragmentation, climate pressures, and rapid technological change, productive and better-paid jobs remain the most effective pathway to poverty reduction and shared prosperity," Sitharaman said.

The minister made six points in India's intervention during the plenary.

First, jobs require ecosystems, not isolated interventions, she stressed. Second, given that most jobs will be created by the private sector, success should be measured not by the volume of financing mobilized, but by outcomes—jobs created and rise in productivity. Third, competitive financing must remain a core priority for the World Bank, she said. Fourth, the World's Bank's knowledge bank must help address market failures in critical areas and give due attention to how AI can boost state capacity in developing countries, she said.

"Fifth, we reiterate our long-standing concerns regarding Worldwide Governance Indicators and similar composite assessments," she said.

Finally, the ultimate measure of success is whether reforms help countries create jobs, raise productivity, reduce poverty, and improve living standards, she stressed.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

India's merchandise trade deficit widens in September

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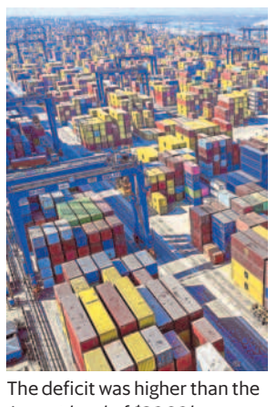
NEW DELHI

India's merchandise exports in September jumped 23% from a year before to $44.4 billion despite external headwinds, while imports rose 8% to $74.61 billion, according to provisional data released by the commerce ministry on Thursday.

Higher export growth narrowed the trade deficit to $30.21 billion in September from $33 billion a year earlier. However, the deficit was higher than the August level of $26.86 billion.

Merchandise exports in the first half of the current fiscal year (FY27) rose 18.51% year-on-year to $259.89 billion. Imports increased 16.31% to $437.53 billion, taking the merchandise trade deficit to $177.64 billion, compared with $156.87 billion a year earlier.

Strong goods exports remain critical to India's economic growth and current account this fiscal as elevated energy prices, driven by the West Asia crisis, have put pressure on the country's external balance, although it's still on a relatively stronger footing than most others. The export growth, analysts said, also suggests India's diversification bid is showing early signs of success.



The deficit was higher than the August level of $26.86 bn. AFP

Last month, a Niti Aayog report said two African countries—Tanzania and South Africa—broke into the top 10 destinations for Indian products in the June quarter, replacing Hong Kong and Saudi Arabia amid the West Asia war.

The latest data showed India's overall exports, including merchandise and services, rose 13.84% year-on-year to $476.20 billion in the first half of the current fiscal. Imports rose 15.68% to $551.13 billion, widening the trade deficit to $74.93 billion from $58.10 billion.

Services exports were pegged at $216.31 billion during April–September 2026, up 8.69% from $199.02 billion in the year-ago period. Services imports increased 13.32% to $113.60 billion from $100.24 billion.

The ministry said India's overall exports reached record levels in both the first and second quarters of FY27. Exports stood at $233.6 billion during April–June and $242.6 billion during July–September, the highest recorded for the respective quarters.

The US remained India's largest merchandise export destination during April–September, with shipments rising to $50.81 billion from $45.73 billion a year earlier.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

Delhi's all-out EV push splits auto firms

Ayaan Kartik & Manas Pimpalkhare

NEW DELHI

As Delhi, one of the world's most polluted cities, braces for another winter of hazardous air, an expert panel's proposal to mandate 100% zero-tailpipe-emission passenger vehicle sales by 2030 in the national capital region has opened a fresh divide in the automobile ecosystem. Led by IIT Madras professor Ashok Jhunjhunwala, the panel has recommended a sales mandate for original equipment manufacturers selling private four-wheelers in Delhi-NCR. The proposed targets are 20% of new sales in 2027, rising to 45% in 2028, 70% in 2029 and 100% in 2030.

The recommendation has intensified the debate in the auto industry, pitting proponents of battery-electric vehicles against industries representing compressed natural gas (CNG), ethanol and compressed biogas (CBG). At stake is whether Delhi-NCR should make a decisive shift to vehicles with zero tailpipe emissions or retain a technology-neutral approach that allows multiple fuels to play a role in reducing pollution.

A panel, led by Ashok Jhunjhunwala, proposed to mandate 100% zero-tailpipe-emission PV sales by 2030. ASHOK JHUNJHUNWALA/LINKEDIN

Jhunjhunwala, chair of the Commission for Air Quality Management's (CAQM) Expert Committee on Vehicular Emission, told *Mint* that the panel rejected an incremental approach based on successive emission norms and alternative-fuel technologies.

The panel has recommended a sales mandate for OEMs selling private four-wheelers in Delhi-NCR

"Let's go all out for zero-emission vehicles. They are increasingly becoming economically viable," he said. "Tomorrow, hydrogen vehicles will be available. We're all for any zero-emission vehicle."

The panel was constituted to recommend steps to curb air pollution from transport. The recommendation has been submitted to CAQM which will now decide whether the measures can be implemented.

The 15-member included former AIIMS director Randeep Guleria as co-chair, along with experts and representatives from IITs, government ministries, and Niti Aayog.

Talks with doctors helped sharpen the urgency of the exercise, Jhunjhunwala said.

The committee found that air pollution in Delhi-NCR affects people across age groups. It noted that the air quality index (AQI) has crossed 460 and that winter PM2.5 concentrations reach nearly 35 times the World Health Organization's guideline level, exposing millions to hazardous air. It also flagged respiratory illnesses among older people, impaired lung development in children and long-term risks, including cardiovascular disease and diabetes.

The discussions and evidence convinced him that the objective should not simply be to reduce pollution gradually, but ultimately to eliminate it.

"Schools are being closed and children are not allowed to play outside. People are talking about incremental improvement. We have to move towards making daily AQI zero," Jhunjhunwala said.

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MINT SHORTS

India's jobless rate rises in urban areas in September

New Delhi: The unemployment rate for those aged 15 and above remained steady in September at 5.0%, as a rise in joblessness in urban areas was compensated by a broadly stable rural unemployment rate. It was 5.2% a year earlier. The unemployment rate among men aged 15 and above remained unchanged at 4.9% in September. **SUBHASH NARAYAN**

HT

Govt offers startups up to ₹50 cr for new drug discovery

New Delhi: The Department of Pharmaceuticals has invited applications for the second round of its Promotion of Research and Innovation in Pharma & MedTech (PRIP) scheme, offering startups and micro, small, and medium enterprises up to ₹50 crore each for new drug discovery, the government said. The PRIP scheme has a total financial outlay of ₹5,000 crore, which includes ₹700 crore to establish Centers of Excellence at seven National Institutes of Pharmaceutical Education & Research, and ₹4,200 crore to accelerate investments in the R&D ecosystem within the sector. **PRIYANKA SHARMA**

Jaishankar calls for 'urgent' reform of multilateralism

Abu Dhabi: Foreign minister S. Jaishankar, during a session of the Raisina Dialogue's Middle East edition, called for "urgent" reform of multilateral institutions to reflect the changing global order, saying better cooperation among smaller nations could aid the process. **PTI**

BLOOMBERG

India says first phase of US trade deal nearly done

PTI

New Delhi: The first phase of an India-US trade deal is in the final stages of drafting, trade minister Piyush Goyal said, but reiterated that New Delhi would proceed only if it secures an advantage over competing exporters. The two sides agreed to a framework for the deal in February which brought down to 18% from 50% the punitive tariff on most Indian goods imposed in August last year. **REUTERS**

India's current account deficit narrows to $5.2 bn in Aug

REUTERS

Mumbai: India's current account deficit narrowed to $5.2 billion in August from $6.1 billion a year ago, aided by a lower merchandise trade deficit and higher surpluses in services trade, according to preliminary data released by the Reserve Bank of India on Thursday. **PTI**

India, Canada to hold next round of trade talks in Nov

New Delhi: India and Canada will hold the next round of talks on the proposed free trade deal in early November here, per the commerce ministry. Chief negotiators from the two nations concluded the fifth round of negotiations for the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement on 9 October in Canada. The next round will be held here in early November, the ministry said. **PTI**

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First published in February 2007 to serve as an unbiased and clear-minded chronicler of the Indian Dream.

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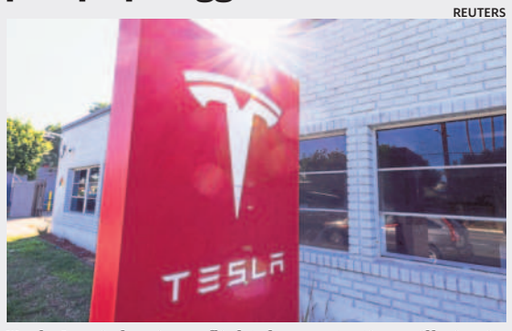
MINT SHORTS

AI agents to soon trade bonds, HSBC's investment bank head says

Banks could within a couple of years allow artificial intelligence (AI) agents to trade on financial markets instead of humans, according to the head of HSBC Holdings Plc's global investment banking division. "I think quantum computing will be able to look at very complex type of market movements, and with the advent of AI, which will make that even quicker, you can see agents trading bonds using quantum computing," Michael Roberts, head of corporate and institutional banking at HSBC, said in an interview with Bloomberg TV. More algorithmic trading is going to be done by AI agents, though humans have to be "in the loop," Roberts said on the sidelines of the International Monetary Fund's annual meeting in Bangkok. **BLOOMBERG**

Tesla readies flying car demo to pump up sluggish auto business

REUTERS



Tesla Inc. is hoping a flight demonstration will give its ground-bound auto business a lift. The electric vehicle (EV) maker planned to unveil its long-promised new Roadster sports car on Thursday in Texas, reviving and refreshing a model that Tesla stopped producing more than a decade ago. The high-end vehicle will give the company another offering in a slimmed-down lineup revolving primarily around a pair of mid-priced consumer models. The automaker has been working for years on a prototype that chief executive Elon Musk has hinted would be capable of flight, using rocket-like technology. **BLOOMBERG**

Trifecta Capital sees five portfolio companies listing in a year

Indian investment firm Trifecta Capital Partners expects five companies from its growth equity portfolio, including some unicorns, to go public over the next year, as it seeks to capitalize on strong investor demand for new listings. "The good news is that there is enough liquidity and enough appetite," Rahul Khanna, co-founder and managing partner of the Mumbai-based firm said on the sidelines of the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi. Consumer appliances company Atomberg Technologies Ltd and fintech firm Fibe are expected to list by the year-end, Khanna said. Other portfolio firms including interior design firm Livspace India Pvt. Ltd, online milk and dairy platform Country Delight and used car platform Cars24 Services Pvt. Ltd are likely to follow in 2027, he said. **BLOOMBERG**

Lightbox shifts focus to repeatable profits

Firm targets later-stage bets to establish a repeatable path to profitability

Mansi Verma
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MUMBAI

Lightbox founder and managing director Sandeep Murthy.

Lightbox, the consumer-focused venture capital (VC) firm, plans to shift to later-stage investments in companies with greater revenue scale. The move is meant to cut the need for aggressive follow-on funding and to establish a repeatable route to profitability before it raises its next fund.

The Mumbai-based firm, which has invested about $400 million in consumer businesses, has historically focused on early-stage companies. Moving later in the investment cycle could mean entering companies at higher valuations, but Lightbox expects to reduce the need for aggressive follow-on investments by backing businesses with greater revenue scale and a clearer path to profitability, founder and managing director Sandeep Murthy told *Mint*.

The strategy comes as Lightbox seeks to demonstrate that it can improve the financial performance of its portfolio companies in a repeatable way before approaching investors for its fourth fund.

"The right answer is to come in when they've moved a little bit further than where we were before. A late Series A, early Series B where companies are getting significant revenue scale," Murthy said.

The firm has made its first exit from its third fund through women's personal care brand Nua, generating a 6.7x multiple and a 30% internal rate of return, Murthy said. Lightbox aims to build on that exit while improving the financial performance of the rest of its portfolio.

Nua raised $50 million in a Series C funding round in September, led by Peak XV Partners and Filter Capital, which also provided an opportunity for existing investors, including Lightbox, to make partial exits. Lightbox continues to hold about 20% of the company, Murthy said.

Founded in 2014, Lightbox raised about $40 million for its first fund and $100 million for its second, before raising its third fund of about $200 million in 2019.

Lightbox is focusing on the financial performance of the nine companies Murthy works closely with: Rebel Foods, Furlenco, Zeno Health, Nua, Cityflo, Bombay Shirt Company, Rupeek, Amaha and Rooter.

Four of these businesses are fully profitable, while another four are expected to become profitable by the end of the year. The remaining company could take another 12 months, Murthy said.

The firm has, in some cases, chosen not to provide additional capital to companies even when they had opportunities to raise funds elsewhere, preferring to focus on their underlying business performance.

"Funding and amount of funding is not an indicator of product market fit," Murthy said.

The approach reflects Lightbox's emphasis on building businesses that can sustain themselves financially, rather than relying on successive funding rounds to support growth. Murthy wants to establish that the firm can help companies improve profitability in a way that can be repeated across its portfolio before approaching investors for a fourth fund.

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CHANGING TRACK

THE Mumbai-based venture capital firm has historically focused on early-stage companies

MOVING later in the investment cycle could mean entering companies at higher valuations

THE approach reflects Lightbox's emphasis on building businesses that can sustain themselves

Accel, Zacua invest $20 mn in robotics startup Origin

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Origin currently has six robots operational across the US and European markets.

Origin, a deeptech startup building autonomous robots for interior construction, has raised $20 million in a round led by Accel and Zacua Ventures as it emerges from stealth, with plans to build 150 robots by the end of next year. Unilazer Ventures, Schema Ventures, Z21, ISAI and Imad Ventures also invested, as did some of Origin's customers. Accel's India fund is the only Indian entity on the startup's cap table.

The raise is an early bet on physical artificial intelligence (AI) in one of the least-automated industries. However, venture funds are increasingly parking money in the sector, with robotics in construction attracting $1.3 billion in funding until Q3 2025, compared to $612 million in all of 2024, according to Pitchbook data.

Origin's pitch to its customers—large housing contractors in the US and Europe such as D.R. Horton and Lennar Corp.—centres on margin expansion amid high labour costs and worker shortages. These pressures have been compounded by tighter immigration curbs on white-collar and blue-collar workers in both regions.

"The cost of hiring skilled contractors in the US is very high. For a US contractor with a crew of five people, they pay $50,000 a month. Replacing them with a robot from us saves them 20% of the cost from day one," Yogesh Ghaturle, co-founder and chief executive of Origin, said in an interview with *Mint*.

Origin plans to have autonomous robots that can work on the entire interior construction of a home including things such as installation of heating, ventilation and air conditioning systems, plumbing, dry wall painting. Currently, the startup's flagship robot, the OG-1, is capable of completing wall-finishing. This includes sanding, applying primer paint, final painting.

Founded in January 2025, the deeptech startup rolled out its initial pilots and deployments in October 2025

Founded in January 2025 by Ghaturle, Ashish Daga and Tushar Makkar, Origin rolled out its initial pilots and deployments in October 2025 and currently has six robots operational across the US and European markets. It is currently focused on three priorities: scaling its painting operations with existing clients while finishing contracted projects and starting new pilots; raising manufacturing capacity; and building deployment teams in both markets.

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Total Deposits ₹8,74,036 Cr Up by 12.50 % Y.o.Y
Gross Advances ₹ 7,21,982 Cr Up by 16.39 % Y.o.Y
RAM (Retail, Agri, MSME) ₹ 4,42,302 Cr Up by 17.74 % Y.o.Y
Net Profit ₹ 3,462 Cr Up by 14.71 % Y.o.Y
Gross NPA 1.61 % Down by 99 bps Y.o.Y
Net NPA 0.14 % Down by 2 bps Y.o.Y
NIM (Domestic) 3.42 %
RoA 1.31%

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IB CYBER CAPTAIN

Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results (Standalone/Consolidated) for the Quarter/ Half Year Ended September 30, 2026 (₹ in crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Reviewed)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Reviewed)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total income from operations	23058.62	43782.24	19076.57	77441.29	23335.98	44333.36	19271.09	78332.70
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4867.64	9229.21	4097.91	16403.72	4848.36	9242.82	4122.99	16501.54
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4867.64	9229.21	4097.91	16403.72	4848.36	9242.82	4122.99	15734.95
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	3462.24	6735.33	3018.22	12155.65	3540.71	6897.34	3107.97	11704.28
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of previous year)	69876.76	69876.76	60762.20	69876.76	71628.40	71628.40	62965.17	71628.40
8.	Securities Premium Account	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02
9.	Net Worth	72062.67	72062.67	62950.90	65627.59				
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt**	47780.15	47780.15	23889.95	22421.14				
11.	Debt Equity Ratio**	0.66	0.66	0.38	0.34				
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)								
	Basic :	*25.70	*50.00	*22.41	90.24	*26.29	*51.21	*23.07	86.89
	Diluted :	*25.70	*50.00	*22.41	90.24	*26.29	*51.21	*23.07	86.89
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
15.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
16.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

* Not Annualised ** Debt represents borrowing with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note: 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/ Half Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/ Half Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) websites (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and Bank's website (www.indianbank.bank.in).
2. Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the Bank.

QR CODE for Result

Place : Chennai
Date : 15.10.2026

Mini T M, Executive Director
Shiv Bajrang Singh, Executive Director
Ashutosh Choudhury, Executive Director
Binod Kumar, Managing Director & CEO

Corporate Office: 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai - 600 014.

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BSE Sensex		Nifty 50		Nifty 500		Nifty Next 50		Nifty 100		BSE 150 MidCap		BSE 250 SmallCap	
CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE	CLOSE	PERCENT CHANGE
74,315.61	2.11	22,997.35	1.66	22,180.80	0.65	68,671.60	-0.47	23,986.10	1.26	16,001.81	-0.48	6,919.75	-1.04
PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN	PREVIOUS CLOSE	OPEN
72,781.89	72,965.80	22,622.70	22,671.30	22,038.00	22,054.25	68,999.30	68,852.85	23,688.45	23,720.35	16,078.42	16,054.79	6,992.57	6,992.75
HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW
74,330.29	72,896.38	23,056.40	22,637.40	22,242.05	22,004.75	68,967.75	68,274.80	24,046.60	23,669.45	16,107.61	15,981.91	6,994.98	6,911.82

Groww's struggle to diversify

Manish Joshi
feedback@livemint.com

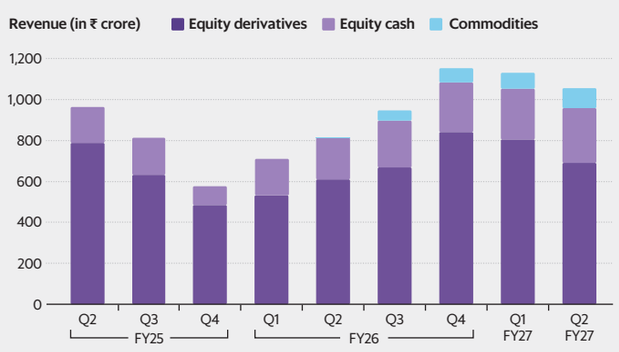
Billionbrains Garage Ventures' (Groww) net profit failed to rise sequentially in the September quarter (Q2FY27) despite having tailwinds of five more trading days and no IPL-related marketing costs.

While Groww's net profit fall may be marginal at 1.3% quarter-on-quarter to ₹725 crore, even as marketing costs fell by almost 29% to ₹105 crore, it highlights the company's high dependence on equity derivatives. Further, a nearly 5% rise in stock active users to 12.7 million might not matter much unless they trade more.

Groww's commodity and equity cash brokerage incomes rose 26% and 7.5% on-quarter in Q2FY27 to ₹95 crore and ₹268 crore, respectively. Yet overall brokerage income fell 6.6% to ₹1,054 crore, as equity derivatives brokerage, which contributed 65.5% of brokerage income, fell 14% to ₹690 crore. Broking orders fell by 7.7% to 517.3 million, with the closing auction session (CAS) mechanism hurting already weak sentiment in equities.

Heavy influence

Groww's higher dependence on equity derivatives marred its Q2FY27 results.



Source: Company presentations

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PRATEEK KUMAR/MINT

To be sure, recent activity suggests the trading community already seems to have adjusted to CAS changes. Trading activity in the most important segment of equity derivatives, i.e., options and its most important parameter, i.e., premium turnover, has already recovered from ₹7.4 trillion in August to ₹9.4 trillion in September, data from National Stock Exchange showed. So, more than the CAS-related changes, it is crucial that the general sentiment for equities revives.

Groww is taking steps to lower its reliance on equity derivatives, reflected in the more than doubling of other operating income to ₹73.9 crore. While details of other operating income are not available, growth seems to be aided by wealth management, as Groww AMC's revenue was just ₹4 crore. But it is still too small to move the needle meaningfully. Fund-based income, comprising interest income on loans under various heads such as margin trading facility (MTF), loans against shares (LAS), and personal loans (PL), grew 7% to ₹415 crore. MTF and LAS generate both brokerage and interest income.

DIVERGENT TREND

BROKERAGE income fell 6.6% to ₹1,054 crore, as equity derivatives brokerage fell 14%

FUND-BASED income from margin trading and other loans grew 7% to ₹415 crore

Cash market turnover contribution from MTF is slightly above 5% in Q2FY27. Note that a rise in MTF value may not necessarily mean higher brokerage income, as Groww charges fixed brokerage per order, capped at ₹20 per order, so to boost brokerage income, order volumes need to grow.

Groww is also working on providing access to trading in the US stock markets, but the timeline is not yet finalized. The brokerage for US stocks is likely to be a percentage of the value rather than a fixed brokerage per order.

Brokers, including Groww, also face another challenge if MDR is introduced on UPI transactions. MDR has been capped at ₹300 per transaction (minimum is 0.02% of value). Note that if a trader transfers funds to a broker but chooses not to trade and later withdraws the funds, the broker still has to bear MDR without earning any brokerage.

Investors have assigned a rich price-to-earnings multiple of nearly 41 to Groww based on *Bloomberg* consensus FY27 estimates, which is closer to the multiples enjoyed by exchanges such as BSE and NSE. Exchanges operate in an almost duopoly structure, while Groww has multiple rivals. Groww must maintain its faster growth to prevent the Street from dragging down its valuation multiple to that of comparable peers, such as Angel One, which trades at a 22 price-to-earnings multiple.

Sebi rolls back CAS, restores VWAP for derivatives expiry

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MUMBAI

Sebi reviewed the framework through a consultation paper in September. REUTERS

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Thursday pulled back the two-month-old closing auction framework for settlement of derivatives contracts, after it led to abrupt price swings and uncertainty on expiry days.

In a late-night circular, the market regulator said that the closing price will be calculated based on a 30-minute volume-weighted average price (VWAP) on derivatives expiry days i.e. Tuesday and Thursday.

Sebi reviewed the framework through a consultation paper in September, following pushback from market participants over a liquidity squeeze during the auction.

The paper outlined two options for calculating closing prices on derivatives expiry days: adopt a blended VWAP-based methodology or retain the existing VWAP calculation based on the last 30 minutes of continuous trading on settlement days for at least a year.

The closing price will be calculated based on a 30-minute VWAP on derivatives expiry days i.e. Tuesday and Thursday

Unlike a simple average, VWAP takes into account both the price and volume of trades. For instance, if 100 shares are traded at ₹10 each and 50 shares at ₹12 each, the WAP is ₹10.67, compared with a simple average price of ₹11. On the other hand, a CAS uses an auction to match orders and derive the closing price.

Many market participants have urged Sebi to retain VWAP-based settlement pricing on expiry days-Tuesday for Nifty options and Thursday for Sensex options-and introduce blended pricing on non-expiry days for a year before transitioning fully to the blended framework.

CAS, introduced in August, led to abrupt price swings on expiry day, making it difficult for traders to participate in the futures and options (F&O) segment.

Initial operational challenges, including the need for market participants to modify their trading software and the early closure of the continuous trading session (CTS), have kept some participants, including arbitrage funds, away. Passive funds such as exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and index funds have been more active in the auction.

For the rest of the market, Sebi has reduced the transition period between continuous trading (CTS) to CAS from five minutes to one minute.

CAS would now run from 3:30 pm to 3:40 pm. Trading in index derivatives contracts would continue until 3:45 pm. On expiry day however, trading in index derivatives contracts will stop at 3:30 pm.

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A muted order inflow upset Bhel's apple cart in Jul-Sep

Ashish Agrawal
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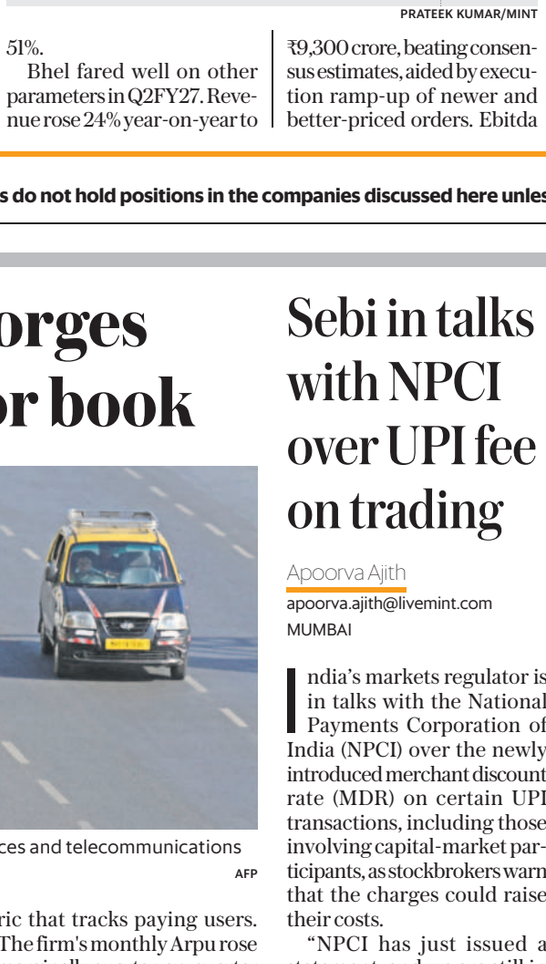
Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd's (Bhel) shares fell 6.4% on Thursday, after hitting a new 52-week high of ₹464 on Wednesday. The U-turn in investor sentiment was in reaction to order inflows sliding to a multi-quarter low of ₹4,000 crore in the September quarter (Q2FY27) from ₹26,700 crore in Q1FY27.

The decline was due to a temporary lull in large thermal power orders. While Bhel's order book at ₹2.6 trillion at the end of Q2 is equivalent to about 6.8 times its trailing twelve months revenue, which is robust, whether the Q2 decline is a blip or a trend is monitorable.

Its large exposure to thermal power amid rising shift to green energy in India, has been a lingering concern for investors. CLSA cautions that the entry of Chinese suppliers, JSW Toshiba, L&T (Larsen & Toubro) and Thermax into Bhel's core thermal equipment segment challenges its market dominance, and its order backlog seems to have peaked, while the stock is pricing in a lot more. So far in FY26, the stock has rallied 51%.

Driving force

Bhel's Q2FY27 revenue growth got a boost from execution picking up across segments.



Source: Company, Antique Stock Broking

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PRATEEK KUMAR/MINT

Bhel fared well on other parameters in Q2FY27. Revenue rose 24% year-on-year to ₹9,300 crore, beating consensus estimates, aided by execution ramp-up of newer and better-priced orders. Ebitda surged 77% to ₹1,026 crore and Ebitda margin expanded over 300 bps to 11% ahead of 8.5% consensus estimate, aided by 600 bps of gross margin expansion.

In H1FY27, revenue rose 31% to ₹17,000 crore while Ebitda increased to ₹1,530 crore against barely ₹44 crore a year ago. These positives prompted earnings upgrades by some domestic brokerages. JM Financial Institutional Securities revised its FY28 and FY29 Ebitda estimates upwards by 8.3% and 5.5%, respectively, adding that Bhel has started hiring after almost 15 years. Further, Bhel announced a capital expenditure of ₹500 crore for an additional manufacturing unit at Haridwar. It is also increasingly diversifying into transmission, rail transportation, coal, gasification, defence, industrial products sectors, to cut dependence on thermal power. But its FY27 price-to-earnings multiple of 42, as per *Bloomberg*, does not offer comfort amid shrinking order inflows. The management said overall, 2,260MW capacity was added during H1FY27, against a target of 4,790MW in FY27. An improvement in capacity addition in H2FY27 would be key.

Mark to Mark writers do not hold positions in the companies discussed here unless otherwise informed

BlackRock, ADIA, Norges vie for Jio IPO anchor book

FROM PAGE 1

institutional entities to secure share allotments before the main issue opens.

Up to 60% of the portion reserved for qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) can be allocated to anchor investors. Half of the anchor portion is reserved for domestic mutual funds. Final share allocations for the anchor book are scheduled to be finalized ahead of the opening of the retail and non-institutional bidding windows.

The three-day subscription window opens on 21 October. Shares are slated to start trading on 28 October.

Jio operates digital services and telecommunications infrastructure across India. Its existing equity holders include Meta Platforms Inc., Alphabet Inc.'s Google, KKR & Co., Silver Lake and General Atlantic.

At a press conference on Wednesday, which saw Anant Ambani, Shloka Ambani and other key CXOs of Jio Platforms seated in the front row, Uday Kotak, chairman of left lead merchant banker Kotak Investment Banking, said, "Reliance Industries (...) has always believed in making it attractive for investors to be long-term with the group."

Anant Ambani is an executive director on the board of RIL and non-executive director at Jio Platforms, while Shloka is the wife of managing director Akash Ambani.

Jio Platforms operates digital services and telecommunications infrastructure across India. AFP

Kotak said: "Akash Ambani has discussed in detail (at institutional roadshows) the various trends of Jio Platforms, including scale, growth, and the fact that significant capital expenditure has already been done and it's already put in place."

The Jio Platforms IPO comes at a time when telecom revenue per user has stagnated across quarters

Kotak said the price band factored in investor feedback from the roadshows, and it aimed to keep the offering attractive for investors. "We believe (the price band) is appropriate. We priced for investors to have returns in this IPO," he said.

The Jio Platforms IPO comes at a time when telecom revenue per user has stagnated across quarters. The average revenue per user (Arpu) is a closely watched industry metric that tracks paying users. The firm's monthly Arpu rose marginally quarter-on-quarter to ₹215.6 from ₹214 at the end of March. In the previous quarter too, the growth was flat.

Commenting on the sluggishness, Akash Ambani said, "Today, our Arpu is measured strictly against our licenced services, but we believe we can achieve higher realization per user from offerings outside of our licenced businesses—one key example being our voice AI service."

He said the company aims to deliver more value by launching new services across its customer base and extracting value from it. "While we always retain the ability to raise prices, our goal is to deliver more services to keep customers satisfied, rather than relying on price hikes as our primary lever for Arpu growth."

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Sebi in talks with NPCI over UPI fee on trading

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India's markets regulator is in talks with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) over the newly introduced merchant discount rate (MDR) on certain UPI transactions, including those involving capital-market participants, as stockbrokers warn that the charges could raise their costs.

"NPCI has just issued a statement, and we are still in talks with them," Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said at an event on Thursday.

MDR is a fee charged to merchants on certain digital payment transactions, with the proceeds distributed among participants in the payments ecosystem, including banks and payment service providers.

The new framework mandates an MDR of 0.4% on person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000. For transactions of ₹75,000 and above, the fee is capped at ₹300 per transaction. Capital-market transactions involving mutual funds, securities and brokers will attract a lower MDR of 0.02%, also subject to a cap of ₹300.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com

Apex court blow to Yes Bank's bond kill

FROM PAGE 1

bondholders, the banker said on the condition of anonymity. The fate of the past dues—from 2020 to now— could not be immediately ascertained.

The court made withering criticism of the central bank—"the RBI was a mere bystander, allowing the CET-1 ratio of Yes Bank to drop to an astonishing low of 0.6% while the business of Yes Bank was being carried out in a clandestine manner," the judgment said. The court added that making investors bear the consequences of administrative lapses is "highly unfair".

The court was not persuaded that the write-down was necessary to revive Yes Bank before the State Bank of India (SBI) infused capital into the lender. It said the need to rescue the bank could not override procedure. The court termed the conduct of Yes Bank, the RBI and the administrator in handling the investor money as "questionable".

"Payment of annual coupon rate shall remain unaffected by the outcome of these appeals and must be made in terms of the information memorandum," the bench said.

Yes Bank sank into a liquidity crisis in March 2020 as bad loans swelled, prompting the RBI to seize the lender and freeze withdrawals. A consortium of lenders led by SBI was assembled to orchestrate a massive bailout by injecting fresh equity capital. The administrator wrote down around ₹8,415 crore worth of AT-1 bonds as part of this exercise, prompting Axis Trustee Services and other bondholders to move court.

The court was not persuaded that the write-down was necessary to revive Yes Bank before the SBI infused capital into it. MINT

The bench also questioned if SBI, the RBI, the administrator and the government were aware that the Yes Bank reconstruction scheme did not have the bond write-down provision. It said the government's decision to remove the clause from the draft scheme appeared to favour bondholders, but the administrator subsequently wrote down the bonds.

Yes Bank sank into a liquidity crisis in March 2020 as bad loans swelled, prompting RBI to seize the lender

The court slammed Yes Bank for offering high-risk AT-1 bonds to individual investors, noting that RBI rules required these instruments to be offered only to institutional investors. "A tighter scrutiny ought to have been exercised before luring individual investors to such high-risk securities", it said.

Queries emailed to Yes Bank remained unanswered.

"If the ruling is implemented and the AT-1 bonds are fully restored, Yes Bank's common equity tier-1 (CET-1) capital ratio will be impacted," Venkatkrishnan Srinivasan, founder of Rockfort Fincap said.In the June quarter, Yes Bank reported a 34% increase in net profit to ₹1,071 crore, and remained well-capitalized with a capital adequacy ratio of 15.1% and CET-1 ratio of 14.0%.

"The ruling could improve investor protection, but also increase uncertainty about future AT-1 write-offs. Investors may become more cautious, particularly towards lower-rated banks, potentially increasing their borrowing costs," Srinivasan said.

"Stronger banks may continue issuing AT-1 bonds, while others may prefer equity-raising if the cost or availability of AT1 funding becomes less attractive," he said, adding the bond market may require greater clarity on the legal process for writing down such bonds to boost investor confidence.

DP Singh, former joint CEO of SBI Funds Management, said the latest developments could kill the AT1 bond market in India. "Institutional buyers are aware about AT-1 bonds and their risks. They cannot say that these bonds were mis-sold to them," Singh said.

"AT1 bonds as an institution is a global phenomenon and not restricted to India only. While I don't think AT1 itself will go away but yes, when such things happen, it does have an immediate fallout on the market," he said.

The ruling came as curbs have squeezed the demand for AT-1 bonds.

In March 2021, the Securities Exchange Board of India directed mutual funds—then biggest buyers of these papers—to value these bonds as 100-year instruments, prompted by the Yes Bank fiasco and concerns around mis-selling. As demand took a hit, AT-1 issuances declined as well.

This also hurt the pricing on such papers, making it difficult for banks to garner enough demand. While mutual funds drifted away, high net-worth individuals chasing higher returns moved in, keeping the AT1 bond market afloat in India.

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India is emerging as a hub for global auto ambitions

Stellantis, Hyundai and Suzuki are committing billions of dollars in new investments in India

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NEW DELHI

In a tough market where Detroit's auto giants folded, a new wave of foreign automakers is doubling down. Spurred by a domestic automobile boom and pressure from homegrown rivals, these manufacturers are committing tens of billions of dollars to build localized supply chains, establish global R&D hubs, and position India as an export powerhouse.

At least three global automakers -- Stellantis NV, Hyundai Motor Group and Suzuki Motor Corp -- have announced mega investment commitments in India in recent months, gunning for a bigger share of the world's third-largest car market. Dutch carmaker Stellantis was the latest to commit an additional ₹4,000 crore over the next three years. Earlier, Suzuki outlined a Rs 77,500 crore investment plan in August and Hyundai committed this week about Rs 1.48 trillion to India over the next five to seven years.

The aggressive investment push is also coming as several of these carmakers have lost market share to homegrown rivals over the past five years.

Hyundai's share of India's passenger vehicle retail market fell to 12.29% in FY26 from 17.36% in FY21, while Honda's declined to 1.29% from 2.99% and Renault's to 0.83% from 3.15%, according to dealership data.

In contrast, Tata Motors' share rose to 13.04% from 7.87% and Mahindra & Mahindra's to 13.42% from 5.35% over the same period. Maruti Suzuki, despite remaining the market leader, saw its share decline to 39.71% from 48.73%.

Stellantis accounted for just 0.25% of India's passenger vehicle retail market in FY26. There is no directly comparable FY21 figure because Stellantis was formed in 2021 through the merger of Fiat Chrysler and PSA as its Indian brands operated under their predecessor companies then.

India's passenger vehicle sales reached a record 4.64 million units in FY26, up 7.9% year-on-year, and rose 28% to 2.63 million units in April-September FY27. HT

For Stellantis, the investment will take its cumulative India investment to ₹15,000 crore and fund the development and rollout of 12 products over three years, including seven new nameplates and five refreshed models. The first of these products will be introduced in the second quarter of 2027. The company will also increase localization and manufacturing engineering as it seeks to make India a larger base for product development and exports.

"India is the key market to grow where we want to remain invested in and the second objective is to use the capabilities as a base for Asia Pacific and for the world," Shailesh Hazela, chief executive officer and managing director, Stellantis India, told Mint.

The commitments come alongside aggressive product cycles. Stellantis plans seven new nameplates by 2029, Maruti Suzuki is preparing seven SUVs by 2031, while Hyundai outlined a 26 product offensive through 2030.

Although there is no comparable fresh investment commitment, French carmaker Renault and Japanese automaker Honda are also renewing their India focus through new product launches and by identifying the country as an important priority market.

As per Hazela, Stellantis will launch products across internal combustion, hybrid and electric powertrains, while its India-built cars will be exported to over 50 countries. Its engineering centre and supplier base will play a larger role in developing these products. "Our aspiration is ... that we want to move from 48 months to 24 months as a product development," Hazela said, referring to Stellantis' target of halving development timelines by combining Indian engineering capabilities with global resources and partnerships.

The company is also expanding its use of Indian partnerships. Stellantis recently agreed to deepen its partnership with Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd beyond manufacturing into engineering, supply chain and purchasing. The two companies are working on a vehicle using a Tata Motors platform, with the Jeep model expected to be developed and manufactured in India for export markets.

Hyundai's commitment is significantly larger and spans the wider automotive ecosystem. Hyundai Motor Group has pledged $15.5 billion, or about ₹1.48 trillion, between 2026 and 2032, covering manufacturing expansion at Hyundai Motor India and Kia India, R&D infrastructure, local supplier development and future technologies. About $700 million of the investment is earmarked for its Indian R&D centre and vehicle testing track. It plans investments in areas such as EV charging, automotive finance, vehicle recycling, startups and other mobility services.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

RENEWING INDIA BETS

STELLANTIS will invest ₹4,000 crore, taking its cumulative India investment to ₹15,000 crore

HYUNDAI Motor Group pledged $15.5 billion (₹1.48 trillion) in India between 2026 and 2032

MARUTI Suzuki plans ₹77,500 crore investment through FY31, eyes 4 million vehicles annually

TATA Motors market share rose to 13.04% from 7.87%, while Mahindra's climbed to 13.42% from 5.35%

Tech Mahindra maintains its edge over Wipro in Sept qtr

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BENGALURU

Wipro Ltd shrank for a second straight quarter as its media, technology and healthcare businesses weakened, while Tech Mahindra Ltd leveraged its Orange deal to post its fastest September-quarter growth in three years on Thursday.

India's fourth-largest information technology (IT) company Wipro ended the second quarter of fiscal year 2026-27 (FY27) with revenue of $2.61 billion, down 0.1% sequentially and up 0.28% year-on-year. The decline was largely driven by its media, technology and healthcare clients, which together account for about a third of its business. It was also Wipro's first second-quarter revenue decline in three years.

About 1,000 miles north, at New Delhi's ITC Maurya, the country's fifth-largest IT company Tech Mahindra reported a stronger quarter, with revenue of $1.69 billion, up 1.99% sequentially and 6.7% year-on-year. Nearly all its incremental growth came from telecom clients, particularly a large deal with French telecom company Orange. Telecom providers account for a third of Tech Mahindra's business.

Wipro's revenue fell 0.1% to $2.6 billion on-quarter, while Tech Mahindra's revenue rose 1.9% to $1.69 billion

The performance was underpinned by management's optimistic outlook that market opportunities for Tech Mahindra would expand.

"Clients have always been expecting productivity. Maybe the expectations are slightly higher now. But what is also happening is, and we give a couple of examples, where there is a strong modernization imperative. There is a strong imperative to build sort of new and rationalized data estates, new applications are being created," said Mohit Joshi, chief executive of Tech Mahindra, at the firm's post-earnings press conference.

However, the mood was more subdued down south.

"In this quarter, the demand environment has remained largely unchanged. Our clients remain focused on efficiency and productivity, while increasingly looking to accelerate AI adoption and drive long-term value," said chief executive Srini Pallia, during the company's press conference from its Bengaluru office.

Pallia added it faced a client-specific issue and slow growth in healthcare that hurt its performance.

The company's commentary was reflected in its outlook, as management retained its July guidance of (-) 1.5%-0.5% growth in constant currency terms. To be sure, Tech Mahindra does not issue quarterly or full-year guidance, but its management expects more work around legacy technology modernization.

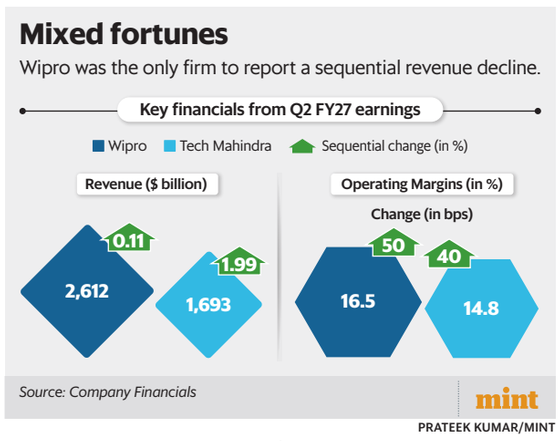
Investors in the US gave Wipro a thumbs-up, with its shares on the New York Stock Exchange jumping 3.9% as of 8pm IST.

The performance comes amid an uncertain demand environment, with clients holding back on discretionary technology spending amid macroeconomic uncertainty stemming from the West Asia war. Automation tools have also pushed Indian IT services firms to pass on cost savings to clients, potentially cannibalizing their own revenue in the hope that clients will use those savings to buy more services.

For now, Tech Mahindra sounded more optimistic than three of its larger peers. While the country's largest IT services company, Tata Consultancy Services Ltd, said the demand environment remains unchanged, and non-essential client spending is under scrutiny, the third-largest player HCL Technologies Ltd believes the environment remains fluid as the demand is influenced by various factors.

Both Wipro and Tech Mahindra beat analyst estimates. The 33 analysts polled by *Bloomberg* had expected Wipro to report revenue of $2.59 billion, while the 37 analysts covering Tech Mahindra expected revenue of $1.66 billion.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.



PRATEEK KUMAR/MINT

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, ग्वालियर, संभाग ग्वालियर
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प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम, ग्वालियर, संभाग ग्वालियर द्वारा निविदा क्रमांक 17/2026-27 ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक - 2026_MPPHC_543250_1, 2026_MPPHC_543251_1 2026_MPPHC_543252_1, ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक- आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 11.11.2026 तक** ऑनलाइन खरीदे जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण **Portal : https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128601/2026 **परियोजना यंत्री**

BHOPAL MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
(Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojna-PMAY)
Atal Bhawan, Tulsi Nagar, Link Road No. 2
Bhopal-462003, Madhya Pradesh
Email: bmcmp.hfa@gmail.com
Website: www.bmconline.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (NIT)
ONLINE TENDER ID-2026_UAD_543430_1

NIT No.671/PMAY/2026/e-tendering/ **Date: 15.10.2026**

Request For Proposal for Selection of Developer for Development of Affordable Housing at Deepdi Village, Bhojpur Road, Bhopal on PPP Mode Under Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojna -2.0.

Bhopal Municipal Corporation (BMC) intends to carry out development of Affordable Housing on proposed site at Deepdi Village, Bhojpur Road in Bhopal, on Public Private Partnership (PPP) mode. Land admeasuring about 3.03 Ha located at Deepdi Village, Bhojpur Road, Bhopal is proposed to be taken up for development under PMAY 2.0 (AHP).

Out of the total 3.03 Ha, 1.56 Ha shall be utilized for EWS (Non-Slum) Housing Component and the balance 1.47 Ha shall be allotted to the selected developer as Compensatory Land Parcel with Freehold Ownership Rights, subject to terms and conditions of the Concession-cum-Development Agreement. The prospective Bidder shall quote Sale Premium for the Freehold Ownership Rights on the Compensatory Land Parcel and undertake construction and development of the EWS (Non-Slum) Housing Component at the fixed cost defined in the RFP. The Project shall be implemented under Build, Finance and Transfer (BFT) model for EWS (Non-Slum) Housing Component and Build, Finance and Own (BFO) model for the Compensatory Land Parcel.

The selected developer shall construct and develop 704 EWS (Non-Slum) dwelling units along with required physical and social infrastructure including roads, water supply, sewerage, storm water drainage, solid waste management, power supply, street lighting and open spaces as part of the project.

Net Premium = Sale Premium for Compensatory Land Parcel - (Fixed Cost of EWS (Non-Slum) Housing Component - Beneficiary Contribution @ Rs. 8.0 Lakhs per unit)

Where:

Fixed Cost = Rs. 90.88 Cr

Beneficiary Contribution = Rs. 56.32 Cr

Project Gap = Rs. 34.56 Cr.

The Commissioner, Bhopal Municipal Corporation, Bhopal invites bids from reputed & experienced entities for development of the Project, through transparent online tendering process. RFP documents can be downloaded and purchased from GoMP online tendering portal **http://www.mptenders.gov.in**.

RFP Document Cost	:	**Rs. 1,00,000/-**
Online sale of RFP Document	:	**16.10.2026 to 16.11.2026 before 1730 hrs.**
Pre-Bid Meeting	:	**27.10.2026 at 1500 hrs.**
Bid Security	:	**Rs. 45.00 Lakhs**

Complete bids shall be submitted **Online only** by **16.11.2026 before 1730 hrs** through the online tendering portal **http://www.mptenders.gov.in**. The Physical Hard Copy Submission of Bids will not be accepted.

Sd/- **Executive Engineer (HFA)**
TN-884/026/027 **Bhopal Municipal Corporation, Bhopal**

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A Capacity Building Initiative of SEBI

VACANCY ANNOUNCEMENT

The National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM), established by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), invites applications from distinguished academicians, researchers, economists, commodity market professionals, policy and regulatory experts, experienced professionals and qualified individuals for the following positions.

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NISM–MCX Centre for Commodities Markets for providing leadership and strategic direction to the newly established centre.	1

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Last Date for Online Applications: November 15, 2026

For detailed information on eligibility criteria, educational qualifications, experience, remuneration, terms of appointment and other conditions, please visit the NISM website: **www.nism.ac.in**.

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Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Ltd. invites online open e-tenders from eligible Bidders for the **Design, Manufacture, Supply, Testing, Commissioning and Training of 60 No. Standard Gauge Cars for Hyderabad Metro Project and Comprehensive Maintenance of these 60 Numbers of Standard Gauge Cars as well as Depot M&Ps, Special Tools, Jigs and Fixtures, Testing and Diagnostic Equipment and Test Benches, Material Handling Equipment Etc., for a period of 15 years.**

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For detailed information log on to **www.delhimetrorail.com** or e-tendering website **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.**

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कार्यालय श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति, उज्जैन
www.shrimahakaleshwar.mp.gov.in
Fax : 0734-2550144/2550563
क्र./महा/स्टोर/2026/3435 **उज्जैन दिनांक 15.10.2026**

निविदा विज्ञप्ति (सुविधा प्रबंधन एवं मानव संसाधन)

Tender ID- 2026_MMPSU_542247_1

श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति द्वारा संचालित विभिन्न इकाइयों में सुविधा प्रबंधन हेतु कर्मचारी प्रदाय करने के लिये संबंधित निविदाकारों से ई-टेण्डर के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन दरें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं :-
कार्य का नाम : श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति में (सुविधा प्रबंधन) हेतु।
कार्य की अनुमानित लागत : रु. 25,00,00,000/-
अमानत राशि : रु. 75,00,000 /-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेन्ट की लागत : रु. 50,000/-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेंट क्रय करने एवं बिड प्रस्तुत करने की दिनांक ई-टेण्डरिंग पोर्टल **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर Tender ID : 2026_MMPSU_542247_1 देखी जा सकती है। पोर्टल में उल्लेखित दिनांक अनुसार कार्यवाही सुनिश्चित करें।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128616/2026 **उप प्रशासक एवं डिप्टी कलेक्टर**

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राष्ट्रीय डिज़ाइन संस्थान
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN
AHMEDABAD

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No. NIT/2026-27/8469-77 **Date: 14.10.2026**
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 424/2026-27
निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई-टेन्डरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु.)
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-	
Jaipur Bhilwara (SH-12) BOT Road" for a period of 01 Year. UBN: RRC2627SLOB00699	**5223.06 Lakh**

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in तथा http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।
महाप्रबंधक

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Phone No - 02582-225403 Toll Free No-1800 233 5264
Website:www.bhusawalnp.org / Email-id-bmcbsl1882@gmail.com
जा.क्र./भुनप/आरोग्य/१४९/२०२६ **दिनांक :– १५/१०/२०२६**

Extension of E- Tender Notice 01

Bhusawal Municipal Council, Health department invites E-Tender Notice for the Collecting wet and dry waste from households and businesses for Bhusawal Municipal Council, Dist-Jalgaon for more details, terms and conditions given in tender id no.2026_DMA_1337180_1 is to be retender and new tender id no.2026_DMA_1337180_2 Please log on to website http://mahatenders.gov.in.
Date:- 15/10/2026
Place:- Bhusawal Municipal Council

Sd/-
Chief Officer
Muncipal council Bhusawal

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
DEONAR ABATTOIR
Department- General Manager, Deonar Abattoir
"e-TENDER NOTICE"

The Municipal Commissioner of BMC invites Tenders for the following work returnable on the due date **24.10.2026**

Name of the work:-Work of erection of Metallic structural canopy & enclosure to cattle unloading & maintenance department at Deonar Abattoir.

Sr. No.	Bid No.	Bid start date	Bid end date	Tender Price	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)
1	GEM/2026/B/8160980	14.10.2026	24.10.2026	Rs. 15,972/-+ 18% GST	Rs. 1,05,500/-

Interested eligible contractors may obtain further information regarding e-Tender is available on GeM portal (**https://gem.gov.in**) and on BMC website **https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/** under (For partners--> Tenders-view--> Select Department - Deonar Abattoir) or from the office of General Manager, Deonar Abattoir, Opp. Govandi Railway Station, Govandi, Mumbai - 43.

PRO/1706/ADV/2026-27
AVOID SELF MEDICATION

Sd/-
General Manager
Deonar Abattoir

How Lakshmi Venu ended with less

Business restructuring leaves the TVS siblings—Lakshmi Venu and Sudarshan Venu—with very different assets and growth trajectories

Varun Sood & Satish John
BENGALURU/MUMBAI

At the heart of the dispute in the Venu Srinivasan family is a fundamental question: did a restructuring of the TVS group leave the two siblings with unequal business inheritances?

Lakshmi Venu, 42 years old, who once ran the larger company by revenue, now heads an auto parts business that has struggled to grow, while her younger brother, Sudarshan Venu, 37, heads the holding company that controls TVS Motor Co. Ltd, India's third-largest two-wheeler maker, and the group's lending businesses.

The restructuring, over a series of decisions that started in 2022, shifted a valuable TVS Motor stake out of the business Lakshmi ran, leaving the siblings with very different assets and growth trajectories.

The division was not an equal split of the businesses as they stood before the restructuring, a *Mint* review of public filings and annual reports showed.

Sundaram-Clayton, then led by Lakshmi, owned 50.26% of TVS Motor and counted the automaker's revenue and profits in its consolidated financials. The subsequent restructuring placed the TVS Motor stake under TVS Holdings Ltd, today led by Sudarshan, while the manufacturing business, including its US operations, remained with the reconstituted Sundaram-Clayton. The latter also carried substantial debt and did not receive proceeds from an earlier sale of TVS Motor shares. The changes took place before the family signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) on control, non-compete obligations and brand usage in March 2024.

The divergence has since become more pronounced. Sundaram-Clayton's revenue was ₹2,026 crore in the year ended March, broadly unchanged from three years earlier, while its profit of ₹252 crore included a one-time gain of about ₹513 crore, largely from a Chennai land sale. Excluding that gain, the company would have reported a loss of ₹186 crore. Over the same three-year period, TVS Motor's revenue rose 76% to ₹56,069 crore, while its profit more than doubled to ₹3,693 crore in the year ended March.

The contrast underscores how the two businesses have diverged since the restructuring. "The valuable asset from the old Sundaram-Clayton, which is the share in TVS Motor, was taken away. So, it was never really a fair split," said a friend of the Srinivasan family, who also serves as an independent board member at a Chennai-based conglomerate.

The family dispute has escalated, with Venu Srinivasan's wife, Mallika Srinivasan, challenging her husband's assertion that all family matters have been settled. In an interview with *Mint* earlier this week, she said no financial settlement had been reached within the family and asserted that their daughter, Lakshmi Venu, has the same rights as her brother, Sudarshan Venu.

Emails sent to Venu Srinivasan and Mallika Srinivasan seeking comment went unanswered.

In the first week of May 2022, the siblings took the top jobs at two connected companies. On 5 May, Sudarshan became managing director of TVS Motor. In the same week, elder sister Lakshmi took the same title at Sundaram-Clayton, the group's auto parts maker. Both had earlier served as joint managing directors of the respective companies.

Lakshmi Venu and Sudarshan Venu.

DISPUTE DEEPENS

THE restructuring shifted a valuable TVS Motor stake out of the business Lakshmi Venu ran

LAKSHMI VENU now heads an auto parts business that has struggled to grow

THE division was not an equal split of the businesses as they stood before the restructuring

MALLIKA Srinivasan has challenged her husband's assertion that all family matters are settled

At the time, Lakshmi's company was larger by revenue. Sundaram-Clayton manufactured aluminium components for vehicle makers and also owned 50.26% of TVS Motor. As a result, it included the automaker's sales and profits in its consolidated financial statements.

In financial year 2022-23, Sundaram-Clayton reported revenue of ₹33,564 crore and profit of ₹1,333 crore. Almost all of this came from TVS Motor, which reported revenue of ₹31,974 crore and profit of ₹1,309 crore in the 12 months to 31 March that year. Sundaram-Clayton's standalone auto parts business generated revenue of ₹2,074 crore and profit of ₹273 crore.

In effect, Lakshmi ran the holding company, while Sudarshan ran the operating company that generated most of its revenue and profit.

Over the next 15 months, the group underwent a series of changes. In September 2022, Sundaram-Clayton took full control of the group's loss-making US factory by paying ₹317 crore to a TVS Motor subsidiary for the 50% stake it did not already own. In March 2023, it set aside ₹2,347 crore from its accumulated profits to issue shareholders a special class of shares carrying a fixed return. Much of that money had been generated by Sundaram-Clayton's sale of about 7% of TVS Motor in two tranches during the year ended March 2022, which yielded ₹2,094 crore.

The restructuring followed. On 16 June 2023, TVS Holdings Pvt. Ltd, the family company that owned Sundaram-Clayton, was merged into it. On 17 July, Sundaram-Clayton was renamed TVS Holdings. A second family company, VS Investments Pvt. Ltd, was merged into it on 4 August. Finally, on 11 August, the auto parts business was transferred to a separate company, which took the Sundaram-Clayton name.

After the changes, TVS Holdings retained the stake in TVS Motor and, through it, the group's lending business. A month later, in September 2023, Sudarshan became managing director of TVS Holdings. The company closed its small trading business in October 2024 and now holds investments.

The reconstituted Sundaram-Clayton, under Lakshmi, retained the manufacturing operations, including the US business. It also carried debt of ₹1,082 crore at the end of March 2023, which rose to ₹1,417 crore by the end of March 2024. Importantly, Sundaram-Clayton did not receive any proceeds from the TVS Motor share sale.

On 20 March 2024, the family signed an agreement setting out management control of the two businesses. Sudarshan, together with his father, Venu Srinivasan, would control TVS Holdings and the businesses under it, including TVS Motor, TVS Credit and Home Credit. Lakshmi, also together with her father, would control Sundaram-Clayton.

The MoU, which covered non-compete clauses and brand usage, was disclosed to the stock exchanges by the three listed companies—TVS Holdings, TVS Motor and Sundaram-Clayton—on 22 March 2024. It didn't have any further details on ownership, however. As the sole trustee of VS Trust, Venu Srinivasan controls 46.83% of Sundaram-Clayton and 66.55% of TVS Holdings.

An expert pointed to the relevant regulation under the Securities Exchange Board of India (Sebi) rules. "Since mid-2023, Sebi has required promoters, promoter-group members, directors, key managerial personnel and certain other insiders to inform a listed company within two working days of any agreement they enter into, among themselves or with others, that directly, indirectly or potentially impacts its management or control, or imposes a restriction or liability on it. This applies even when the company isn't a party, and covers later amendments too. The company must then disclose the agreement to the exchanges in a prescribed format," said Sumit Agrawal, a partner at Regstreet Law Advisers and a former Sebi officer.

"A document described as a brand or non-compete arrangement can still fall within the rule if it bears on who controls the company," Agrawal said. "Whether any particular disclosure was complete is ultimately for the company, the exchanges and Sebi to examine. The investor's interest is simple: the market should know who controls a listed company, and on what terms."

The business changes that preceded the March 2024 MoU have led at least one executive to describe the outcome as "a story of two inheritances that are not equal in size".

"What is clear is that the sister who once ran the main company now runs the smaller business, while the brother runs the family's most valuable asset," the executive said. "The question is why Lakshmi agreed to the business changes even before the control agreement was signed."

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Social media influencers have a new playground: Indian reality TV

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NEW DELHI

Indian reality television, long challenged by high costs and inadequate returns, is increasingly turning to social media influencers and creators to headline shows, particularly streaming originals. Titles such as Lock Upp, The 50, Social Currency, The Traitors, Rise and Fall and The Tribe have tapped into creators' popularity and fan bases, creating a new category of shows and an additional revenue stream for these personalities.

Entertainment industry experts say this is a natural progression. Reality shows have always relied on personalities who can draw eyeballs and keep audiences engaged. Today, creators already have large, highly involved communities that follow their lives, opinions and personalities. Their growing presence on such shows reflects how they now command audiences in their own right. They can also be more cost-effective investments than tentpole properties featuring film stars or top television actors.

Reality TV turning to social media influencers to headline shows.

"The rise of these shows is a natural extension of how entertainment itself has changed. The audience has moved from consuming celebrities only through traditional television and films to building very personal relationships with creators online," said Mansi Panpalia, a former gaming creator and co-founder of Opraah, an influencer marketing firm.

From a platform's perspective, it also makes sense, she added. "You're not starting with an unknown cast and spending months building familiarity. These creators come with an existing audience and strong fan communities, which gives the show an immediate distribution layer," she added.

Reality TV used to manufacture stars and now it rents them, said Amit Dhawan, co-founder at Crack'd, a user-generated content and influencer agency. He pointed out that casting wants a fanbase that votes, not one that watches. For instance, finance and education creators rarely get cast. Their audiences trust them but won't fight for them.

Reality shows have always relied on personalities who can draw eyeballs and keep audiences engaged

The shift has largely come from how the definition of celebrity has changed, agreed Anushree Jain, founder of SocialTAG, an influencer marketing agency. Social media creators already have audiences that follow their personalities, opinions and everyday lives, so they bring an existing level of familiarity and engagement to a reality format.

There is also a clear overlap between creator content and reality television. Audiences are used to watching creators in relatively unfiltered, personality-driven formats, making the transition to a longer-form reality show feel more natural than it might have a few years ago, Jain added.

Creators are particularly well suited to this because they understand attention, according to Suyog Jadhav, co-founder of B.I.G Media Co, an influencer marketing and creative agency.

"They know how to communicate, create conversation and keep people interested. A reality show can then extend that conversation across Instagram, YouTube, memes, fan pages and everything else that exists around the show," Jadhav said.

Fees for these shows can vary significantly depending on a creator's scale, audience quality, popularity, previous television or entertainment experience and the format. Jag Chima, co-founder at IPLIX Media, an influencer marketing and talent management agency, said producers are increasingly looking beyond the creator with the largest following. They want personalities who can drive conversation, with a distinct point of view, strong fan communities, entertainment value and the ability to sustain audience interest beyond short-form content.

"Many creators are not joining these shows purely for the immediate payout. They are there because that reality show can compress three years of audience building, into three months," said Pratish Mepani, founder and creative director, Starting Monday Design and Branding Co.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com

SRTT delays reply, says Mistry; Trust cites charity orders

Yash Tiwari
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MUMBAI

Former Tata trustee Mehli Mistry told the Maharashtra charity commissioner on Thursday that the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) was delaying its reply to his complaints, citing the commissioner's orders dated 15 and 18 May, which barred the trust from holding meetings until the inspector's inquiry report is submitted.

Former Tata Trustee Mistry is not seeking reinstatement. MINT

In a handwritten submission seen by *Mint*, Mistry's lawyer argued that filing a reply "would not constitute a decision regarding the administration, management or composition of the trust." He alleged that failing to reply even after four months was deliberate and intended to delay the proceedings.

SRTT's lawyers, however, told the deputy charity commissioner that the trust could not file a reply because meetings were barred. They argued that some of Mistry's claims were incorrect and would rebut them in detail.

Mistry's affidavit clarified that he is not seeking reinstatement. He said his complaint is that, as a trustee, he faces unlimited personal liability and cannot be held responsible for breaches by other trustees that he had flagged.

The commissioner's office also heard related disputes on Thursday. The Bai Hirabai Jamshetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution challenged Mistry's locus to contest trustee changes, arguing he was not removed but ceased to be a trustee when his term expired. "The objector was not removed as a trustee but ceased to be a trustee as his term of appointment expired by efflux of time on 28.10.2025," its reply stated.

The trust submitted that a resolution proposing Mistry's reappointment had not passed, leaving him without a fresh term. It also argued that the original will and codicil do not impose a blanket requirement that trustees be Parsis or Zoroastrians or permanent residents of Navsari or the Bombay Presidency.

Mistry, in his complaint, objected to the proposed appointment of Noel Tata in place of Vijay Singh, whose term expired on 14 August 2026, citing Clauses 6 and 18 of the trust deed dated 7 December 1923, which stipulate that trustees must be practising Zoroastrians of the Parsi community.

Mehli Mistry, in his complaint, objected to the proposed appointment of Noel Tata in place of Vijay Singh

Countering this, the trust said Mistry himself had served a three-year term and had given his "categorical approval" to the reappointments of Vijay Singh and Venu Srinivasan during his tenure. Both matters will be heard next on 5 November.

Meanwhile, the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), which owns 27.98% of Tata Sons, sought more time on 5 October to respond to complaints of alleged mismanagement in the trust's role in the affairs of Tata Sons, the group's holding company.

Air India's new CEO tightens spending as losses mount

Abhishek Law
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NEW DELHI

Less than a month after taking over as chief executive of Air India, Tewolde Gebremariam has initiated belt-tightening measures to counter mounting losses and rising operating costs. The airline has set up a dedicated team to identify cost savings across the group and tightened spending approvals, even as external shocks complicate its turnaround efforts. The Air India Group includes the flagship airline and its budget carrier, Air India Express.

The steps were announced on 12 October via the firm's internal digital noticeboard, Workplace, said an executive familiar with the development. *Mint* has reviewed a copy of the communication.

"To support this effort (cost cut), a multidisciplinary, cross-functional cost savings team has been established on full-time basis to identify cost-saving opportunities across the organisation," Gebremariam wrote. "Effective 1 October, approvals will now be routed through the HOD, CXO and CEO, ensuring greater rigour, transparency and alignment in decision-making across the organization," he added.

The measures mark a shift in priorities under Gebremariam. Under his predecessor Campbell Wilson, who led Air India after its return to the Tata Group in 2022, the focus was on rebuilding the airline, integrating Vistara with Air India and AirAsia India with Air India Express, placing large aircraft orders, and modernizing the fleet. Gebremariam's task is to convert that investment into better operational performance and sustainable profitability.

The cost-cutting push follows Gebremariam's first town hall with employees on 28 September, where he outlined a shift towards profitable and sustainable growth. He emphasized boosting revenue productivity—including revenue per available seat kilometer—and controlling costs, while prioritizing safety, operational reliability, and better coordination across the group. The new team and tighter approval matrix give that financial-discipline agenda a more formal structure.

Air India CEO Tewolde Gebremariam has launched a group-wide cost-cutting drive less than a month after taking charge.

In his message, Gebremariam acknowledged external pressures. "While external factors remain beyond our control, how we manage costs is something each of us can influence every day. Cost savings cannot be driven by a single team or function alone; it requires the active participation and commitment of every employee." The team will "systematically review all expenditure and identify cost-saving opportunities across functions," he wrote.

The new team and tighter approval matrix give that financial-discipline agenda a more formal structure

To this end, an employee reward scheme will recognize ideas to cut costs or improve revenue, including contract renegotiations, resource utilization, procurement improvements and waste reduction.

External disruptions also raised operating costs. Closure of Pakistani airspace since April 2025 has forced Air India to take longer routes on westbound services, raising fuel consumption, flying time and crew cost. Wilson estimated the impact at around ₹4,000 crore over a year. West Asia conflict has added to disruptions and supply-chain shortages have delayed parts of fleet-modernization programme. The AI-171 crash in June 2025 also brought the airline under increased regulatory scrutiny.

"Ongoing airspace closures, the conflict in the Middle East and resulting operational disruptions, and persistently high jet fuel costs continue to place significant pressure on airlines across the industry," he wrote.

Higher fuel cost has added to the pressure. Gebremariam said savings would help the airline reinvest in operations and better customer experience.

Govt unlikely to sell spectrum this fiscal

Second time in a row Centre will miss timeline, according to officials

Jatin Grover
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NEW DELHI

Missing the auctions in a particular year could hit the government's future revenue, as spectrum is a key source of revenue besides licence fees. MINT

The government is unlikely to hold a spectrum auction this fiscal year, the second time in a row the government will miss the Cabinet's timeline for selling mobile airwaves, according to two government officials and industry executives familiar with the matter.

Telecom companies have little reason to buy more, as the three private-sector operators spent heavily at earlier auctions and few spectrum renewals are due this year. The telecom department is also reclaiming airwaves from operators such as Aircel and Reliance Communications, which is facing insolvency proceedings. There is an upcoming renewal for Vodafone Idea, and, if needed, spectrum can be administratively assigned to ensure continuity until the next auctions, a government official, one of the persons mentioned earlier, said.

"It is unlikely the auctions will be held this fiscal. The regulator's recommendations are yet to be discussed internally, and then a back reference to the regulator will be sent on the reserve price and other terms," the person added. Simply put, the telecom department must first review the regulator's recommendations and then communicate its acceptance or rejection to the regulator, with reasons and clarifications.

The previous auction, in June 2024, raised ₹11,340.78 crore from the ₹96,320 crore of spectrum on offer, the third-lowest since competitive bidding began in 2010. Operators had little appetite after the 2022 5G auction, which saw spectrum worth ₹1.5 trillion sold. Telecom spectrum refers to the radio frequencies used by mobile phones and wireless networks to transmit voice and data. The government auctions these frequencies for 20 years. Spectrum determines network coverage, speed and service quality, making it the backbone of the telecom industry.

Queries emailed to DoT, Reliance Jio and Vodafone Idea remained unanswered till the press time.

"A fairly reasonable amount of spectrum has already been distributed. We have had a very successful 5G round, the round before the last one. As and when requirements come up and as we move on towards 5G standalone and then coming up to 6G, depending on the spectrum bands that are required, we will certainly hold the auction," communications minister Jyotiraditya Scindia said in response to *Mint's* questions at the India Mobile Congress in New Delhi last week. "We do not have a surfeit of spectrum, but we also want to monitor when there is a desirable amount of demand, and then we will hold the auction," he added.

Missing the auctions in a particular year could hit the government's future revenue, as spectrum is a key source of revenue besides licence fees. In fiscal year 2027, it expects to earn ₹42,411 crore from spectrum auctions and administrative allotment of spectrum, according to a 6 August report by the parliament committee on communications and information technology.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

SPECTRUM BLUES

DoT is reclaiming spectrum from insolvency-hit Aircel and Reliance Communications

VODAFONE Idea may get spectrum administratively until the next auction

THE 2024 auction raised just ₹11,341 crore, the third-lowest since 2010

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
B.Y.L. NAIR CH. HOSPITAL
Dr. A. L. Nair Road, Mumbai Central, Mumbai -400 008
No. NMS/551 Date: 15.10.2026
Short E-Tender Notice

NO	Description	Start Date	End Date
1	Inj. Non ionic contrast for intravascular use Iodine concentration 400 mg/ml 100 ml Vial (GEM ID: GEM/2026/B/8144559)	As per Gem Portal	As per Gem Portal
2	Inj. Non ionic contrast for intravascular use Iodine concentration 300 mg/ml100 ml Vial (GEM Id: GEM/2026/B/8144226)	As per Gem Portal	As per Gem Portal
3	Inj. Non ionic contrast for intravascular use Iodine concentration 350-370 mg/ml 100 ml Vial (GEM ID: GEM/2026/B/8143632)	As per Gem Portal	As per Gem Portal
4	KONICA DRY FILM FOR DRY CAMERA SIZE 14" X 17" (GEM ID: GEM/2026/B/8141548)	As per Gem Portal	As per Gem Portal

https://gem.gov.in
Contact Person: Dr. Chetana Kantharia (Dy. Dean)
Tel No. 022-23027109, E-mail ID: medical.store.nair@gmail.com

PRO/1705/ADV/2026-27
AVOID SELF MEDICATION

Sd/-
Dean
BYL Nair Ch. Hospital

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER
GUJARAT ENERGY (Erstwhile Gujarat Gas Limited)

Gujarat Energy Limited (GEL), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description
354397	Supply, Installation and Configuration of Secure Internet Proxy Solution for Gujarat Energy Limited
354399	Supply & Installation of Backup Appliances at PR & DR DC of GEL with Licenses for a period of 5 Years
353437	Appointment of Service Provider For Centralized Customer Call Centre (CCCC) for GEL operating area
353747	GIS Data Create, Capture, Develop And Update Land & Gas Features In GEL GIS Database
354121	Appointment of service provider for Environment related jobs & services for GEL Natural Gas facilities

Interested bidders can access the Tender Documents and related updates on https://geltender.nprocure.com and https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/. Interested bidders are advised to regularly visit above websites to stay updated on the aforementioned tender.

In the court of Mr.T.J.Patel Sir, Small Cause Court, Vadodara
(E-1,4th Floor, District Court Diwalipura, Vadodara)
PUBLIC NOTICE

Case No.	SMST R 141/2023
Plaintiff advocate	A.B. SOLANKI

PLAINTIFF: GUJARAT ENERGY TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED.
ADDRESS: SARDAR PATEL VIDHYUT BHAVAN, RACE COURSE, VADODARA 390 007

V/S

DEFENDENT: ALOK TRADE & INVESTMENT (PRV.) LIMITED
ADDRESS:- 1) OFFICE:-PLOT NO.A-1/906, 907, GIDC UMARGAM, TA-VAPI, DI-VALSAD 396171
2. 12/14, KAZI SAIYAD STREET, RAVJI MENSION, MASJID BANDAR, MUMBAI 400 009

The above mentioned plaintiffs have filed a claim against you defendant/s under Order 37 of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 for Rs.1,60,937/- and interest thereon. Therefore, you or your lawyer will appear for further proceedings within 10 days from the date of publication of this public summons.

If you fail to do so, you will be liable to pay the claim amount of Rs.1,60,937/- at any time after the expiry of the period of 10 days, together with interest, if any, as the Hon'ble Court may direct. Permission to defend may be obtained if you can satisfy the court by affidavit or otherwise that the claim can be defended on merits or that it is reasonable to allow you to defend the claim.

This day 09/06/2026, I have signed and affixed the court stamp.

Prepared By (A.M.Jadav) Assistant | **Compare By (P.M.Rathva) Sr.Clerk** | Court Seal | **(S.M.Rathod) I/C Registrar Small Cause Court Vadodara**

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UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(₹ in crs.)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2025	Year ended Mar 31, 2026
		(Unaudited)		(Audited)
1	Total income from operations	1,400.20	978.45	4,065.57
2	Net profit for the period (before tax, exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	335.30	193.96	839.29
3	Net profit for the period before tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	335.30	193.96	832.26
4	Net profit for the period after tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	260.49	150.45	647.32
5	Total comprehensive income for the period [comprising profit for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)]	259.96	150.11	645.97
6	Paid up equity share capital	860.97	679.83	737.72
7	Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve)			5,241.04
8	Securities Premium Account			3,229.00
9	Net worth			5,978.76
10	Paid up debt capital / outstanding debt			37,890.77
11	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	-	-	-
12	Debt equity ratio	4.79	6.90	6.34
13	Earnings per share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) -			
	1. Basic:	3.03	2.26	9.56
	2. Diluted:	3.02	2.26	9.54
14	Capital redemption reserve	-	-	-
15	Debenture redemption reserve	-	-	-
16	Debt service coverage ratio	NA	NA	NA
17	Interest service coverage ratio	NA	NA	NA

Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited

1. The above is an extract of the Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended September 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended September 30, 2026 are available on the National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. website (URL: https://nseindia.com) and BSE Limited website (URL: https://www.bseindia.com) and on the website of the Company (URL: https://homefinance.adityabirlacapital.com/).
2. For the other line items referred to in Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and are available on the National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. website (URL: https://nseindia.com) and BSE Limited website (URL: https://www.bseindia.com) and on the website of the Company (URL: https://homefinance.adityabirlacapital.com/).
3. These financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on October 15, 2026. The statutory auditor of the Company has carried out the limited review of the aforesaid results.
4. Operating business segment results are reviewed regularly by the Company's Chief Operating Decision Maker (Board of Directors) to make decisions about resources to be allocated to the segments and assess their performance. Business segment is the primary segment comprising of 'Housing finance'. As the Company operates only in a single business segment, no segment information thereof is given as required under Ind AS 108.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of **Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited**

Place : Mumbai
Date : October 15, 2026

Pankaj Gadgil
Managing Director & CEO
DIN: 08521239

LOANS INVESTMENTS INSURANCE PAYMENTS

Fairfax faces big IDBI staff test

Syncing IDBI's PSU culture with Fairfax's private-sector approach could prove harder than securing the deal

Subhana Shaikh & Shayan Ghosh
MUMBAI

Fairfax Financial Holdings has cleared the government's hurdle to acquire IDBI Bank, but its bigger test lies within the lender, where employees are pushing back and the work culture remains closer to a state-run entity.

Integration is hard in any deal, and harder when a bank that has operated in the public sector for decades must adopt private-sector practices, according to experts. A unionized workforce adds to the challenge.

Within hours of the Union cabinet approving the sale, bank unions voiced their opposition. The United Forum of IDBI Officers & Employees said it "strongly opposes" the sale of a controlling stake to a "foreign entity". The Centre sought to reassure workers that their service interests would be protected under the agreement.

"IDBI is not a typical private bank and remains closer to a PSU (public sector undertaking) in culture, so the harder part for Fairfax will be moving its unionized workforce to a more private-sector way of working," said Rajeev Suneja, founder and director of Sparrow Capital Advisors Pvt. Ltd.

Employee concerns have also surfaced following earlier privatizations. The Tata Group acquired a 100% stake in Air India in January 2022. In 2023, pilots sought Ratan Tata's intervention over the airline management's decision to unilaterally change their salary structure and service conditions, *PTI* reported.

This is not IDBI Bank's first restructuring. In 2005, the Industrial Development Bank of India, then a development finance institution, merged with the bank. The lender has since received ₹25,000 crore in capital from the Centre. In 2019, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) acquired a 51% stake for ₹21,624 crore, in a deal described at the time as a "win-win situation" for both parties.

Within hours of the Union cabinet approving the sale, IDBI Bank's workers voiced their opposition. REUTERS

Following the change in ownership, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) classified IDBI Bank as a private-sector lender for regulatory purposes. However, a former bank executive who was present during the 2019 transition said the qualification was significant: the change in classification did not necessarily translate into a corresponding shift in the bank's internal culture.

> IDBI Bank is a private bank on paper but remains a public-sector entity in spirit, say experts

IDBI Bank had 20,693 employees as of 31 March, up from 19,731 a year ago.

"IDBI Bank still has a chief vigilance officer appointed by the Central Vigilance Commission. It still comes under the Right to Information (RTI) Act, which the private sector does not," the former executive said.

According to a senior consultant, IDBI Bank is a private bank on paper but remains a public-sector entity in spirit. How Fairfax handles the integration will be closely watched.

The fate of CSB Bank's current management will also be worth tracking, particularly if Fairfax chooses to merge the two lenders, the consultant added. The decision could indicate whether Fairfax is willing to entrust CSB Bank's leadership with running a much larger institution.

Mint reported on Wednesday that private-sector lender CSB Bank Ltd is expected to be merged with IDBI Bank following the Centre's decision to sell a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank to Fairfax. The Canadian financial services holding company would either have to sell its 40% stake in Thrissur, Kerala-headquartered CSB Bank or merge it with IDBI Bank, as RBI regulations do not allow an entity to own two banks.

If the two lenders merge, they will face the usual integration challenges, including cultural differences, technology migration and unions. However, Suneja said the process could be relatively smoother than in a typical bank merger. IDBI Bank is several times the size of CSB Bank, while CSB has already undergone a transition from an older private-sector bank to Fairfax ownership, he said.

IDBI Bank accounted for 1.2% of the banking system's loans and deposits at the end of the three months through June. In comparison, CSB Bank—where Fairfax has a 40% stake—accounted for 0.2% of system loans and deposits.

"The government can't keep pumping in equity now and then to make sure the bank survives or passes through this," said Nirav Shah, managing director at Equirus Capital.

Merging two banks also brings cultural challenges, Shah said, adding that changes to processes, systems, technology and operating efficiencies are part of any transaction. Fairfax, he said, could attract strong leadership to overhaul IDBI Bank's operations. He pointed to the progress Fairfax has made at CSB, which he described as a union-driven, local bank.

The change in ownership could also broaden the pool of talent available to IDBI Bank. Although public-sector banks hire from the market, differences between market-linked compensation and pay structures for internal cadres can create friction.

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For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

IDBI Bank's Wednesday mystery on IDBI deal of Fairfax

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MUMBAI

There's something about Wednesdays for IDBI Bank investors. Over the past year, the lender's shares have delivered their strongest average returns midweek, only to lose ground the following day.

A *Mint* analysis of market data reveals a curious pattern, seemingly driven by investors betting on a breakthrough in the bank's long-awaited privatization at the Union cabinet's meetings that are typically held on Wednesdays.

The stock generated an average return of 1.08% on Wednesdays over the last one year, shows the analysis. And Thursdays saw an average return of negative 0.8%, implying traders booked profits in the very next session.

After Wednesday, Fridays brought the highest average return of 0.7%; followed by Tuesdays, where the average return was 0.14%. The lowest average was at negative 0.9% recorded on Mondays.

The Wednesday cheer anomaly becomes even more evident seeing the stock's biggest single-day gains. Of IDBI Bank's ten largest single-day price spikes over the past year, half or five of them happened on a Wednesday.

Five of IDBI's 10 top single-day gains were on Wednesday. MINT

The single largest one-day gain occurred on Wednesday, 17 June 2026, when the bank's shares surged 17% at market close. "Wednesday recorded higher average trading volume than most other weekdays, but this appears to be driven by a few event-led spikes, rather than a consistent weekday effect," said Hitesh Tailor, technical research analyst at Choice Broking. "Over the last year, Wednesday's average volume was around 22.28 million shares against an overall average of 17.82 million, approximately 25% higher."

However, excluding the two exceptional sessions on 17 June and 14 October, Wednesday's average falls to around 15.3 million shares, below the overall average. And excluding these two spike sessions, the average returns for the day go down to 0.59%.

This indicates trading activity is linked more closely to major announcements and sharp price movements than to a particular day of the week, Tailor added.

This Wednesday, 14 October, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved sale of a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank, held by the government and Life Insurance Corp., to Canada Inc., the parent entity of Fairfax Financial Holdings, for ₹52,878 crore. The stock closed 8.98% higher on 14 October on expectation of a government announcement, which came late evening.

The transaction will trim government's direct holding to 15% and LIC's stake to 19%, leaving them with a combined minority shareholding of 34%. The move is part of government's broader strategy to pare its investments in non-core assets and financial institutions that have previously received bailout support.

And not surprisingly as per the trend, 15 October, a Thursday, saw a sharp decline. Profit booking battered the stock, and it ended 8.1% lower at ₹83.07 on the National Stock Exchange, erasing almost all gains of the previous session.

CSB Bank's future hinges

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MUMBAI

For CSB Bank, the next big share-price catalyst may lie not in quarterly earnings but in a decision that could reshape its ownership.

Canada's Fairfax Financial Holdings, which owns 40% of the Kerala-based lender, must choose between selling its stake and merging CSB with IDBI Bank after the government approved the sale of a 60.72% stake in IDBI to a Fairfax subsidiary for ₹52,878 crore. The outcome could determine not just CSB's valuation, but also its scale and growth prospects, analysts said. The Reserve Bank of India bars an entity from being the promoter of two banks simultaneously.

After a difficult year, CSB Bank and IDBI Bank are back on investors' radar amid the prospect of a merger. Both stocks rallied early on Thursday, but the optimism soon faded, with both surrendering their gains and slipping into the red amid profit-booking. IDBI Bank and CSB Bank shares ended 8% and 3% lower, respectively, on Thursday.

CSB Bank stock has slumped 36% in 2026 so far, with much of the pressure stemming from uncertainty over Fairfax's plans for its stake, according to market participants.

Fairfax owns 40% of the Kerala-based lender. MINT

IDBI Bank is down 20% year to date. IDBI Bank's troubled past, marked by bad loans, losses and repeated capital infusions, forms the backdrop to what the government called strategic restructuring of the lender. But the more immediate trigger for the stock's weakness in 2026 has been uncertainty over the long-delayed stake sale, particularly after bids fell short of expectations. While the Centre's approval of Fairfax's ₹81-per-share offer has advanced the deal, the below-market price has put further pressure on the stock.

Fairfax has two years to either sell its 40% stake in CSB or merge it into IDBI, and both routes play out very differently for CSB shareholders, noted Shashank Udupa, founder, fintech advisory firm Vayu Capital.

CSB Bank trades at about 1.1 times its book value, compared with 1.4 times for IDBI Bank, he said. In a merger, CSB shareholders would exchange a lower-valued stock for a higher-valued one, making the swap ratio crucial in determining how much of the valuation gap they can capture.

In a sale, any new buyer acquiring more than 25% must make an open offer to public shareholders under the market regulator's takeover rules, giving minority investors a chance to exit at the deal price, he pointed out.

For CSB Bank, the deal is not just about a merger; it is also about clarity on ownership and the road ahead.

"On growth, CSB depends on gold loans, which make up 54% of its book, and on expensive deposits. Its Casa ratio sits around 19%. Whoever ends up owning CSB will need to fix that funding side before the growth story can scale," said Udupa. "Execution is where it gets hard".

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EXPERT VIEW
NIRMAL JAIN

Respond to this column at
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WHY LONG-TERM CAPITAL STILL SEES POTENTIAL IN INDIA

When markets turn unsettled, daily price movements can dominate the economic conversation. Foreign selling becomes a verdict on the country, a weaker currency feeds doubts, and individual disappointments become evidence of a wider problem. These signals deserve attention. But judging India's prospects also requires examining what businesses, borrowers and investors with longer horizons are doing.

Two recent developments provide that perspective. The Centre has approved a Fairfax unit as strategic buyer for the proposed sale of IDBI Bank's 60.72% stake for approximately ₹52,878 crore. Separately, Blackstone's Jon Gray has outlined an ambition to raise India investments from about $50 billion to $100 billion over five years. These represent substantial confidence in India's future.

Having worked closely with Prem Watsa and Fairfax, I have seen their willingness to support businesses through difficult periods. Their experience also teaches caution. Transforming a smaller private-sector bank in southern India has required years of investment in technology, diversification and scale. An investment in a leading PVC producer has faced setbacks too. Patient capital needs sound execution, realistic expectations and a willingness to correct course.

Portfolio investors deserve a fair hearing. Their selling can reflect concerns about valuations, earnings, currency risk and global interest rates. The extraordinary investment in artificial intelligence is also competing for global capital. This helps explain the environment in which allocations are changing, although it cannot explain every outflow from India. When reallocations depress prices beyond what business fundamentals justify, they create opportunities for discerning long-term investors.

India offers a compelling foundation. Its growth is faster than that of the other large economies: real gross domestic product(GDP) expanded 7.8% in April-June, and the International Monetary Fund (IMF) projects 7% growth for FY27. Its favourable demographics add depth to the opportunity.

Indian households are demonstrating their own confidence. Monthly mutual fund systematic investment plan (SIP) contributions reached a record ₹32,490 crore in September, despite market weakness. They deepen markets and provide a broader domestic investor base.

> India should offer investors a dependable welcome via predictable taxation

That matters to overseas investors. Confidence to enter a market depends partly on confidence that an orderly exit will be possible. Blackstone's Gray has highlighted the strength of India's public markets and listing opportunities. India also offers a vibrant democracy, an independent judiciary, and established legal protections. Faster dispute resolution and more consistent enforcement would make those institutional advantages stronger still.

The financial foundation has improved too. Crisil estimates that median corporate gearing roughly halved over the past decade to around 0.5 times by March 2026. Banks' gross non-performing assets (GNPAs) stood at 1.68% in June, with a robust capital adequacy of 17.78%. Healthier borrowers and lenders give expansion a firmer foundation. Icra also reports healthy repayment performance in rated secured retail securitization pools, although unsecured segments require scrutiny.

Public investment reinforces this strength. The central government's capital expenditure reached approximately ₹5.10 trillion during April-August.

There are a few significant challenges. A deficient monsoon threatens farm incomes and food prices. September retail inflation reached 5.54%, while expensive oil affects household budgets and business costs. The Reserve Bank of India's October rate increase demonstrates vigilance. Policy must provide calibrated support to growth without losing sight of inflation.

Oil dependence creates a recurring external financing challenge. Services exports and remittances offset much of the merchandize trade deficit, but India runs a current account deficit. The gap requires net capital inflows or a drawdown of reserves.

Special Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposit schemes can mobilize foreign currency quickly, while limits on banks' open foreign exchange positions can help manage instability. These measures have their place, but deposits mature and curbs cannot create a lasting supply of forex. Sustained equity and debt investment must help finance greater productive capacity and more jobs.

India should, therefore, offer investors a dependable welcome through predictable taxation, timely approvals and straightforward entry and exit. While tax exemptions for eligible foreign investors in government securities are an encouraging first step, extending relief to long-term equity investments could attract patient capital. The finance minister's openness to hearing investor views on long-term capital gains (LTCG) taxation is welcome. Extending any such relief to domestic investors would avoid apparent discrimination and support household wealth creation.

Nirmal Jain is founder of the IIFL Group.

A whiff of controversy over Chivas perfume at Diljit concert tour

Varuni Khosla & Soumya Gupta
NEW DELHI/MUMBAI

A whistleblower complaint sent to Pernod Ricard India executives, government authorities, industry executives and *Mint* has raised questions about the French liquor maker's reported association with singer-actor Diljit Dosanjh's upcoming concert tour, which begins on 30 October, and the promotion of its Chivas Luxe Collective perfume brand.

The email, which is anonymous and unsigned and was also sent to Pernod Ricard chairman Alexandre Ricard, questions whether promoting the perfume brand's logo could indirectly advertise alcohol, given that the product is not available for sale on any e-commerce platform. Pernod Ricard India sells alcoholic drinks across categories, including Chivas Regal and Ballantine's Scotch whiskies, Royal Stag and Blenders Pride whiskies, Jameson Irish Whiskey and Absolut vodka.

To be sure, India restricts direct and indirect advertising of alcohol. The Central Consumer Protection Authority's (CCPA) 2022 guidelines prohibit surrogate advertising that uses another product to circumvent curbs on promoting alcohol. Separately, the Advertising Standards Council of India (ASCI) has guidelines to assess whether brand extensions, such as perfumes or packaged water, are genuine businesses or a means of indirectly advertising liquor brands. To qualify as a genuine brand extension rather than a surrogate advertisement, a product must be registered and available in reasonable quantities in the market. The complaint questions whether Chivas Luxe Collective meets this criterion.

Chivas Luxe Collective is Pernod Ricard's fragrance range, which the company introduced as an extension of the Chivas Regal brand in 2024 ahead of Diwali. The perfume line includes eau de parfum fragrances. The perfumes extend the Chivas Regal whisky brand into perfumes; product labels list Fraganote Fragrances Pvt. Ltd as the marketer and distributor, while Pernod Ricard India is identified as the licensee for the Chivas trademark.

Diljit Dosanjh's upcoming concert tour begins on 30 October. HT

The complaint comes at a time when Pernod Ricard India is preparing for a potential initial public offering (IPO), with the company having begun legal preparations and steps to convert its Indian business into a public limited company. It has yet to announce a listing timeline, though.

Mint responded to the complainant's email, seeking to establish their identity and understand the issue better, but had not received a response by press time.

SURROGATE BRAND?

AN email has asked whether promoting the perfume brand could indirectly advertise alcohol

THE complaint comes at a time when Pernod Ricard India is preparing for a potential IPO

Promotional material posted on social media by ticketing platform BookMyShow and reviewed by *Mint* lists Chivas Luxe Collective as a sponsor of Dosanjh's concert tour. The complaint questions whether using the perfume brand could indirectly promote Chivas Regal whisky.

"Pernod Ricard India is committed to responsible business practices and to complying with all applicable laws and regulations across its operations. Chivas Luxe Collective Perfumes is a legitimate business operating within our Brand Extensions portfolio. In promoting our Brand Extensions, we ensure that applicable eligibility requirements are met and that the relevant brands are duly registered with the appropriate authorities," Pernod Ricard India said in response to a detailed email from *Mint*.

Mint reached out to the Delhi excise authority, the CCPA and the concert representatives for comment on the complaint and clarification on the applicable rules but had not received a response from them by press time. BookMyShow, the tour's producer, declined to comment.

According to the BookMyShow listing, the Diljit Dosanjh RuPay Aura India Tour, presented by Chivas Luxe Collective Perfumes, will begin on 30 October, covers seven cities including Ahmedabad in Gujarat—a dry state—and conclude in December.

ASCI told *Mint* that it had neither got a complaint nor come across any recent advertisement for these perfumes.

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NEWS IN NUMBERS

$666 mn
REVENUE EARNED by Goldman Sachs from equity capital markets in Q3, up 43% from a year earlier, driven by stock sales tied to the AI spending boom.

93%
THE PERCENTAGE of Indian employers now vetting contract and freelance workers, due to rising credential forgery, as per a HireRight and YouGov report.

$16.8 bn
THE REVENUE reported by Claude chatbot maker Anthropic in the third quarter, according to the company's disclosure to prospective investors.

₹4,155 cr
THE AMOUNT already committed to IIT Kanpur's 'Greater than us' fundraising campaign,covering nearly half of its $1 billion target by March 2029.

6.6 tn
THE AMOUNT of gas-in-place resources, in cubic feet, Essar Oil & Gas is expected to get from five coal-bed methane blocks in secured across three states.

HOWINDIALIVES.COM

RBI clarifies scope of forex curbs

India's central bank said its recent derivative restrictions will only apply to deals for hedging forex risk and not for market-making, providing a clarification after sharp swings in currency forward markets.

The foreign-exchange risk reserve will be applicable to banks' own assets and liabilities hedged through derivative contracts when they purchase foreign currency against the rupee, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said in a statement on Thursday. The RBI added lenders will not have to set aside cash when such transactions involve sale of foreign currency. It also said that the measure is only for hedging current account transactions.

"The RBI's clarification provides some relief for banks and may result in a decline in the longer-term dollar-rupee forward premium rates," said Dilip Parmar, currency analyst, HDFC Securities. **BLOOMBERG**

Vehicle dispatches rise 30.7% in July-September

Domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from automakers to dealers stood at 1,360,687 units in July-September this year, registering an on-year rise of 30.7%, supported by improved affordability following Goods and Services Tax 2.0., the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said on Thursday.

According to SIAM, the automobile industry is expected to maintain positive growth momentum in second half of financial year 2026–27, though the pace of expansion may moderate due to the higher baseline from the previous year. "Demand fundamentals remain supportive, aided by the festive season, new product launches, infrastructure spending and fleet replacement," SIAM stated. **PTI**

'India to overtake Japan as 4th largest economy in 2027'

India is expected to become the world's fourth-largest economy by 2027, overtaking Japan, according to International Monetary Fund (IMF) projections that on Thursday laid out the Asian nations' contrasting trajectories.

The IMF said Japan would remain the fourth-largest country by nominal gross domestic product this year, but in 2027 India is set to take its place, with a gross domestic product reaching $4.52 trillion. Japan is slated to slip to sixth place that year, falling behind both India and the UK, the projection showed. India has shown strong growth in recent years despite global economic headwinds, with the IMF this week raising its forecasts for 2026 growth to hit 7%. Japan, by contrast, is plagued by an aging population and other structural problems that have seen the Asian giant's growth stagnate.

The US is the world's largest economy, followed by China and Germany. **AFP**

Torrent Power eyes $500 mn bond sale

Torrent Power is planning to raise around $500 million through the issue of rupee-denominated bonds, its second such bond sale in the current financial year, three merchant bankers said on Thursday.

The power producer is considering bond sales worth $473.44 million to $526.04 million, across 3-, 5-, 7- and 10-year maturities, the three bankers familiar with the deal said.

"Torrent Power has already started speaking to investors and once they get some firm commitments, they could go ahead with the issue before end of this month," one of the bankers said. In June, they had raised ₹38 billion through a similar structure, issuing bonds maturing in 3 years, 5 years, 7 years and 10 years at coupons of 8.10%, 8.15%, 8.20% and 8.20% respectively. In March, they raised ₹20 billion through staggered redemption bonds maturing in 8 years, 9 years and 10 years at an annual coupon of 7.97%. **REUTERS**

Maharashtra FDA suspends 892 licences in six months

The inspection drive began after Mundhe took charge of Maharashtra FDA in May

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MINT

The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has conducted a massive quality assurance drive across the state over the past six months. In a press briefing on Thursday, Maharashtra FDA Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe said that since the drive began in May, the regulator has inspected more than 19,713 food establishments, including restaurants, dark stores, milk product manufacturers and retailers, as well as edible oil manufacturers and retailers.

During this drive, the regulator suspended 892 licences and issued 1,538 stop-business notices due to violations. Of the total inspections, 5,335 were conducted across hotels, restaurants, dhabas and other food establishments, resulting in 585 licence suspensions and 15 cancellations. The widespread inspection drive has been underway since Mundhe took charge of the Maharashtra FDA in May.

The regulator also launched a special statewide drive to curb the sale, storage, and transport of prohibited items like gutkha, pan masala, and scented tobacco, Mundhe said. During inspections across 1,472 locations, officials discovered banned items at 1,411 establishments and seized inventory valued at ₹27.86 crore. Authorities have registered 1,175 first information reports (FIRs), arrested 1,529 individuals, filed charge sheets in 96 cases, and sealed 837 establishments. Additionally, 205 vehicles worth ₹13.61 crore used to transport the contraband have been confiscated. Beyond this, authorities seized suspected, substandard, and adulterated food items valued at ₹50.63 crore. The Maharashtra FDA inspected over 3,000 establishments selling milk and milk products, seizing 203,622 liters of milk worth ₹21.01 crore. Officials also confiscated stock of milk products valued at ₹7.99 crore, registered 19 FIRs, and arrested 65 individuals.

The regulator also stepped up its crackdown on analogue paneer. Following the Analogue Paneer Prohibition Notification, authorities cancelled 16 licences for analogue paneer. Across 57 inspections where analogue paneer was detected in establishments, officials seized 22,241 kg of stock valued at ₹5.76 lakh.

For an extended version of this story, go to livemint.com.

Nestlé India's profit rose 36.3% year-on-year in the September quarter. **REUTERS**

Nestlé India shares crash over 8%

Nestlé India's September-quarter profit rose 36.3% year-on-year, but its shares fell as much as 8.3% on Thursday after the company flagged persistent food inflation and volatile commodity costs.

The maker of Maggi noodles and KitKat chocolates reported broad-based growth across product categories, but investor sentiment was dampened after it said, "rising inflation, particularly food inflation, is a reality." The stock closed 7.76% down at ₹1,275.80 on the National Stock Exchange, while the benchmark Nifty50 closed 1.66% higher. "Coffee and wheat are expected to remain range-bound, while sugar and edible oils have stabilized at elevated levels," the company said in an exchange filing. Cocoa prices remain volatile due to weather-driven crop concerns in key producing regions. The company expects milk prices to soften as the flush season arrives. **NEETHI LISA ROJAN**

'New norms won't disrupt business'

The intention behind the proposed commission norms is not to disrupt any business model or any particular market segment, Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) chairman Ajay Seth said on Thursday.

Market participants attributed the rupee's continued appreciation to central bank intervention and the unwinding of long dollar positions.

However, ongoing external macroeconomic pressures are likely to temper further gains, they said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 94.95 against the American currency. In intraday trade, it touched a high of 94.86 and a low of 95.11 and settled at 94.99 against the greenback, registering a gain of 18 paise from its previous close. **PTI**

HDFC Life profit up 13.6% to ₹508 crore

HDFC Life Insurance reported higher quarterly profit on Thursday, as a recovery in policy sales through parent HDFC Bank helped drive growth. Profit rose 13.6% to ₹508 crore for the quarter ended 30 September, while net premium income grew nearly 16% to ₹21,727 crore.

Distribution through HDFC Bank has begun to recover in recent months after weaker sales over the past year amid heightened regulatory scrutiny of banks' distribution of financial products and intense competition. Growth recovery through HDFC Bank is driven by more granular engagement at the branch level and improved coordination, chief executive officer Vibha Padalkar said in a post-earnings call. "We do believe that we should continue to see reasonable growth in the HDFC Bank channel," chief business officer Vineet Arora said.

The bank channel accounts for around 60% of HDFC Life's retail insurance sales, with the parent comprising a major share. **REUTERS**

The group's consolidated net loss declined to ₹8,468 crore in FY26. **MINT**

Flipkart revenue rises 18% in FY26

Flipkart Group's revenue from operations rose 18% to₹1.46 trillion in the year ended March 2026, and adjusted operating losses narrowed by about ₹1,600 crore, reflecting improved margins and lower overheads, according to consolidated financial statements filed with the Registrar of Companies.

The group's consolidated net loss declined to ₹8,468 crore in FY26 from a restated ₹8,646 crore a year earlier, an improvement of about ₹178 crore.

The results mark the first time since the group's redomiciliation to India that its consolidated financial performance has been reported under Flipkart Internet Private Limited, the company said in a statement.

"As part of its redomiciliation to India, Flipkart Group is publishing consolidated financial results under Flipkart Internet Private Limited," the company said, adding that the results provide a historical view of the business for the year ended March 2026 and should not be interpreted as a current trading update. **PTI**

Nifty clocks best day in four months, but rally may fade

FROM PAGE 1

the Nifty, which witnessed a dramatic rise, said analysts.

The put-call ratio of Nifty options expiring on 19 October jumped to 1.65 on Thursday from 1.01 a day earlier, implying that call sellers were forced to cut their short call positions due to the smacking rally in heavyweights, they said.

"This means that for every 100 calls sold on Thursday, 165 puts were sold, skewing the market in favour of the bulls," said Sudhir Joshi, consultant at Khambatta Securities.

This ratio shows the number of outstanding puts relative to the outstanding calls. When the ratio rises, it's a bullish sign as investors and traders sell more puts than calls, hoping to pocket the premium paid by the put buyers who are bearish.

While heavyweight stocks rose, the Nifty Smallcap 250 index fell 1.01% and Nifty Midcap 150 fell 0.8% on Thursday.

FIIs have net sold shares worth ₹38,722 crore in October so far, according to National Securities Depositories Ltd (NSDL) data.

The market got a boost from moderating crude oil prices and a stronger rupee. The rupee continued its winning streak for the fifth straight day, rising 23 paise to 95.06 per dollar on Thursday, while benchmark Brent crude oil prices fell 1.3% to $104.63 a barrel, easing worries over inflationary pressures.

Globally, AI and tech-heavy indices saw a sharp correction: South Korea's Kospi index fell 8.18%, Japan's Nikkei 225 fell 4.18% and Nasdaq fell 1.88% on Thursday.

The stocks that saw biggest declines on Nasdaq on 14 October were all AI-focussed companies: CoreWeave, Nebius Group and Marvell Technology fell 15%, 10% and 8.8%, respectively.

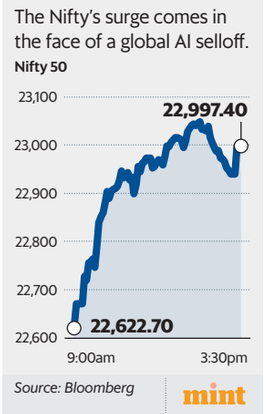
The fall in AI stocks globally comes amid worries that the massive spending on the technology may not deliver commensurate gains.

India, with its relatively low exposure to AI stocks, could offer investors a refuge from the global AI turmoil.

However, for investors to actually move money out of the US markets, "would need a more sustained correction in some of the major AI stocks," said Christy Mathai, fund manager at Quantum Mutual Fund. "We may be seeing the beginnings of that in a few stocks, partly because bond yields have risen. But the earnings outlook for US technology companies remains strong, and we are not yet seeing clear signs of a broader earnings slowdown," Mathai added. "So, it is still too early to conclude that global investors are shifting towards India as an anti-AI trade."

Rupee continued its winning streak for the fifth straight day, rising 23 paise to 95.06. **PTI**

Bulls return
The Nifty's surge comes in the face of a global AI selloff.



SATISH KUMAR/MINT

Tendulkar's Ten X You races into running shoes and athleisure

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MUMBAI

A year after launch, Sachin Tendulkar's sportswear and athleisure brand Ten X You is turning to running as its next growth area, while targeting ₹100 crore in annual revenue by March 2027, a top executive said.

While Ten X You's best-selling products in its first year include performance shoes for cricketers, the company is rolling out footwear designed for different kinds of runners. It is also taking T-shirts and other running apparel to marathons and running clubs, Karthik Gurumurthy, co-founder and chief executive, told *Mint* in an interview.

"We have had over 1 lakh customers so far, establishing dominance in cricket, where we wanted to build," Gurumurthy said. "We launched running shoes in January, and they have caught up well. We are also doing a lot more on the running apparel side. Our running T-shirts and shorts are doing very well."

Ten X You sources its nylon running apparel from Sri Lanka. Cricket still accounts for 45% of its revenue, while running contributes 30%, he added.

"We now plan to make it [portfolio of running goods] big," Gurumurthy said. "In running, we want to get more technical. We want to launch a long-distance [marathon] running shoe. We started with a recovery running shoe [in January] and a tempo running shoe that weighs only 200g. This is one of the lightest shoes in the market, with a carbon plate at the bottom and casting polyurethane outsole to reduce the overall weight."

Karan Arora, co-founder of Ten X You, with Sachin Tendulkar.

Ten X You is reaching out to running clubs and attending major marathon events, including the recent Wipro Bengaluru Marathon, Gurumurthy added.

The brand, launched last October, has raised a total of $6.5 million from backers including venture capital firm Peak XV and Alteria Capital. Sachin Tendulkar serves as the company's 'chief inspiration officer'.

Ten X You is targeting aggressive expansion, aiming to top ₹100 crore in annual revenue by March 2027, Gurumurthy said. Its current annualized revenue run rate is ₹60 crore.

It will also open two exclusive brand outlets (EBOs) this year and plans six such stores by March. The company is also keen to enter the mass-priced footwear segment.

"The top price point of ₹7,000 and above [in cricket] is dominated by Adidas," Gurumurthy said. "This segment is about 10% of the market. In the middle segment of ₹3,500-7,000, we and Asics are the only players there. We have yet to enter the under ₹3,500 segment, which is more than 60% of the market. We will launch this very soon, we are already pitching a product for this segment to our retailers. Currently, we have a network of about 250-300 multibrand sports stores in the country, but with this lower priced shoe, we can [take] this to 1,000 stores," he said.

Competition in India's sports-shoe market is intensifying, with established brands and sports celebrities vying for customers. In June, Virat Kohli's sports brand One8 was relaunched in Delhi with a flagship red sneaker inspired by a cricket ball and positioned as a lifestyle shoe. One8, previously run by Puma India, is now owned by Agilitas Sports, founded by former Puma India chief executive Abhishek Ganguly.

French sports goods retailer Decathlon also launched a sub-brand named Kiprun in September, focused on running. Sports events in India were a ₹10,200 crore business in FY25, as per a KPMG report of September 2025.

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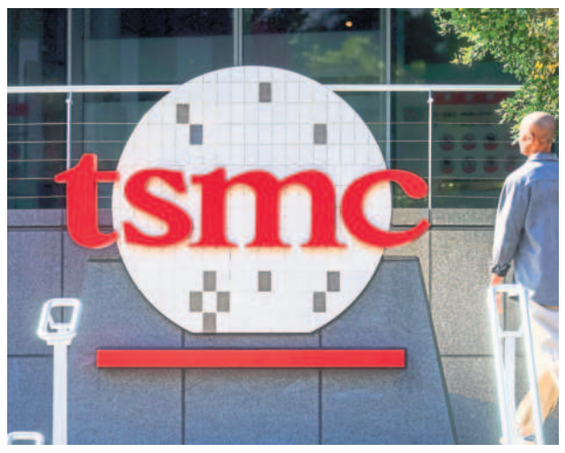

The chipmaking linchpin is projecting sales of as much as $54.3 billion in the December quarter. AP

TSMC's upbeat outlook fails to quash AI concerns

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Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co. (TSMC) delivered a better-than-expected revenue outlook, sustaining a torrid pace of growth yet failing to dispel rising concerns about the sustainability of a global artificial intelligence (AI) buildout.

The chipmaking linchpin is projecting sales of as much as $54.3 billion in the December quarter, handily beating expectations. That should translate into a roughly 44% rise in 2026 revenue in US dollar terms, and followed a better-than-expected 69% jump in profit for July to September. TSMC's upbeat projection however failed to stem a global tech stock rout, as selling of AI names extended into the European day.

The main chipmaker to Nvidia Corp. on Thursday reiterated its long-held stance about the resilience of demand for AI as the technology evolves and transforms global economies. Chief Executive Officer C. C. Wei stressed that Taiwan's largest company remains in prudent expansion mode, exploring a new manufacturing site in Texas while discussing a potential tieup with Elon Musk's Terafab chipmaking endeavour.

The company has so far managed to accelerate sales growth and ramped up capacity expansion

"TSMC's results are a much-needed vote of confidence in the AI demand story, but I would stop short of calling them an all-clear for the sector," said Charu Chanana, the chief investment strategist at Saxo Markets.

While the outlook suggests AI demand remains robust, moderating margins, rising costs and overseas expansion raise questions about how much of that growth will translate into higher profitability. "I see this as reassurance rather than a reset of expectations," Chanana said.

TSMC's outperformance follows a spate of positive results from big industry names including ASML Holding NV, though solid numbers and commentary have so far failed to arrest a selloff triggered by growing signs of stress among AI data center players such as CoreWeave Inc.

Wei sounded a note of caution about the need to remain disciplined in spending. TSMC is sending its own teams to the US to survey the progress of data centre construction and power supply availability, gathering intel on the ground in addition to relying on partners such as Nvidia and Apple Inc. Yet he clearly signalled TSMC would pursue growth.

"We are using multiple levers to do everything we can, whenever we can, as fast as we can to maximize the support to our customers," Wei told analysts on a conference call. "We have no intention to leave food on the table for others, and we want to capture every piece of business possible."

Hsinchu-based TSMC serves as a key barometer of global AI demand as every major industry player including Nvidia, Advanced Micro Devices Inc. and Alphabet Inc.'s Google relies on the Taiwanese chipmaker to turn their most cutting-edge designs into reality.

TSMC, for its part, has so far managed to accelerate sales growth and ramped up capacity expansion. The company reiterated its capital expenditures will reach as much as $64 billion, a record, this year.

Its shares touched an all-time high this month, among the first chip stocks globally to reach new records after a July market rout. It's been outperforming peers thanks to a dominant position in the manufacturing of processors needed to power AI. Yet it got caught up in the broader pullback in tech stocks over the past week.

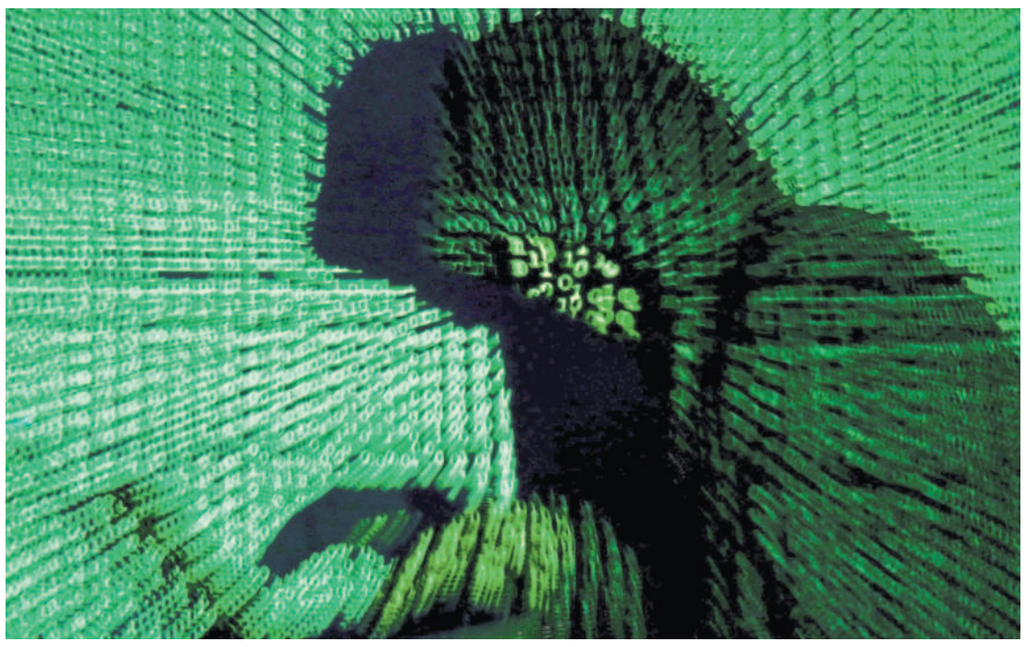
The company is now trying to build and furnish about 20 factories at home and overseas, an unprecedented pace for a company that typically works on four or five new buildings simultaneously.

Consensus estimates have been climbing for the Taiwanese firm's 2027 capital spending, a key indicator for the industry. Goldman Sachs Group Inc. now targets $85 billion and UBS Group AG sees $90 billion, compared with the $75 billion average of firms polled by *Bloomberg*.

AI firms play cat-and-mouse with secret-stealing spies

Silicon Valley was on espionage alert even before the FBI's arrest of an OpenAI employee

Georgia Wells, Erin Wood & Meghan Bobrowsky


The companies building artificial superintelligence describe it as a force that could reshape entire economies. REUTERS

At a San Francisco playground, a stranger tried to befriend an OpenAI employee who was there with their child. The stranger also regularly showed up with a child, and, in the process of making small talk, asked the OpenAI employee questions about their work. It was no idle curiosity: The stranger was a spy.

That is one of the scenarios employees of the artificial intelligence company have been presented with in attempts to raise their vigilance against attempts to steal corporate secrets—and that was before federal authorities arrested an employee for planting a listening device.

In training sessions, OpenAI has warned employees that outsiders, including competitors and state-sponsored actors, could try to get access to company information. Company leaders have said that could take the form of people offering money, listening in cafes or even trying to seduce OpenAI employees, people familiar with the matter said. Employees at other AI heavyweights, including Anthropic and Google, have received similar warnings.

The companies leading the race to build artificial superintelligence describe the technology as a force that could reshape entire economies, create vast fortunes and dominate future warfare, potentially altering the geopolitical power balance. All that has inevitably made the industry, its employees and their secrets ripe targets for espionage. And while Silicon Valley has been on guard against the threat, there is no such thing as perfect defense.

On Tuesday, a Saudi employee of OpenAI, Abdulrahman Alfozan, was charged with trying to record audio using a device planted behind a TV set in a company conference room. In announcing Alfozan's arrest, FBI Director Kash Patel said protecting the technological secrets behind AI "is essential to safeguarding our nation's economic strength and national security, and the FBI views that mission as one of our highest counterintelligence priorities."

Alfozan's attorney said the allegations were "wholly out of character" and noted his client was charged only with violating a federal recording statute, not stealing trade secrets or acting as a foreign agent.

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Corporate security experts say it is likely the threat goes well beyond one hidden recording device. "Catching one guy means there are half a dozen out there," said Randy Watt, president of leadership consulting firm SRW, which conducts security and threat assessments for companies. He said bad actors may be searching not only for technical or strategic information but for personal secrets that can be used to exploit or blackmail individuals.

The rapid growth of the industry has created abundant opportunities to get inside the leading companies, which have quickly added thousands of employees to their payrolls. OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta and Google all employ large numbers of foreign nationals, with China supplying much of the world's top AI talent. A number of Trump administration officials have identified employment of Chinese nationals by AI and technology companies as a national security vulnerability, alleging that some share secrets with Beijing.

Employees also frequently job-hop between companies, creating an additional vector for information leakage or misappropriation. OpenAI and Apple have been engaged in litigation over claims of poached employees taking confidential files with them to their new jobs. Elon Musk's xAI made a similar claim in a lawsuit against an engineer who went to OpenAI.

"AI companies are scaling their workforces at unprecedented speed. The question is whether their ability to manage insider risk is scaling at the same pace," said Aviv Nahum, the chief executive of Above Security, a startup that uses AI to help companies detect insider risks.

He said the traditional approach to mitigating insider risk relies on verifying someone's identity and then trusting that what they do afterward is legitimate, which can miss cases where the threat develops over time.

In corporate training sessions, OpenAI instructs employees to avoid wearing anything bearing OpenAI's logo outside of the office, to use screen protectors that restrict visibility on public transit, and to wipe down whiteboards when they are finished with them, in case kitchen and cleaning staff are compromised, according to people familiar with the matter. Employees are frequently reminded of these precautions, including via Slack, some of the people said.

In some trainings, OpenAI offers additional warnings about scenarios involving "honey pots," or agents who use the offer of sex or romance to get close to a target, some of the people said.

One story OpenAI tells employees to illustrate the risk: To seduce a U.S. diplomat in Russia, a foreign espionage operation first sent a blond woman to his hotel room with Champagne. When he declined, the spies sent a redheaded woman, and then next a young man. The implication for OpenAI employees was this could happen to them, according to the people. OpenAI maintains a security team with experience in physical security, insider risk, information security and related disciplines, according to a spokesperson.

Corporate espionage has been going on as long as there has been intellectual property to steal, said Phil Venables, a partner at Ballistic Ventures and investor in companies including Nahum's, and former chief information security officer for Google Cloud.

In 2022, a former Twitter employee was found guilty of spying for Saudi Arabia and sentenced to 42 months in prison. The man, Ahmad Abouammo, had passed on private user information associated with critics of the kingdom in exchange for hundreds of thousands of dollars, prosecutors said during the trial.

In January, a former Google software engineer was convicted of stealing thousands of pages of confidential information relating to the company's AI trade secrets and giving the material to China.

According to Venables, the concentration of so much value in a handful of AI companies—OpenAI and Anthropic are each expected to seek valuations of more than $1 trillion in their initial public offerings—makes them bigger targets.

"The resources and money required to train foundation models makes them even more valuable intellectual property," he said.

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SpaceX's spectrum purchase exposes risks for big telecom stocks

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Telecom stocks have long been considered a relatively safe bet for investors, offering predictable growth, limited downside and healthy dividends. But a combination of competition from SpaceX and rising Treasury yields is threatening to upend that equation.

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. announced last week that it's buying a swath of spectrum that will enable it to beam cellular service from its Starlink satellites, potentially setting up Elon Musk's aerospace technology company to become a major mobile carrier as well. Verizon Communications Inc., AT&T Inc. and T-Mobile US Inc. all suffered double-digit percentage declines on Friday after the news hit.

"Competitive risk is presenting itself in a way it hasn't in the past," said John Conca, a telecom analyst at Third Bridge Group. "The market perception is that this is just the first shoe dropping."

The telecommunications players were already under pressure from soaring interest rates. The yield on 10-year Treasuries crossed 5% on 15 September, and since then shares of Verizon and AT&T are down 14% while T-Mobile's have lost 13%. The companies are sensitive to bond yields because part of their appeal is based on their reliable dividend payouts.

"Some people buy them for their (dividend) yields on the idea that it comes with a growth kicker," said Michael Cuggino, president and portfolio manager at Permanent Portfolio Family of Funds. "But they're not growing very much, and there are risks to that growth down the road with this SpaceX question. At the same time, the yields don't look nearly as attractive as they might otherwise, because you can get a similar yield from risk-free Treasuries."

A SpaceX Dragon spacecraft prepares for splashdown AFP

T-Mobile shares are down 22% this year, while AT&T has lost 7.2%. Verizon is up 9.1% but still trails the S&P 500 Index's 13% gain. SpaceX went public in June and the stock has jumped 13% from its initial public offering (IPO) price, though it's 25% below the peak it hit within days of the IPO.

The firm is buying a swath of spectrum that will enable it to beam cellular service from its Starlink satellites

Of course, the threat from SpaceX is pretty far down the road considering it will need a lot of costly terrestrial infrastructure to effectively compete, especially in densely-populated markets, according to Conca. However, this is compounding pre-existing concerns about the pace of growth in the industry.

"This is more about sentiment than fundamentals in the near term," he said. "But if there's even a small chance they could lose significant market share in the future, that's really going to scare people."

Those fears aren't confined to the US. In Europe, Deutsche Telekom, which has a majority stake in T-Mobile, is down 8.6% this year through Wednesday's close. And a gauge of European telecom stocks has fallen 18% from a peak in May.

To stay ahead of the competition, AT&T, T-Mobile, and Verizon unveiled a joint venture focused on expanding satellite-enabled connectivity to eliminate US mobile dead zones just days before SpaceX's announcement. The move "should help neutralize Starlink Mobile's ability to offer contiguous coverage in the US," Bloomberg Intelligence wrote at the time.

Investors will get a look at the companies' fundamentals over the next few weeks, with AT&T reporting earnings on Oct. 21, and Verizon and T-Mobile scheduled for the following week.

In response to the competitive environment, T-Mobile pointed to a LinkedIn post from its chief technology officer that downplayed the risk and noted that terrestrial networks were better suited for indoor coverage and density. Representatives from AT&T and Verizon didn't respond to requests for comment.

Apple Joins Nvidia in the $5 trillion valuation club

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Apple became the second company to close above the $5 trillion mark on Wednesday, capping the Tim Cook era, and posing an implicit challenge to new Chief Executive John Ternus.

The iPhone-maker's shares closed at a record, just enough to push the company's market capitalization into territory that only chip colossus Nvidia occupies. Apple's market value has surpassed $5 trillion six times previously during intraday trading, but it had never closed above that level, which it squeaked past on Wednesday, ending the day at $5.005 trillion according to Dow Jones Market Data.

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Cook's act will be tough to follow. During his 15-year tenure as CEO , which ended Aug. 31 , Apple's market capitalization multiplied by a factor of 13. He nearly quadrupled the number of iPhones sold annually. He grew its highly profitable services business from $10 billion annually to more than $100 billion. He launched the Apple Watch and AirPods, which together generate more than $30 billion a year. He poured Apple's cash into more than $1 trillion worth of share buybacks and dividends.

Today, Apple shares trade at a premium compared with the overall S&P 500 even though the company's revenue growth rate is slower than the index's average. That is because the company's shares are viewed as safe, and its business predictable, say analysts .

A key to Apple's success under Cook is how it has limited capital spending, juicing the company's returns for investors and greatly reducing the risks of its business. That has never been more apparent than during the AI build-out, when big tech rivals have rushed to spend gargantuan sums on data centers while Apple has focused on its core businesses making devices and selling high-margin services for them.

Apple CEO John Ternus (left) and Tim Cook, chairman of the company's board of directors. AFP

Apple investors are so confident in its business that they have driven up its shares despite big cost increases that threaten profit margins. The cost of memory and storage chips inside iPhones, Macs and iPads has skyrocketed as demand for those chips from data centers has led to shortages. Apple has responded by raising prices across its device lineup, including for older model iPhones that would typically get a price cut.

In theory, such a move could hurt Apple since iPhone buyers might wait longer to upgrade their devices. Yet since the first wave of price increases Apple shares have jumped 25%.

In part, that is because investors think Apple device buyers will pay the higher prices, enabling Apple to generate as much or more in total profits even if margins are down, said Bank of America analyst Wamsi Mohan . He added that Apple's new foldable iPhone Duo is likely to be popular and that the new Siri AI will prompt iPhone upgrades.

Apple's shares closed at a record, pushing its market capitalization into territory that only Nvidia occupies

AI has long been viewed as Apple's Achilles' heel. The company failed in its efforts to build its own frontier model, and it also allowed its Siri assistant to fall far behind rivals. ChatGPT revolutionized what smartphone users expect from chatbots.

Apple hopes to turn a corner with the new Siri AI. Built with Google's help, Apple's redesigned chatbot was released this fall. It still lags behind rival AI systems in key respects, though it has the advantage of being built directly into the device that many people already use, their iPhone. Apple also has access to more personal data, which could theoretically be used for compelling AI features, though new AI agents show the technology is advancing faster than Apple's ability to keep up.

Tech rivals know how important it is to control the devices that people use to deliver their services. Perhaps most threatening to Apple, OpenAI is planning a family of AI-powered devices. It has poached hundreds of Apple employees to drive its device strategy. Apple responded in July by suing OpenAI , alleging it stole Apple trade secrets.

OpenAI has said it is "not aware of any evidence that this complaint has merit" and alleged in a new legal filing Wednesday that Apple poached one of its own employees who took confidential files with him. Apple said in response that it had found no evidence supporting the new allegation.

AI could be the battleground where Ternus makes his mark, either ushering in a new era of innovation and growth for Apple or finally losing its status as the company that has defined how people interact with computers.

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Can a class IX textbook make your children better money managers?

Budgeting, investing and insurance enter NCERT's personal finance curriculum; building habits is the real test

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MUMBAI

Budgeting, saving, investing, insurance, borrowing and income tax now feature in a single class IX chapter in CBSE-affiliated schools. The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) introduced it in its new Social Science textbook, Understanding Society: India and Beyond – Part 2, released on 28 September.

Titled Managing Your Personal Finances, the chapter introduces personal finance through five pillars: income, budgeting, saving, investing, and protection and risk management.

Using familiar situations, such as deciding whether to spend pocket money and festival gifts or save them in a gullak, it explains inflation, purchasing power and compounding. Students also learn about fixed deposits, bonds, shares, mutual funds, insurance, the true cost of equated monthly instalments (EMIs) and income-tax calculations. But can one chapter translate this knowledge into lasting money habits?

What already exists?

Financial literacy in Indian schools has traditionally been fragmented, with many concepts taught through commerce, economics and accountancy at higher levels rather than as compulsory lessons for all students.

NCERT introduced economic concepts in earlier classes, too. Its 2024 class VI Social Science textbook included Economic Life Around Us, covering needs and wants, work, occupations, markets and exchange. Class VII extended this foundation through Banks and Magic of Finance, introducing money, banking, savings, borrowing and digital payments, including UPI.

The Class IX chapter builds on this foundation, covering personal financial decisions, from comparing investments and assessing risk to evaluating borrowing costs and calculating income tax.

NCERT director Dinesh Prasad Saklani says in the foreword that the textbook aligns with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE) 2023, which emphasise reasoning, responsible citizenship and preparedness for a changing world. Its inclusion in mainstream Social Science of Class IX means students who later pursue science or humanities will also encounter financial concepts.

Beyond terminology

V. Pradeep Kumar, visiting professor and career and management consultant, said education should prepare students for everyday challenges, not just examinations. Financial literacy in Class IX can encourage responsible attitudes towards spending, saving and investment.

However, exposure to concepts does not guarantee practical skills.

Kunal Bhakat, a certified NISM and NCFE financial literacy trainer, said the chapter includes useful activities, such as preparing a budget for a new school year. But teachers need time to explain concepts, conduct exercises and discuss mistakes. "Without adequate time and continuity, students may learn the terminology without understanding how to apply it in everyday situations," he said.

If treated primarily as an examination topic, the chapter could teach students to define compounding or income-tax slabs without knowing how to apply them in real life.

ICSE's different approach

The Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations (CISCE) has also published a teachers' handbook, *Financial Literacy: Integrating Financial Educatio*n in school curriculum. It recommends integrating financial education into Classes VI-X across subjects, rather than treating it as a standalone subject. Teachers can use articles, stories and reports in language classes to introduce financial concepts. The handbook also suggests role-play, games, case studies, surveys and discussions with experts.

Some schools may opt for a supplementary textbook. "However, the actual impact of any book or curriculum ultimately depends on how effectively it is implemented in the classroom and how many opportunities students receive for hands-on learning," Bhakat said.

Parents' role

Anand Damani, a behavioural scientist and global speaker, believes financial education should extend beyond classrooms. Schools should deepen learning through games using tokens, while parents should introduce children to money early.

While children need not know their family's net worth at a very young age, parents should begin by teaching them to see money as an enabler of their dreams and hobbies rather than associating it with status and power, he said.

Neha Singh, founder of Womoneysta and a certified financial planner whose daughter is in class IX, said children need to connect classroom lessons with everyday decisions. The chapter provides a starting point for discussions about money, but children also need practical experience.

Shopping can teach budgeting: asking a child to choose a birthday gift within a fixed amount introduces financial limits, Singh said.

She also uses digital pocket money to encourage independence, discusses investments held in her daughter's name and explains stocks through familiar companies.

Delhi-based advocate Tanu Dhania gives her son fixed pocket money, encourages saving and assigns paid projects to teach the relationship between work, income and spending. Financial literacy is particularly important in a digital environment where children face online spending pressures and other money-related risks, she said.

Singh believes parents' attitudes towards money influence how children learn to manage it.

"We have learned about money on the job but the advantage of having it in school is that it gives a starting point and a structure for parents to have to talk about it," she said.

Build in stages

Abha Adams, educational consultant and vice-chair of the Ahvaan Trust, said the approach assumes class IX students attend school and receive money from their parents. For those able to continue schooling and receive an allowance, budgeting would be a primary objective.

She also questioned the emphasis on income-tax calculations without first developing a broader understanding of taxation.

"Understanding why we are taxed, what happens with tax payers money, what is the % of taxpayers in the country is prior information that I believe is critical," she said.

Adams warned that introducing several concepts in class IX without systematically building on earlier lessons may limit understanding.

Kumar highlighted another challenge: the revised Part 2 textbook reached teachers and students midway through the academic year, leaving less time for effective teaching. "Teachers will have less time and teaching may not be very effective," he said.

Financial literacy must not remain theoretical or become another examination exercise, he added. Students need practical lessons in budgeting, saving, borrowing, digital financial safety and long-term planning, supported by real-life examples and age-appropriate activities. Learning must also progress as students move to higher classes.

NCERT's chapter provides a structured introduction to money management, but familiarity with financial terms is only the first step. Sound money habits require repeated opportunities to make decisions, compare alternatives and learn from mistakes.

Ultimately, the chapter's value will depend not on what students recall in examinations, but on whether they can apply their learning to make informed financial decisions.

Scan the QR code to read an extended version of this story.

NCERT's money management lessons

The new class IX curriculum introduces personal finance, but turning classroom concepts into lasting habits will take practice.

A primer on money management

- **Budgeting:** Planning expenses and distinguishing between needs and wants.
- **Saving:** Developing saving habits and understanding the importance of starting early.
- **Investing:** Fixed deposits, bonds, shares and mutual funds; understanding the relationship between risk and returns.
- **Protection and risk management:** Insurance, financial risks and responsible borrowing.
- **Finance:** Introduces students to inflation, purchasing power, liquidity, compounding and EMIs.
- **Taxes:** Calculating income tax under the new tax regime.

Parents' take

NEHA SINGH
Founder Womoneysta, certified financial planner, parent of a class IX student

"The chapter provides a starting point and a structure for discussions around money."

TANU DHANIA
Advocate, parent of a class IX student

"Financial literacy is a critical layer.. today's digital ecosystem exposes children to structural traps."

Educators weigh in

KUNAL BHAKAT
A certified NISM and NCFE financial literacy trainer

"Without adequate time and continuity, students may learn terminology without understanding how to apply it in everyday situations."

V PRADEEP KUMAR
Visiting professor, career and management consultant

"Age-appropriate practical exercises and real-life examples can make these concepts meaningful."

ABHA ADAMS
Educational consultant and vice-chair of the Ahvaan Trust

"Parachuting concepts into class IX without reference to it in earlier classes would not build understanding."

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POWER POINT
RANJITH KRISHNAN

Respond to this column at
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WHOM TO TRUST? GEN Z'S FINANCIAL ADVICE DILEMMA

A young professional receiving their first salary today has no shortage of financial advice. By breakfast, their phone may have explained SIPs, credit scores, term insurance and IPOs. By evening, an influencer may have recommended a stock, a friend shared a "sure-shot" idea and an app suggested another product. The challenge is no longer access to information, but deciding what deserves trust.

This is an under-discussed personal-finance challenge for Gen Z. The generation is financially connected, but access to information does not guarantee sound guidance. Parents, colleagues, social media, financial apps and AI all offer answers. What is often missing is a reliable sounding board who understands individual circumstances, weighs risks and has no product to sell.

Advice everywhere

Sebi's Investor Survey 2025 offers useful insights. Among surveyed investors, 59% cited friends, family and colleagues as sources of information on securities-market products, while 56% cited financial influencers. Online investment communities, including Telegram, WhatsApp, Reddit and Facebook, were used by 34%, while about 25% cited financial professionals. Though these figures cover investors generally, they reflect the environment in which young investors make decisions.

Trust is the more revealing metric. Sebi found that 93% of surveyed investors considered finfluencers moderately to highly credible, while 62% based some investment decisions on their recommendations. Repeated exposure breeds familiarity, which can be mistaken for competence. The person offering advice may know nothing about the viewer's income, dependants, debt, emergency savings or ability to absorb losses.

Parents traditionally filled this gap in India. Their advice on thrift and caution remains valuable, but financial products have evolved. A parent familiar with provident fund, fixed deposits, gold and property may have sound instincts but little experience with ETFs, app-based credit, international funds or derivatives. The principles may hold; products may be unfamiliar.

> Young investors should learn to filter noise from sound, credible and unbiased financial advice

Friends bring another bias. We hear about IPOs doubling, not investments that disappoint. Profits get more attention than loss, distorting young earners' perception of risk despite being surrounded by apparently successful investors. Financial pressure compounds the problem. Deloitte's 2026 India survey found that 54% of Gen Z respondents delayed major life decisions due to finances. Thirty-seven percent could not afford a home, while 29% felt financially insecure. A generation worried about financial security faces more financial persuasion than any before it.

Financial loneliness

This is a form of financial loneliness: many voices to consult but no basis for deciding which to trust. Consider a 25-year-old with ₹1 lakh. A parent suggests a fixed deposit, a colleague recommends a small-cap fund, social media promotes an IPO, an app suggests an asset allocation and AI generates a portfolio in seconds. None is necessarily wrong, but each could be unsuitable if the person lacks an emergency fund and must pay university fees. Financial literacy must include judging advice, not just understanding products. Four questions can cut through the noise: Who is advising? What do they gain if I act? Does the recommendation reflect my circumstances? What happens if it is wrong?

A hierarchy of trust

Not every first-time investor needs a professional adviser, but every young earner needs a hierarchy of trust. Regulatory and product disclosures should rank above viral content. Qualified advice matters when decisions become complex. Family experience is useful, not infallible. Social media can generate ideas, but ideas are not advice. Technology has democratised finance. Markets, credit and investment products that once required appointments and paperwork are now accessible on a phone. The next challenge is to democratise judgement just as seriously.

For Gen Z, wealth creation depends not just on knowing where to invest, but when to ignore advice. In an age overflowing with guidance, trustworthy judgement may be the rarest asset.

Ranjith Krishnan, associate professor, Christ University, Delhi.

'Wait for bond yields to rise further before locking in long-term debt'

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MUMBAI

MONEY GURU

As the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) moves into a rate-tightening cycle, Suyash Choudhary, head of fixed income at Bandhan AMC, explains what higher interest rates mean for savers and investors. In a conversation with Mint, he discusses the expected rate trajectory, the implications for portfolio duration, global bond allocation and why investors should prioritise quality over high yields in fixed income. Edited excerpts from the interview:

The RBI has recently increased interest rates. What does this mean for Indian investors, and how do you view the move?

Market interest rates do not always move in tandem with RBI policy decisions. Even when the RBI was cutting rates previously, market bond yields in India were rising due to broader macroeconomic factors. The RBI is normalizing policy in response to global and domestic pressures. Globally, there is intense competition for capital, driven by massive AI technology spending in developed markets, which has pushed up global bond yields. Additionally, rising geopolitical risks and higher energy costs are adding to inflationary pressures.

We believe the RBI is embarking on a broader tightening cycle, with total rate hikes potentially reaching 100 to 125 basis points. This could push the repo rate to around 6.25% to 6.50% by the end of the cycle. Fortunately, bond markets have already priced in a significant portion of this move.

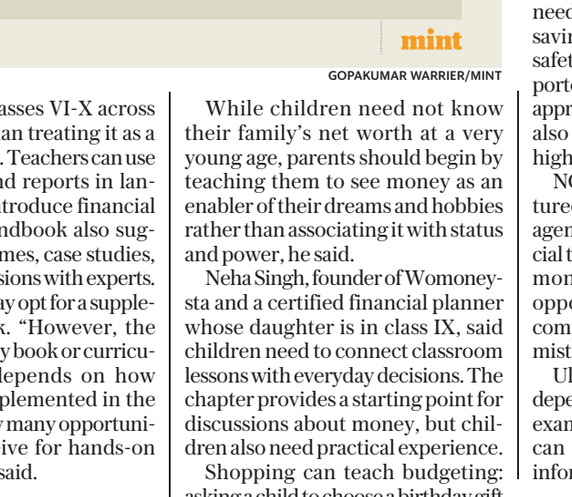
As interest rates rise, how should savers interpret higher yields?

For a saver, rising bond yields are actually positive news. The primary goal of fixed-income investing is to earn a 'real return', which means your investment returns beat expected inflation so that your purchasing power is protected. Higher interest rates increase the real income your savings can generate.

There is a common misunderstanding that debt mutual funds become riskier when rates rise because their daily unit prices, or net asset values (NAVs), fall. When interest rates rise, existing bond prices fall, lowering the NAV. However, the overall portfolio yield continuously rises as new, higher-yielding bonds are added. If you hold a direct fixed deposit or bond, you experience the same effect as an invisible 'opportunity loss' because you have locked your money in at a lower rate instead of capturing the higher yield. As long as your money is in actively managed funds or short-term instruments, rising rates can ultimately work in your favour.

How do investors position their debt portfolios in the current rate cycle?

Currently, we recommend keeping portfolio duration low, meaning investors should avoid locking into long-term bonds too early. If you hold medium- to long-duration products, ensure they are actively managed so the fund manager can adjust the portfolio as rate cycles evolve.



For passive or retail investors managing their own allocations, sticking to very short-term options, such as money market funds, makes the most sense right now. We are still in the middle of India's rate-adjustment cycle, so it is wiser to wait for bond yields to rise further before committing to long-term fixed-income products.

How should someone starting out with debt investments approach asset allocation and fund selection?

Investors must first understand the fundamental role of debt in a portfolio. Equity is meant for long-term growth, while fixed income is meant to provide stability, regular income and safety during market downturns.

Many investors make the mistake of hunting for the highest possible yield in debt funds by investing in lower-rated corporate bonds. This defeats the core purpose of fixed income. Chasing credit risk adds hidden danger to the part of your portfolio meant to protect you. During market stress, you need high-quality buffers. Beginners should focus on high-quality, short-duration fixed-income options that offer strong risk-adjusted protection rather than simply chasing yield.

> Chasing credit risk adds hidden danger to the very part of your portfolio meant to protect you
>
> **Suyash Choudhary**
> Head of fixed income, Bandhan AMC

What is a reasonable debt allocation for a long-term investor?

When evaluating your debt allocation, you must look at your total net worth holistically, including assets outside mutual funds, such as Provident Fund savings and bank fixed deposits. As a general baseline, holding an overall ratio of around 40% in fixed income and 60% in growth assets such as equities makes sense. Since a large portion of your debt allocation may already be in retirement funds or bank deposits, your requirement for debt mutual funds could be lower, which is completely fine.

Should Indian investors consider US debt funds for diversification?

US dollar bond yields have risen significantly, making them look attractive globally. However, Indian investors must remember that their living expenses and financial liabilities are denominated in Indian rupees. Buying US debt introduces currency exchange-rate risk, which adds an element of speculation. While a small allocation can serve as a secondary diversification tool if you have seamless access, it should remain a strictly controlled, minor portion of your overall wealth.

Which global and domestic macroeconomic cues are you keeping a close eye on?

We are tracking two major pressure points. The first is US Treasury bond yields. With US yields hovering near 5%, the floor return for global capital has shifted upwards. This makes global investors less eager to deploy capital into emerging markets such as India, even though our domestic economy remains fundamentally sound.

The second is broad-based commodity-price inflation across energy and food, driven by geopolitical conflicts and weather disruptions.

What is one timeless lesson from your more than 20 years of experience across market cycles that retail investors can apply?

Always evaluate every investment on two dimensions: risk and reward. Most retail investors focus exclusively on returns, often looking backwards at recent performance. Instead, you should determine your natural risk appetite and how much drawdown or fluctuation you can comfortably handle without panicking. Remember that your perceived risk tolerance expands when the markets are booming and shrinks during market downturns. Staying faithful to your baseline risk comfort across changing market cycles is key to long-term investment success.

OUR VIEW

MINT

India's IDBI Bank stake sale: double-score move

The Centre's IDBI Bank stake-sale decision took long but sends out a welcome signal that it's back in disinvestment mode. The deal will aid its fiscal math and draw foreign exchange too

The on-now-off-again 'privatization' of IDBI Bank is finally on again, following the Union Cabinet's clearance of its sale. Under the deal approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on Wednesday, Canadian billionaire Prem Watsa's Fairfax Financial Holdings will acquire a stake of nearly 61% in this development-turned-commercial bank for ₹52,878 crore. A Fairfax subsidiary will pay ₹81 per share, higher than the ₹75.99 average of two independent valuations, the government said. This brings down the curtains on an effort that has lasted for over a decade. The bank is not being 'privatized,' as it is already classified officially as a private bank. Under the deal, Fairfax will pick up a stake of a little over 30% from the government and a slightly smaller one from the state-run Life Insurance Corporation of India; this is expected to leave the former with 15% and latter with 19%. While a shift in control could deliver operational improvements, the deal's significance lies in the fiscal support it may lend the Centre in a year of soaring subsidy bills on account of an energy shock, apart from the foreign exchange it draws.

The broad contours of India's banking sector will not shift. We have 12 public sector banks (PSBs) that account for 55% of all assets and a sizeable share of total deposits, as on 31 December 2025, according to Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data. Yet, with the sale of IDBI Bank, the government—which called the exercise "strategic restructuring" rather than "disinvestment," a sign that semantics still matters—has achieved two things. *One*, it has finally completed a stake sale that has been on the anvil for long. *Two*, in the event that it goes through within this fiscal year, it would have struck its annual disinvestment target for the first time since 2018-19. As per latest data from the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management, the government has so far raised ₹55,757 crore in 2026-27 by selling equity. Proceeds from its stake in IDBI Bank would take that sum past its ₹80,000 crore goal for this fiscal year. In a signal of intent, the CCEA has also authorized an empowered group of cabinet ministers to offload IDBI Bank shares from the Centre's remaining 15% stake through the open market.

Since the investment will be from Canada-based Fairfax, the funds will count as foreign direct investment (FDI), and to that extent, be a welcome addition to the country's capital account. While this sum will be a one-off flow, perhaps we can expect further FDI flows on account of buoyant global interest in Indian banking. In recent years, India has shown a willingness to allow greater foreign equity participation in this sector. Overseas entities have sizeable stakes in banks like Yes Bank and RBL Bank, to cite just two examples. As for Fairfax, it already has a big stake in CSB Bank, thanks to a purchase back in 2018, and would likely have to either give up control of this lender or merge it over a period of time with IDBI Bank, since RBI regulations will not allow it to run two separate banks in the country. A merger might seem attractive, given CSB Bank's notable presence in India's southern states, but it is unlikely to be an easy task. Mergers entail human resource overlaps that can simmer under the surface for long after. Nonetheless, this stake sale marks a major milestone in the government's effort to reduce state ownership where it's not a must.

MY VIEW | FARM TRUTHS

Wage data suggests that distress in rural India is about to worsen

Falling real wages across rural occupations argue for stepping up job generation via VB-G RAM G

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Rural wages are the most important indicator of the well-being of the majority of India's rural poor. Given their close relationship with agricultural as well as non-agricultural activity, they are also among the few high-frequency indicators of distress in the country's rural economy.

Available since 1998 on a monthly basis from the labour bureau for 12 agricultural and 13 non-agricultural occupations, the series was revised from July 2025 onwards, with the bureau changing both the coverage and methodology of wage data collection and reporting. It expanded the coverage of villages, aligning the series with the revised consumer price index for agricultural labourers (CPIAL), with 2019 as its base. The new series from July 2025 was expanded to provide wages for 34 states and Union territories, as against 20 major states before that. However, this also meant that the new series is not comparable with the earlier one. This resulted in a break in the series, with no concordance provided by the labour bureau to merge the two series.

Until mid-2025, the rural evidence suggested stagnation in both agricultural and non-agricultural wages. During the decade from July 2015 to June 2025, agricultural wages increased 1.3% per annum in real terms while non-agricultural wages increased 0.2% per annum. These are the lowest rates of growth for a decade-long period since Independence. If we take the post-covid period (data starting July 2019), real wages in agriculture grew at 1.3% per annum, while non-agricultural wages declined at 0.1% per annum.

Data from the new series is now available for July and August 2026. Real wages on a year-on-year basis declined in July by 1.5% for agricultural occupations and 1.6% for non-agricultural. These deteriorated further in August, declining by 1.9% over the previous year in agricultural occupations and 2.1% in non-agricultural. The decline is broad-based across almost all agricultural and non-agricultural work.

These estimates of growth from the new series confirm the trend since 2013. These also suggest a real decline compared to a modest growth in agricultural occupations observed in the old series. Similarly for non-agricultural occupations, we see an acceleration in the rate of decline in casual wages. The numbers thus confirm the deepening rural distress shown by other sources.

In contrast with urban euphoria over India's performance recorded by national accounts, rural areas are faring poorly. This is especially noteworthy since July and August were affected by not just what happened to agriculture as a result of El Niño, but also because these represent the first two months of the implementation of the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin), or VB-G RAM G, which replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). The latter played an important role in earlier episodes of drought in the country. Public employment created in the non-farm sector sustained rural livelihoods and helped shore up household finances.

QUICK READ

Rural wages are among the few high frequency indicators of the health of India's rural economy. Unfortunately, the signs aren't good. A wage decline in real terms is yet to be reversed.

India must ramp up spending on its employment guarantee. This scheme was originally designed for such exigencies. It can help relieve rural distress and lift India's broader economy.

This year, both engines of the rural economy, farming as well as non-farm commercial activity, seem to have suffered. In fact, the decline in non-agricultural wages is higher than seen in farm wages.

What is likely to make matters worse this year is the threat to food security. Food inflation has already crossed 8% in rural areas, as visible in India's consumer price index data. An expected rise in inflation will also hurt the non-farm sector by dampening demand for non-farm goods and services.

Agriculture is unlikely to lead to a revival of the rural economy, given this year's drought (in many parts of India) and rising input prices. Therefore, increasing public employment through VB-G RAM G will not only generate incomes, but also have an indirect impact on wages and non-farm demand. While VB-G RAM G has been operational only for four months, initial reports suggest a decline in overall job generation performance. It also shows variations, with poorer states showing significantly lower person-days of work generated compared to last year or even the average over the past five years.

Increasing public employment through VB-G RAM G may require the government to relax some of its new provisions. It will also need fiscal support for poorer states. The MGNREGA was designed for such contingencies. Strengthening VB-G RAM G is not just a necessity to relieve rural distress, but also to revive an overall economy in need of stronger rural consumption.

10 YEARS AGO

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JUST A THOUGHT

"Adventure is the life of commerce, but caution is the life of banking.

WALTER BAGEHOT

THEIR VIEW

Indian tourism's climate risks need to be fully priced in

SOUMYA SARKAR

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India is investing heavily in tourism, but it may be underpricing the biggest risk to those investments. A hotel can be built in a year, but a tourism asset can last for decades. If the climate, water supply or physical access to a destination deteriorates during that period, today's profitable project can become tomorrow's expensive liability.

The stakes are huge. India recorded almost 4.3 billion domestic tourist visits in 2025, while tourism's estimated direct and indirect contribution to GDP was about ₹15.7 trillion, supporting 84.6 million jobs, according to the tourism ministry. That makes climate risk a tourism-business problem, not just an environmental one.

India's mountains, beaches and pilgrimage centres are among its biggest tourism assets. They are also places where climate change can constrain the ability to accommodate visitors. The Himalayas face rising temperatures, changing precipitation and growing exposure to floods and landslides, while tourism adds pressure on roads, water, waste and emergency systems, as a government assessment has found.

The economics can be counter-intuitive. Climate change may not reduce demand for a destination. On the contrary, it can increase it. Hotter plains could send more visitors towards cooler mountain destinations even as those places struggle with water, congestion and unstable slopes. The result could be rising demand colliding with falling effective capacity.

Pilgrimage tourism makes the problem particularly clear. Visitor numbers at Uttarakhand's Char Dham destinations have risen from about 1 million annually in the early 2000s to around 5 million in 2023. Yet, a recent peer-reviewed study estimated sustainable daily limits of 15,778 visitors at Badrinath, 13,111 at Kedarnath, 8,178 at Gangotri and 6,160 at Yamunotri. The issue is not that tourism must be stopped. It is that visitor demand cannot be treated as the same thing as economically sustainable capacity.

The same tension exists on India's coast. In Goa, tourism attracts 3-4 times the state's resident population, according to the government's climate assessment. As much as 14.7% of the state's land is below 15 metres above sea level, while rising sea levels, flooding and increasingly heavy rainfall pose growing risks. For a coastal hotel, therefore, the asset is not just the building. Its value depends on the closeby beach, access roads, drainage, electricity, water and the surrounding ecosystem continuing to function. If any of these fail repeatedly, occupancy could fall and operating costs rise even if the building survives.

That is how climate risk becomes financial risk—through business interruption, repair costs, insurance, financing and even asset impairment. India's tourism policy needs to reflect this reality. The tourism ministry already has a national sustainable-tourism strategy, but climate risk must move from a sustainability consideration to a condition of investment approval.

QUICK READ

India is betting on tourism as a growth engine but climate change could make some of its most valuable destinations more expensive, less accessible and harder to insure.

We need to ask how many tourists a destination can take sustainably. If our investment plans assume a larger number, these assets will increasingly be vulnerable to climate impacts.

Large hotels, resorts, airports and other forms of tourism infrastructure should face forward-looking assessments of flood, heat, water, landslide, cyclone and coastal risks over their expected economic lives. Projects in high-risk locations should have to demonstrate how those risks will be managed before capital is committed.

Carrying capacity should also function as an operating constraint rather than a theoretical number. Visitor and vehicle limits should reflect water availability, waste capacity, road access and also emergency services. The principle is already being tested in Uttarakhand, where a new $126.4 million Asian Development Bank programme combines tourism development with transport, water supply, waste management, disaster preparedness and nature-based protection.

This is the right model because individual businesses cannot make a destination resilient by themselves. A hotel can conserve water but it cannot create a municipal water system. A resort can strengthen its own structures but cannot secure the roads connecting it to local sites.

The financing question will be harder to answer. Developing countries are expected to require $310 billion to $365 billion a year for climate adaptation by 2035, while international public adaptation finance was only $26 billion in 2023, according to the United Nations.

India will, therefore, need to make every adaptation rupee work harder, using public money to protect shared infrastructure and 'crowd in' private capital. That means destination-resilience funds, climate-risk screening for tourism lending, insurance incentives for resilient assets and greater use of natural systems such as forests, wetlands, mangroves and dunes as protective infrastructure.

The larger change needed in India's approach is conceptual. The country has spent years asking how many tourists a destination can attract. It now needs to ask a more difficult question. How many tourists can that destination safely, profitably and sustainably accommodate as the climate changes? If the answer is lower than the number assumed in today's investment plans, climate change would not merely threaten tourism, it would challenge the value of assets being built to serve it. In many ways, it is already doing this.

THEIR VIEW

Europe must look beyond the US and China to boost productivity

Instead of emphasizing innovation, it could take a distinctly European approach that focuses more on adoption and diffusion

DANI RODRIK
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BLOOMBERG

Europe faces a productivity crisis. Over the past quarter-century, its labour productivity has risen only half as rapidly as that of the US, widening the gap between American and European incomes. Thanks to higher public expenditures, stronger labour-market institutions and superior safety nets, the benefits of European economic growth are better distributed. But without improved productivity, European economies and democracies will remain at risk.

That's why European leaders have been sounding the alarm. Mario Draghi, former president of the European Central Bank who authored an influential 2024 report on European competitiveness, calls the productivity imperative an existential challenge. To focus attention on the issue, he and other top European business leaders and academics recently came together to form the Rhine Group, whose website laments that, "Of the fifty largest technology companies in the world, only four are European."

Europe feels squeezed between the US and China. The US may hold a thin lead over China in AI and other frontier technologies, but China is rapidly making up the difference. It is already the world's top source for international patent applications, its share having increased from 3% to 33% between 2000 and 2022, when the EU's share fell from 30% to 16%.

It is no surprise that much of the European discussion revolves around the need to emulate and catch up with the two technological superpowers. But, in fact, neither the US nor China offers a relevant or attractive model for Europe.

True, the Silicon Valley model of innovation, with its reliance on a rich pool of venture capital and strong links to academic research, has much going for it. It's responsible for most key innovations of the digital age. But it does a poor job of diffusing the benefits of innovation across the economy, which is what matters for overall productivity. Innovation does not automatically produce increased productivity unless it raises the capabilities of broad segments of society, including workers and small businesses. That is why periods of innovation do not necessarily correlate well with productivity booms.

Within the US, there was a pronounced slowdown in labour productivity growth after the 1970s oil shocks, despite the onset of the digital age and mass computing in the 1980s. The decade before the covid pandemic had the lowest US rate of productivity growth since the end of World War II, even though there was no apparent slowdown in innovation. Nor are these deficiencies confined to macroeconomic figures. The US model has produced highly concentrated wealth and economic power, which now lies at the root of America's political dysfunction and polarization.

China's productivity growth, meanwhile, remains heavily reliant on manufacturing. China has led the way in electric machinery, electronics, solar products, electric vehicles and batteries. But while it is true that manufacturing has traditionally been critical both for innovation and jobs (as Europe's own history shows), it will necessarily play a small role in Europe's future. After all, European jobs and economic activity are already heavily concentrated in services and will remain so. It would be a mistake to try to emulate China's trade and industrial policies to revive the fortunes of Europe's manufacturers, other than for national-security reasons.

Raising productivity in services presents different policy challenges. Europe cannot and should not compete with the US and China on their own terms. It has little choice but to develop its own, distinct productivist model. The key to boosting European productivity will lie in deploying and disseminating technological and organizational innovations throughout the economy, regardless of where the innovation is generated.

QUICK READ

Europe's public outlays, labour protections and other safety nets mean the benefits of growth are well distributed but it must sharply improve productivity to secure its future.

Europe's approach needs to conform with its social market economy. Unlike the US, it should aim to use technology in the service of people rather than the other way around.

Consider some examples. Cellular telephony and handheld phones were both developed initially in the US. But Europe moved well ahead of the US in mass adoption and established the GSM standard, which helped European firms such as Nokia and Ericsson dominate global markets until smartphones took over. Similarly, nuclear reactors were developed in the US and UK, but it was France that turned them into a major source of electricity generation. Industrial robots and numerically controlled machines were developed in the US, but it was Germany (and Japan) where factories used them to greatest effect.

There are plenty of cases that go in the opposite direction as well. The internal combustion engine, World Wide Web and the wind turbine were all invented in Europe, but it was America and China that made the most of them. Europe was unable to turn its head-start in handheld phone tech into commercial success in smartphones. The Dutch company ASML is the global leader in photolithography machines, but Europe lags badly in the $1 trillion-plus global market for the chips these machines make.

Targeting outcomes downstream of innovation opens a new perspective on Europe's productivity challenge. It suggests a somewhat different focus than current preoccupations with startups, big tech, capital-market integration and global competitiveness. As a recent EU report shows, the bottlenecks—finance, scale, regulations, organizational changes—differ across activities and cannot be presumed *ex ante*. The solutions Europe needs are more in the nature of 'industrial' policies based on public-private collaboration that discover and unlock binding constraints to effective deployment in specific technological streams.

Instead of emphasizing innovation *per se*, a distinctly European approach would emphasize adoption and diffusion. Deployment of organizational and technological innovations will matter in services such as retail, gig work, hospitality and care, where the bulk of jobs will be. Since most such activities are not exposed to the international economy, competitiveness is a poor lens through which to formulate the requisite policies.

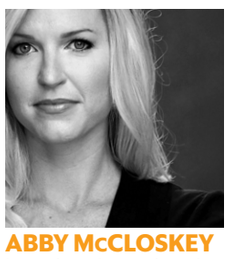
Europe's lag in AI raises difficult questions, but it does not change the nature of the remedy. Investment in data centres and compute is costly, and the bulk of the gains will be generated through AI use, which can happen anywhere that has access to a cloud. For national-security purposes, Europe may want to avoid an excessive reliance on the US (or China). But as long as AI users are not cut off from data centres, the productivity benefits will depend less on where compute is located than on AI use.

Last but not least, downstream dissemination has the advantage that it is more consistent with Europe's own model of a social market economy. Unlike the US, the European approach should aim to use technology in the service of people rather than the other way around. ©2026/PROJECT SYNDICATE

MINT CURATOR

AI is making parenting scarier for mothers of young children

It amplifies anxieties around child-rearing at a time of digital flux



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AI has introduced a new era of bringing up children. ISTOCKPHOTO

Recent books and studies have begun to highlight the risks that artificial intelligence (AI) poses to children. This is a good thing. Maybe we are collectively realizing that we shouldn't wait a decade after a new technology emerges—as we did with social media—before we sound the alarm.

But kids aren't the only ones affected by AI. Mothers are too. The vast majority of parents use AI for parenting support. I'm one of them. But as much as I appreciate AI managing my grocery list, I worry it could make parenting harder. When I asked Google's Gemini how AI might go about dismantling American motherhood, its answer rang eerily true: It warned that AI could encourage "hyper-individualized isolation," intensify perfectionism and make every decision seem to carry a risk of "permanent, catastrophic consequences."

As a mom of young kids, I've felt this personally. For example, I recently asked ChatGPT if it is good for my boys to share a bedroom. In the past, I would have turned to my sisters and friends, who would have shared their own experiences. But I no longer need to pick up the phone to get motherly advice. Within seconds, AI gave me a precise age range when sharing was supposedly beneficial—although it's unclear what evidence it was based on. Still, it's easy to see how this sort of instant advice could chip away at the peer-to-peer maternal networks that have historically supported mothers.

AI's responsiveness could also erode trust in maternal instincts. A survey by Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago found that a third of parents admit to following AI-generated guidance for their children instead of their own instincts. As Dr. Dana Suskind warns in her new book, *Human Raised*, maternal instinct has been honed over millennia and remains a core part of child-rearing, while generative AI is new and often still hallucinates. Yet how quick we are to ascribe more authority to the latter!

Then there's the sense of uncertainty—or even doom—that AI feeds. The future is always unknown, but it feels especially so these days. Nearly half of moms expect AI will reduce their financial security and their children's.

To the many questions weighing on parents, add: Will my kids have jobs in a post-AI world? How can I best prepare them when I'm new to this technology too? All the way to: Do I need a pantry full of canned food and bottled water in case of an AI apocalypse? This is to say nothing of the new monitoring burdens AI introduces, which disproportionately fall on mothers already knee-deep in checking iPads, smartphones and school-sponsored devices. Now add AI to the list. A recent survey by the research firm Count on Mothers found that most mothers are concerned about children's exposure to unsafe or inappropriate content (63%), confusion between human and AI-generated interactions (55%) and behavioural or social-emotional changes (51%). Only 8% of moms didn't think AI presented a risk.

And yet, in the absence of a policy fix—be it age limits on chatbots or school restrictions—moms are on their own to limit children's AI access. Because AI is integrated into search platforms and not contained in clearly identifiable apps like TikTok or YouTube, it's harder to track. And only a handful of school districts have restricted its use. No wonder most parents consistently underestimate their children's use of AI, according to Common Sense Media. Keeping track of all the pings, apps, alerts and devices feels more like an exercise in futility than digital management.

In other words, AI is taking an already intense period for child-rearing and making it more so. I recently discussed this with Anne-Marie Slaughter, incoming dean of the London School of Economics' School of Public Policy, and Richard Reeves, president of the American Institute for Boys and Men. As Slaughter put it, "My mother's theory was benign neglect... and she raised three very successful children. But, I mean, I can't even imagine anybody saying that now."

In our digital world, that is no longer possible. AI has introduced a whole new era of mothering. To be sure, AI can ease some of the domestic drudgery and invisible labour borne by mothers, from making meal plans to managing schedules to remembering class parties. Sign me up for a robot to empty my dishwasher and fold laundry. And interestingly, most parents say that AI has made their jobs easier—even as they express significant concern about its impact on their children.

But there is a cost for mothers as well. Heightened anxieties, endless optimizations and ever-growing lists of things to monitor are ratcheting up the pressures of parenthood. ©BLOOMBERG

GUEST VIEW

How insurance business models can adapt to new rules

PEEYUSH DALMIA & ABHISHI BHATIA

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Insurance companies preparing to navigate the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India's (Irdai) proposed regulatory changes should anticipate shifts across distribution strategy, cost structure and their core platform. A comprehensive rethink of their business model, rather than incremental tweaks, could help them differentiate themselves and thrive.

A value shift away from distribution: As commissions drop, it is expected that pricing will follow and insurance 'manufacturers' will pass on the benefit to consumers. The total new business or gross written premium could consequently shrink; even if the number of policies grows, it will likely not expand commensurately in the short-term to compensate for price drops. With porting and renewal commissions set at the same level, the distributor has no reason to move a customer. While this means lower churn and better persistency for the incumbent's book, switching may also stop working as a source of new business. This could impact distributors in three ways—the commission percentage will drop; combined with price drops and new business drops from porting this means that absolute commissions will drop faster. The overall premium pool, and therefore value-based penetration, will also shrink in the short-term.

Distribution will undergo a paradigm shift. *First*, a smaller pool rewards scale and productivity, so sub-scale intermediaries (agents and brokers) may exit or join tech-enabled platforms that ease selling. *Second*, agency success becomes an AI and technology question—as income now depends on volume, not the rate, an insurer that speeds up an agent's work wins the agent (including by making the agent sell multiple products). That means scored leads, instant quotes, pre-filled proposals, on-the-spot underwriting, an assistant answering product questions mid-conversation and automated renewal follow-ups. Hiring support teams is not an option with a lower expense ceiling. *Third*, bancassurance could gravitate towards proprietary distribution. Without an opportunity to negotiate pricing, banks will look to create more market value through their subsidiaries, creating a challenge for insurers with significant third-party bancassurance business. *Fourth*, the growth of direct selling depends on insurers passing savings on to customers and the channel. If insurers cut prices evenly everywhere, customers have no reason to change where they buy. Direct grows if the savings appear in the direct and platform price, which Irdai proposals permit by barring distributors from insisting on uniform pricing and which the 5% platform fee ceiling makes affordable. Most insurers will hesitate, since it undercuts the channel that still writes most of their business.

More broadly, the basis of distribution will shift to either proprietary channels or brands and services in non-proprietary channels. This could benefit better established brands as distributors will want to sell what is easier. Paying more for shelf space stops working when the rate is fixed. Distributors then pick on the product, systems integration, claims record and training. Insurers that bought distribution rather than earned it will feel this impact the most. There could be an eventual consolidation of players in the market. Also, as value shifts from distributors to manufacturers, we might see large distributors either enter or take equity stakes in insurance manufacturing.

QUICK READ

Irdai's regulatory proposals are expected to change the economics of the insurance business in India. Insurers will need to adapt fast or they risk staring at obsolescence.

With running costs already at 6-28% of premium value, achieving a 12.5% expense ratio while absorbing servicing costs could require changes beyond stepwise budget reductions.

Changes in process and cost structure: Customer information must be verified before issuance and every policy names its seller. This relationship data could move to the insurer, and so would the servicing and renewal work previously supported by distributors. Combined with expense caps, this could impact cost structures. With running costs already at 6-28% of premium value, achieving Irdai's proposed 12.5% expense ratio while absorbing servicing costs could require changes beyond incremental budget reductions.

The core platform could be both a constraint and an opportunity: Regulatory compliance and AI-readiness require identical foundational systems—seller tagging, functional identities, audit-ready expense data and commission engines. As insurers must build compliant systems anyway, they could simultaneously create the infrastructure needed for AI. This modern core platform enables automation to achieve expense reduction targets that commission cuts alone cannot.

For India's insurers, the next phase of growth may be determined less by product availability and more by distribution effectiveness, especially as customer acquisition becomes more competitive, expectations evolve and new digital channels emerge. As McKinsey's recent research report *India's New Insurance Track* indicates, insurers can use AI to redesign core operating models for effective distribution. Conversational, voice-first and vernacular-enabled engagement could make processes more intuitive for advisors, while AI-enabled activity management may help frontline managers identify performance gaps earlier and focus on actions most likely to improve outcomes.

The adaptation window is short. Insurers that redesign their operating model comprehensively are likely to emerge ahead. These players could differentiate and thrive, while those that hesitate risk obsolescence.

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A car for hills and highways

A chunky steering, hushed cabin and reassuring ride help the Nissan Tekton make short work of any manner of road

Rishad Saam Mehta

Some cars you evaluate, others you feel. The Nissan Tekton declared itself in the second category within kilometres thanks to its chunky steering, hushed cabin, and reassuring ride.

I was driving up to Saroga Woods, a homestay perched at 8,000 ft, above the village of Thanedar, run by two old friends, Anu and Kartik Budhraja. In 2005, I had mentioned this little corner of the Himachal Himalaya to them as a holiday spot; they fell in love with it so thoroughly that they gave up their jobs in Singapore, and moved their lives here in 2012. Now they have a lovely home set into a hillside overlooking apple plantations all the way down to the Sutlej. They run it as a luxury homestay and it remains one of my favourite places in these mountains because of the clime, the easy conversations, and the delicious cooking.

It gave the Tekton exactly the test I wanted: a proper spread of roads, each one asking something different of the car. The flat-out expressway between Delhi and Chandigarh. The fast four-lane twisties climbing to Shimla. The narrower road on to Narkanda. And finally, the broken, narrow-shouldered stretch beyond it, into the hills.

ON THE ROAD

Getting into the driver's seat, the first thing I registered is how commanding it feels with the bonnet's muscular lines clearly visible. It's a look that carries through the rest of the car too. The lines are boxy without being blunt, the wheel arches sit proud rather than flush, and there's enough visual heft to it that you half expect it to feel heavier than it drives.

On the Delhi-Chandigarh leg, wind and road noise stayed low, the cabin stayed hushed, and it settled into a cruising gait that made the first three hours go by in a blur. I set the cruise control, and it locked on to a rhythm, pacing itself with the flow of traffic ahead. The only moment it got caught out was when a car ahead decided the lane markers were more of a suggestion than a rule; the system hesitated, visibly unsure whether to hold its line or follow the delinquent. Otherwise, it simply ate the kilometres.

> While the car scores on tech and comfort, a few niggles, like the grainy parking camera, leave room for improvement

On the fast four-lane twisties up to Shimla, I could lean on it hard through corner after corner without a hint of unsettlement. It delivered a supple, absorbent ride that shrugged off poor surfaces. Through Shimla itself, where the traffic tightens, the steering's precision made threading through gaps easy work. On to Narkanda, over a mix of good tarmac and broken patches, the composure held. And on the final stretch to Saroga, which was steep and broken-shouldered, the car simply refused to get flustered, even when I had to put the two left wheels on the broken shoulder of the narrow road.

It wasn't all rosy, though. The steepest sections did produce the one dynamic weak point: a moment's hesitation from the 1.3-litre T280 GDi engine as the turbo gathered itself before the power arrived. But on a car this composed everywhere else, I'm inclined to let it go.

The dual-clutch transmission itself never put a foot wrong: smooth, unobtrusive, exactly what you want when you're not thinking about the gearbox at all.

On the final run into the hills, where the road tightens into a string of steep, narrow corners, the turning circle made the stretch something close to enjoyable. Corner after corner, it moved like it was reading the road a beat ahead of me.

THE REALITY CHECKS

The Tekton features a pleasant interior. Priced from ₹10.49 lakh to ₹18.59 lakh (ex-showroom), the Nissan Tekton saves its best cabin tricks for the higher trims. Top variants get features like ventilated and powered front seats, dual-zone climate control, and 48-colour ambient lighting. The major touchpoints feel reassuringly robust, but a few lower-dashboard and door-pad plastics feel a step down in texture.

Ergonomically, it's close to excellent, everything within reach, nothing awkward, with one genuine physical exception: the centre console sits high enough to properly constrain my left knee. With the left leg entirely redundant in an automatic anyway, I wanted to let it fall out and relax. But the console restrained it. On a long haul, that's the sort of small friction one notices by the third hour and remembers well after the trip is over.

THE SPECS

- Engine type: 1.3-litre 4-cylinder T280 GDi turbo-petrol
- Max power: 163 hp @ 5,250 rpm
- Max torque: 280 Nm @ 2,000-3,500 rpm
- Transmission: 6-speed wet-clutch DCT (automatic)
- Drivetrain: Front-wheel drive (FWD)
- Fuel tank capacity: 50 litres

Tech-wise, wireless Android Auto and Apple CarPlay are table stakes these days; what isn't is Google built natively into the system. I signed into my Google account and never once reached for CarPlay again. Google Maps ran exactly as it does on my phone, same interface, the same drop-down menu of recent destinations I'd searched for on my phone, no tethering required. It's the kind of detail that sounds minor on a spec sheet and turns out to matter enormously on a three-day drive. On the flip side, in low-light conditions, the 360-degree surround-view parking camera offers a feed so grainy it looks like CCTV footage.

The Tekton is clearly aimed at buyers currently weighing up a Hyundai Creta or a Kia Seltos. The styling borrowed from the Patrol is a deliberate play for aspirational value, giving badge-conscious buyers something that looks a class up without costing one. It's built in Chennai with India as its primary market, and will also be exported to some 50 countries across West Asia and Africa, a corporate plan that aims to roughly triple both domestic and export volumes.

It sounds ambitious, but after driving the car, the ambition doesn't feel misplaced.

Rishad Saam Mehta is an author and independent journalist based in Mumbai.

Sao Tome's vanilla finds fans around the world

The island off the Gulf of Guinea has revived its cultivation of a unique vanilla with cocoa undertones

AFP

ISTOCKPHOTO

The plump, bright-green vanilla pods growing in tiny Sao Tome's vast leafy plantations may well end up in some of Europe's finest dining.

Although better known for its cocoa, the central African island off the Gulf of Guinea has revived its cultivation of vanilla, the world's second most expensive spice, after saffron.

While his mother used to grow cocoa, Ifrasio de Barros Rompao has invested in the green pods that will turn yellowish on the thick, flat leaf vines once harvest time comes.

Spurred on by the promise of more profits, the farmer recently ventured into growing vanilla.

"Vanilla, in terms of money, for me, is essential," de Barros Rompao said on his sloping forest plot in the heart of the island.

"I have a big family at home, and with this crop I manage to provide for our needs," he added.

Once nicknamed the "Chocolate Islands", the Portuguese-speaking archipelago was the world's leading cocoa producer at the beginning of the 20th century. The vanilla planifolia orchid is believed to have been introduced in 1880 as an offering by French colony Gabon to the Portuguese governor at the time.

Its cultivation never took off, neglected in favour of intensive production of sugarcane and later cacao and coffee.

But the volatility of global cocoa prices and the ageing of the island's plantations have left Sao Tome scrambling to diversify its economy. And hopes are pinned on its niche vanilla cultivation.

Only saffron commands higher prices than vanilla, which "adds an extra income for farmers", Juliette Dohar, co-founder of L'Atelier Vanilha, said.

The project was set up seven years ago and focuses on supporting the development of high-quality vanilla production in Sao Tome. With cocoa, producers can expect to earn small amounts spread across the year.

Vanilla brings in "much larger sums once or twice a year", said Dohar.

Her organisation buys the spice from around 50 farmers to process locally before exporting it to European markets.

Producing the sweet-smelling spice is a lengthy process.

Vanilla can take up to three or four years to develop its first flowers. At their facilities in Pema Pema on the outskirts of Sao Tome's capital, the plant, once harvested, undergoes a long, artisanal preparation process.

First, the green vanilla is dried in the gardens in the sun. "We're in a very humid environment, so we need to remove part of the moisture from the pod fairly quickly," Francesco Mai, the other founder of L'Atelier Vanilha, said.

Afterwards comes several months of drying indoors, massaging the pods, scalding, fermentation and curing.

The vanilla then turns from green to dark brown and develops its characteristic aroma. "At full production, we're at around 300 kilos. These are very small volumes, but the goal is to achieve high quality and target a premium market of fine grocery shops and Michelin-starred restaurants in France, Switzerland and Belgium," Dohar said.

Madagascar and Indonesia dominate the global market, accounting for more than 80% of production with around 3,000 tonnes between them.

On the island of Sao Tome, where the mild, warm climate favours the growth of vanilla vines, cultivating the tropical orchid, which involves a demanding process of manual pollination, remains a largely underdeveloped sector.

But more than 5,000 km away, the vanilla of the "Chocolate Islands" is appreciated for its aromatic qualities.

"There are notes of cocoa nibs in the base notes," said Mathilde Roellinger, managing director of Epices Roellinger, a renowned, Michelin-starred name in French gastronomy.

"There's a real floral elegance with violet notes," she said, from the family restaurant in Cancale Bay in northwestern France.

"Then at the heart of the vanilla you almost get hints of small red berries. It's extremely rich in the diversity of its aromatic profile," she added, breaking off to inhale the scent of a newly arrived pod from the island.

Its flavours give a tiny taste of the faraway archipelago of 210,000 people which gained independence in 1975.

"For me, every spice carries the landscape it comes from," Roellinger said. "And Sao Tome is a paradise island. There is a bit of that mystery and beauty in the vanilla bean."

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results for the Quarter/Half Year Ended 30th September, 2026 (₹ in Lakh)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations (net)	817408	742139	1685632	1485460	2974098
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	78564	61976	144197	122720	276786
5.	Total Comprehensive income for the period (comprising Profit/Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)	Please Refer Note No. 2				
6.	Paid Up Equity Share Capital	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	1756007	1541844	1756007	1541844	1756007
8.	Securities Premium Account	504211	504211	504211	504211	504211
9.	Net Worth	2788109	2301266	2788109	2301266	2446221
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	0.08	0.09	0.08	0.09	0.09
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	0.75	0.66	0.75	0.66	0.70
12.	Earning Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
	1. Basic :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
	2. Diluted :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable				
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve					

Notes : 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/ half-yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under regulation 33 and 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly/half yearly Financial Result are available on the Stock Exchange websites. (BSE : **www.bseindia.com** and NSE : **www.nseindia.com**), Bank's website (**www.uco.bank.in/Investors**)
2. Information relating to total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the bank.

For UCO Bank

Place : Kolkata
Dated : 15th October, 2026

Sd/- Vijaykumar Nivrutti Kamble, Executive Director
Sd/- Rajendra Kumar Saboo, MD & CEO (I/C) and Executive Director
Sd/- Aravamudan Krishna Kumar, Non-Executive Chairman

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